

Parmenides

ΠΑΡΜΕΝΙΔΗΣ

Plato

translated by David Horan

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When we arrived in Athens from Clazomenae, our hometown, we came across Adimantus and Glaucon¹ in the Agora. Adimantus took me by the hand and said, “Greetings, Cephalus. If there is anything you want here, anything we can do for you, just ask.” “In fact,” said I, “that’s the very reason I’m here, to ask you for something.” “Tell us what you want,” he said.

ἐπειδὴ Ἀθήναζε οἴκοθεν ἐκ Κλαζομενῶν ἀφικόμεθα, κατ’ ἀγορὰν ἐνετύχομεν Ἀδειμάντῳ τε καὶ Γλαύκῳ· καὶ μου λαβόμενος τῆς χειρὸς ὁ Ἀδείμαντος, Χαῖρ’, ἔφη, ὦ Κέφαλε, καὶ εἴ του δέῃ τῶν τῆδε ὧν ἡμεῖς δυνατοί, φράζε· ἀλλὰ μὲν δὴ, εἶπον ἐγώ, πάρειμί γε ἐπ’ αὐτὸ τοῦτο, δεησόμενος ὑμῶν· λέγοις ἄν, ἔφη, τὴν δέῃσιν.

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“Your half-brother,” I replied, “on your mother’s side, what was his name? I have forgotten it. He was just a child when I came to Athens previously from Clazomenae, and that was a long time ago now. I think his father’s name was Pyrilampes.” “Indeed so,” he replied. “And his name was?” “Antiphon. But why are you asking?”

καὶ ἐγὼ εἶπον· τῷ ἀδελφῷ ὑμῶν τῷ ὁμομητρίῳ τί ἦν ὄνομα; οὐ γὰρ μέμνημαι. παῖς δέ που ἦν, ὅτε τὸ πρότερον ἐπεδήμησα δεῦρο ἐκ Κλαζομενῶν· πολὺς δὲ ἦδη χρόνος ἐξ ἐκείνου. τῷ μὲν γὰρ πατρί, δοκῶ, Πυριλάμπης ὄνομα· πάνυ γε, ἔφη, αὐτῷ δέ γε; Ἀντιφῶν. ἀλλὰ τί μάλιστα πυνθάνη; οἶδε, εἶπον ἐγώ, πολιταί τ’ ἐμοί εἰσι, μάλα φιλόσοφοι, ἀκηκόασί τε ὅτι οὗτος ὁ Ἀντιφῶν Πυθοδώρῳ τινὶ Ζήνωνος

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“These men here,” said I, “are fellow citizens of mine, serious philosophers who have heard that this man, Antiphon, had numerous meetings with a certain Pythodorus, a companion of Zeno’s,² and that he had heard the discussions that took place between Socrates and Zeno and Parmenides³ so often from Pythodorus that he could recite them from memory.” “That’s true,” he replied. “Well,” said I, “we want to hear an account of these discussions.” “That is no problem,” said he.

“Indeed, as a young man he studied these, although nowadays he takes after his grandfather of the same name and busies himself, for the most part, with horses. But if you want we can go to visit him. He left here a while ago to go home, but he lives nearby in Melite.”

ἐταίρω πολλὰ ἐντετύχηκε, καὶ τοὺς λόγους, οὓς ποτε Σωκράτης καὶ Ζήνων καὶ Παρμενίδης διελέχθησαν, πολλάκις ἀκούσας τοῦ Πυθοδώρου ἀπομνημονεύει. ἀληθῆ, ἔφη, λέγεις. τούτων τοίνυν, εἶπον, δεόμεθα διακοῦσθαι. ἀλλ’ οὐ χαλεπὸν, ἔφη μειράκιον γὰρ ὦν αὐτοὺς εὖ μάλα διεμελέτησεν, ἐπεὶ νῦν γε κατὰ τὸν πάππον τε καὶ ὁμώνυμον πρὸς ἱππικῇ τὰ πολλὰ διατρίβει. ἀλλ’ εἰ δεῖ, ἴωμεν παρ’ αὐτόν· ἄρτι γὰρ ἐνθένδε οἴκαδε οἴχεται, οἰκεῖ δὲ ἐγγὺς ἐν Μελίτῃ.

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With that, we set off on foot and we came across Antiphon at home, giving a bit of some sort to a smith to work on. When he had finished with the smith, the brothers told him why we were there. He recognised me from my previous visit, and greeted me. When we asked him to recount the discussions, he was reluctant at first, saying that it involved a lot of work, but he eventually gave us a detailed account.

ταῦτα εἰπόντες ἐβαδίζομεν, καὶ κατελάβομεν τὸν Ἀντιφῶντα οἴκοι, χαλινόν τινα χαλκεῖ ἐκδιδόντα σκευάσαι· ἐπειδὴ δὲ ἐκείνου ἀπηλλάγη οἱ τε ἀδελφοὶ ἔλεγον αὐτῷ ὦν ἕνεκα παρεῖμεν, ἀνεγνώρισέν τέ με ἐκ τῆς προτέρας ἐπιδημίας καί με ἡσπάζετο, καὶ δεομένων ἡμῶν διελθεῖν τοὺς λόγους, τὸ μὲν πρῶτον ὥκνει—πολὺ γὰρ ἔφη ἔργον εἶναι—ἐπειτα μέντοι διηγεῖτο. ἔφη δὲ δὴ ὁ Ἀντιφῶν λέγειν τὸν Πυθόδωρον ὅτι ἀφίκοιντό ποτε εἰς Παναθήναια τὰ μέγала

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Antiphon explained that, according to Pythodorus, Zeno and Parmenides had come to Athens once for the Great Panathenaea.⁴ Parmenides was by then well advanced in years, a grey-haired, sixty-five-year-old man of noble and handsome appearance. Zeno was almost forty at the time, tall and good-looking, and it was said that he had once been a favourite of Parmenides. They were staying, he said, with

Pythodorus outside the walls in the Kerameikos. Socrates arrived, accompanied by a number of others who wished to hear a reading of Zeno's writings which had been brought to Athens for the first time by these two visitors. Socrates was quite young at the time. While Zeno himself was reading to them, Parmenides happened to be outside.

Ζήνων τε καὶ Παρμενίδης. τὸν μὲν οὖν Παρμενίδην εὖ μάλα ἤδη πρεσβύτην εἶναι, σφόδρα πολίον, καλὸν δὲ κάγαθὸν τὴν ὄψιν, περὶ ἔτη μάλιστα πέντε καὶ ἐξήκοντα Ζήωνα δὲ ἐγγὺς τῶν τετταράκοντα τότε εἶναι, εὐμήκη δὲ καὶ χαρίεντα ἰδεῖν, καὶ λέγεσθαι αὐτὸν παιδικὰ τοῦ Παρμενίδου γεγονέναι. καταλύειν δὲ αὐτοὺς ἔφη παρὰ τῷ

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Pythodorus said that when he himself came in, along with Parmenides and Aristoteles, who later became one of The Thirty, very few of the arguments still remained to be read, and they listened to a small number of writings, although he himself had actually heard them before from Zeno.

Πυθοδώρῳ ἐκτὸς τείχους ἐν Κεραμεικῷ· οἱ δὴ καὶ ἀφικέσθαι τὸν τε Σωκράτη καὶ ἄλλους τινὰς μετ' αὐτοῦ πολλοὺς, ἐπιθυμοῦντας ἀκοῦσαι τῶν τοῦ Ζήωνος γραμμάτων—τότε γὰρ αὐτὰ πρῶτον ὑπ' ἐκείνων κομισθῆναι—Σωκράτη δὲ εἶναι τότε σφόδρα νέον. ἀναγινώσκειν οὖν αὐτοῖς τὸν Ζήωνα αὐτόν, τὸν δὲ Παρμενίδην τυχεῖν ἕξω ὄντα· καὶ εἶναι πάνυ βραχὺ ἔτι λοιπὸν τῶν λόγων ἀναγινωσκομένων, ἥνικα

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Having listened, Socrates asked that the first hypothesis of the first argument be read again, and once it had been read, he said,

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S: “What do you mean by this Zeno? If things that are, are many, they must actually be both like and unlike, but this is an impossibility since what's unlike cannot be like, nor can what's like be unlike. Is that what you are saying?”

αὐτός τε ἐπεισελθεῖν ἔφη ὁ Πυθόδωρος ἕξωθεν καὶ τὸν Παρμενίδην μετ' αὐτοῦ καὶ Ἀριστοτέλη τὸν τῶν τριάκοντα γενόμενον, καὶ σμίкр'

ἅττα ἔτι ἐπακοῦσαι τῶν γραμμάτων· οὐ μὴν αὐτός γε, ἀλλὰ καὶ πρότερον ἀκηκοέναι τοῦ Ζήνωνος. τὸν οὖν Σωκράτη ἀκούσαντα πάλιν τε κελεῦσαι τὴν πρώτην ὑπόθεσιν τοῦ πρώτου λόγου ἀναγνῶναι, καὶ ἀναγνωσθείσης,

Z: “It is,” said Zeno.

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S: “So if it is impossible for what’s unlike to be like and for what’s like to be unlike, then isn’t it also impossible for them to be many? For if they were many, they would be subject to impossible outcomes. So isn’t this the intention of your arguments, solely to contend, contrary to everything that is said, that things that are, are not many? You think, don’t you, that each of your arguments is a proof of this very claim, and so you believe that you have provided as many proofs as written arguments to the effect that things that are, are not many? Is this what you mean, or have I misunderstood you?”

πῶς, φάναι, ὦ Ζήνων, τοῦτο λέγεις; εἰ πολλά ἐστι τὰ ὄντα, ὥς ἄρα δεῖ αὐτὰ ὅμοιά τε εἶναι καὶ ἀνόμοια, τοῦτο δὲ δὴ ἀδύνατον· οὔτε γὰρ τὰ ἀνόμοια ὅμοια οὔτε τὰ ὅμοια ἀνόμοια οἷόν τε εἶναι; οὐχ οὕτω λέγεις; οὕτω, φάναι τὸν Ζήωνα. οὐκοῦν εἰ ἀδύνατον τὰ τε ἀνόμοια ὅμοια εἶναι καὶ τὰ ὅμοια ἀνόμοια, ἀδύνατον δὲ καὶ πολλὰ εἶναι; εἰ γὰρ πολλὰ εἶη, πᾶσχοι ἂν τὰ ἀδύνατα. ἄρα τοῦτό ἐστιν ὃ βούλονταί σου οἱ λόγοι, οὐκ ἄλλο τι ἢ διαμάχεσθαι παρὰ πάντα τὰ λεγόμενα ὥς οὐ πολλά ἐστι; καὶ τούτου αὐτοῦ οἶμι σοι τεκμήριον εἶναι ἕκαστον τῶν λόγων, ὥστε καὶ ἡγῇ τοσαῦτα τεκμήρια παρέχεσθαι, ὅσουσπερ λόγους γέγραφας, ὥς οὐκ

Z: “No,” said Zeno. “On the contrary, you have well understood the intent of the book as a whole.”

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S: “Well Parmenides,” said Socrates, “I am discovering that Zeno here wishes to be close to you not only in general friendship, but also in his book. For he has, in a way, written the same thing as yourself, but by making some changes he tries to deceive us into believing that he is

saying something different. For you say in your poems that ‘all is one’, and you provide excellent, elegant proofs of this assertion, while this man, for his part, says that it is not many,⁵ and he too provides lots of extensive proofs. So with one of you saying that it is one, and the other that it is not many, and each speaking as if you had seemingly not said the same things, while saying more or less the same things, what you have said appears to have been spoken over the heads of the rest of us.”

ἔστι πολλά; οὕτω λέγεις, ἢ ἐγὼ οὐκ ὀρθῶς καταμανθάνω; οὐκ, ἀλλά, φάναι τὸν Ζήνωνα, καλῶς συνήκας ὅλον τὸ γράμμα ὃ βούλεται. μανθάνω, εἰπεῖν τὸν Σωκράτη, ὃ Παρμενίδη, ὅτι Ζήνων ὅδε οὐ μόνον τῇ ἄλλῃ σου φιλίᾳ βούλεται ὥκειώσθαι, ἀλλὰ καὶ τῷ συγγράμματι. ταῦτόν γὰρ γέγραφε τρόπον τινὰ ὅπερ σύ, μεταβάλλων δὲ ἡμᾶς πειρᾶται ἐξαπατᾶν ὡς ἕτερόν τι λέγων. σὺ μὲν γὰρ ἐν τοῖς ποιήμασιν ἔν φης εἶναι τὸ

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Z: “Yes, Socrates,” said Zeno, “but you have not fully appreciated the truth about the book, although like the hounds of Sparta, you hunt down the arguments and follow their trail quite well. In the first place, you are unaware of the fact that the book is not really so serious as to have been written with the intention you are describing, while concealing it from people as if that was some significant achievement. No, you are referring to something incidental, while in truth this is a support to Parmenides’ argument against those who try to make fun of it on the grounds that if it is one, many absurdities and self-contradictions follow from that proposition. This book then opposes those who speak for the many and pays them back with the same and more, intending to demonstrate that this hypothesis of theirs, that it is many, incurs even greater ridicule, if someone sufficiently presses the point, than the hypothesis that it is one. I wrote the book in this sort of combative spirit in my early years, but once it had been written, someone plagiarised it, so I was not allowed to decide whether it should see the light of day or not. So, this is the point you have missed, Socrates. You think it was written out of an older man’s

ambition rather than a young man's combative spirit. Although, as I said, your comparison is not a bad one."

πάν, καὶ τούτων τεκμήρια παρέχῃ καλῶς τε καὶ εὖ· ὅδε δὲ αὖ οὐ πολλά φησιν εἶναι, τεκμήρια δὲ καὶ αὐτὸς πάμπολλα καὶ παμμεγέθη παρέχεται. τὸ οὖν τὸν μὲν ἔν φάναι, τὸν δὲ μὴ πολλά, καὶ οὕτως ἐκάτερον λέγειν ὥστε μηδὲν τῶν αὐτῶν εἰρηκέναι δοκεῖν σχεδόν τι λέγοντας ταυτά, ὑπὲρ ἡμᾶς τοὺς ἄλλους φαίνεται ὑμῖν τὰ εἰρημένα εἰρῆσθαι. ναί, φάναι τὸν Ζήνωνα, ὦ Σώκρατες. σὺ δ' οὖν τὴν ἀλήθειαν τοῦ γράμματος οὐ πανταχοῦ ἦσθησαι. καίτοι ὥσπερ γε αἱ Λάκαιναι σκύλακες εὖ μεταθεῖς τε καὶ ἰχνεύεις τὰ λεχθέντα· ἀλλὰ πρῶτον μὲν σε τοῦτο λανθάνει, ὅτι οὐ παντάπασιν οὕτω σεμνύνεται τὸ γράμμα, ὥστε ἅπερ σὺ λέγεις διανοηθὲν γραφῆναι, τοὺς ἀνθρώπους δὲ ἐπικρυπτόμενον ὥς τι μέγα διαπραττόμενον· ἀλλὰ σὺ μὲν εἶπες τῶν συμβεβηκότων τι, ἔστι δὲ τό γε ἀληθὲς βοήθειά τις ταῦτα τὰ γράμματα τῷ Παρμενίδου λόγῳ πρὸς τοὺς ἐπιχειροῦντας αὐτὸν κωμωδεῖν ὥς εἰ ἔν ἐστι, πολλὰ καὶ γελοῖα συμβαίνει πάσχειν τῷ λόγῳ καὶ ἐναντία αὐτῷ. ἀντιλέγει δὴ οὖν τοῦτο τὸ γράμμα πρὸς τοὺς τὰ πολλά λέγοντας, καὶ ἀνταποδίδωσι ταῦτα καὶ πλείω, τοῦτο βουλόμενον δηλοῦν, ὥς ἔτι γελοιότερα πάσχοι ἂν αὐτῶν ἢ ὑπόθεσις, εἰ πολλά ἐστίν, ἢ ἢ τοῦ ἔν εἶναι, εἴ τις ἰκανῶς ἐπεξίῃ. διὰ τοιαύτην δὴ φιλονικίαν ὑπὸ νέου ὄντος ἐμοῦ ἐγράφη, καὶ τις αὐτὸ ἔκλεψε γραφέν, ὥστε οὐδὲ βουλεύσασθαι ἐξεγένετο εἴτ'

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S: "I accept that," said Socrates, "and I believe that the circumstances were as you say. But tell me this. Don't you think that there is a form, just by itself, of likeness, and again another form, opposite to this, that which unlike is? And don't you and I, and whatever else we call many, get a share of these two? Don't those that get a share of likeness become like in the way that, and to the extent that, they get a share, while those that get a share of unlikeness become unlike, and those that get a share of both become both? And even if all things get a share of both, although they are opposites, and by partaking of both become like as well as unlike themselves, is that a surprise?

ἐξοιστέον αὐτὸ εἰς τὸ φῶς εἶτε μή. ταύτη οὖν σε λανθάνει, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὅτι οὐχ ὑπὸ νέου φιλονικίας οἶει αὐτὸ γεγράφθαι, ἀλλ' ὑπὸ πρεσβυτέρου φιλοτιμίας· ἐπεὶ, ὅπερ γ' εἶπον, οὐ κακῶς ἀπήκασας. ἀλλ' ἀποδέχομαι, φάναι τὸν Σωκράτη, καὶ ἡγοῦμαι ὡς λέγεις ἔχειν. τότε δέ μοι εἶπέ· οὐ νομίζεις εἶναι αὐτὸ καθ' αὐτὸ εἰδὸς τι ὁμοιότητος, καὶ τῷ τοιούτῳ αὖ ἄλλο τι ἐναντίον, ὃ ἔστιν ἀνόμοιον· τούτοις δὲ δυοῖν ὄντων καὶ ἐμὲ καὶ σὲ καὶ τᾶλλα ἃ δὴ πολλὰ καλοῦμεν μεταλαμβάνειν; καὶ τὰ μὲν τῆς ὁμοιότητος μεταλαμβάνοντα ὅμοια γίνεσθαι ταύτη τε καὶ κατὰ τοσοῦτον ὅσον ἂν μεταλάβῃ, τὰ δὲ τῆς ἀνομοιότητος ἀνόμοια, τὰ δὲ ἀμφοτέρων ἀμφοτέρα; εἰ δὲ καὶ πάντα ἐναντίων ὄντων ἀμφοτέρων μεταλαμβάνει, καὶ ἔστι τῷ μετέχειν ἀμφοῖν ὁμοιά τε καὶ ἀνόμοια αὐτὰ

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S: “Indeed if someone were to show the likes themselves becoming unlike, or the unlikes becoming like, that I think would be extraordinary. But if he shows that whatever partakes of both of these is characterised in both ways, that does not seem at all unusual to me, Zeno, nor indeed if he shows that all things are one by partaking of the one, and these same things are again many by partaking of multiplicity. But if someone can prove that this itself, what one is, is many, or in turn that the many are indeed one, at this I will be surprised. And the same holds for all of the others. If someone could show the kinds and forms themselves, in themselves, being characterised by these opposite characteristics, that would be worthy of surprise. But why be surprised if someone can show that I am one and many by saying, when he wants to show that I am many, that my right side is different, my left side is different, my front is different, my back is different, and the same goes for my upper and lower parts, since I presumably partake of multiplicity?

αὐτοῖς, τί θαυμαστόν; εἰ μὲν γὰρ αὐτὰ τὰ ὁμοιά τις ἀπέφαινε ἀνόμοια γιγνόμενα ἢ τὰ ἀνόμοια ὅμοια, τέρας ἂν οἶμαι ἦν· εἰ δὲ τὰ τούτων μετέχοντα ἀμφοτέρων ἀμφοτέρα ἀποφαίνει πεπονθότα, οὐδὲν ἔμοιγε, ὦ Ζήνων, ἄτοπον δοκεῖ, οὐδέ γε εἰ ἔν ᾗπαντα ἀποφαίνει τις τῷ μετέχειν

τοῦ ἑνὸς καὶ ταῦτα ταῦτα πολλὰ τῷ πλήθους αὖ μετέχουν. ἀλλ' εἰ ὁ ἔστιν ἓν, αὐτὸ τοῦτο πολλὰ ἀποδείξει καὶ αὖ τὰ πολλὰ δὴ ἓν, τοῦτο ἤδη θαυμάσομαι. καὶ περὶ τῶν ἄλλων ἀπάντων ὡσαύτως· εἰ μὲν αὐτὰ τὰ γένη τε καὶ εἶδη ἐν αὐτοῖς ἀποφαίνοι τάναντία ταῦτα πάθη πάσχοντα, ἄξιον θαυμάζειν· εἰ δ' ἐμὲ ἓν τις ἀποδείξει ὄντα καὶ πολλὰ, τί θαυμαστόν, λέγων, ὅταν μὲν βούληται πολλὰ ἀποφῆναι, ὡς ἕτερα μὲν τὰ ἐπὶ δεξιὰ μου ἐστίν, ἕτερα δὲ τὰ ἐπ' ἀριστερά, καὶ ἕτερα μὲν τὰ πρόσθεν, ἕτερα δὲ τὰ ὀπίσθεν, καὶ ἄνω καὶ κάτω ὡσαύτως—πλήθους γὰρ οἶμαι μετέχω—ὅταν δὲ ἓν, ἐρεῖ ὡς

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S: And when he wants to show that I am one, he will say that I am one person of the seven of us here, since I also partake of the one. And so he shows that both assertions are true. So if, in the case of stones and sticks and the like, someone were to show that such objects are many and also the same one, we shall maintain that he has shown that something is one and many, not that the one is many or that the many is one, and he is not saying anything surprising, but something we would all accept. But if someone were first to distinguish as separate the forms, just by themselves, of the things I just mentioned,

ἐπὶ τὰ ἡμῶν ὄντων εἷς ἐγὼ εἶμι ἄνθρωπος μετέχων καὶ τοῦ ἑνός· ὥστε ἀληθῆ ἀποφαίνει ἀμφοτέρω. ἐὰν οὖν τις τοιαῦτα ἐπιχειρῇ πολλὰ καὶ ἓν ταῦτ' ἀποφαίνειν, λίθους καὶ ξύλα καὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα, τί φήσομεν αὐτὸν πολλὰ καὶ ἓν ἀποδεικνύναι, οὐ τὸ ἓν πολλὰ οὐδὲ τὰ πολλὰ ἓν, οὐδέ τι θαυμαστόν λέγειν, ἀλλ' ἅπερ ἂν πάντες ὁμολογοῖμεν· ἐὰν δέ τις ὦν νυνδὴ ἐγὼ ἔλεγον πρῶτον μὲν διαιρῆται χωρὶς αὐτὰ καθ' αὐτὰ τὰ εἶδη, οἷον ὁμοιότητά τε καὶ ἀνομοιότητά τε καὶ πλῆθος

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S: such as likeness, unlikeness, multiplicity, the one, rest and motion and the like, and then show that these are capable of being combined and separated among themselves, I for one, Zeno, would admire him wonderfully,” said he. “And although I believe you have dealt with these issues very thoroughly, I would, as I say, have much more admiration for someone who could demonstrate that this very same

difficulty that you and Parmenides described among visible things, is involved

καὶ τὸ ἐν καὶ στάσιν καὶ κίνησιν καὶ πάντα τὰ τοιαῦτα, εἴτα ἐν ἑαυτοῖς ταῦτα δυνάμενα συγκεράννυσθαι καὶ διακρίνεσθαι ἀποφαίνει, ἀγαίμην ἂν ἔγωγ', ἔφη, θαυμαστῶς, ὦ Ζήνων. ταῦτα δὲ ἀνδρείως μὲν πάνυ ἡγοῦμαι πεπραγματοῦσθαι· πολὺ μεντὰν ὧδε μᾶλλον, ὡς λέγω, ἀγασθεῖν εἴ τις ἔχοι τὴν αὐτὴν αὐτὴν ἀπορίαν ἐν αὐτοῖς τοῖς εἶδεσι

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S: in all sorts of ways in the forms themselves, in things that are grasped by reasoning.”

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Pythodorus said that while Socrates was saying all this, he himself thought that at any moment Parmenides and Zeno might get annoyed, but on the contrary they paid close attention to him and occasionally glanced at one another and smiled as if they admired Socrates.

παντοδαπῶς πλεκομένην, ὥσπερ ἐν τοῖς ὀρωμένοις διήλθετε, οὕτως καὶ ἐν τοῖς λογισμῶ λαμβανομένοις ἐπιδειξαι. λέγοντος δὴ, ἔφη ὁ Πυθόδωρος, τοῦ Σωκράτους ταῦτα αὐτὸς μὲν ἂν οἶεσθαι ἐφ' ἐκάστου ἄχθεσθαι τὸν τε Παρμενίδην καὶ τὸν Ζήνωνα, τοὺς δὲ πάνυ τε αὐτῶ προσέχειν τὸν νοῦν καὶ θαμὰ εἰς ἀλλήλους βλέποντας μειδιᾶν ὡς ἀγαμένους τὸν Σωκράτη. ὅπερ οὖν καὶ παυσαμένου αὐτοῦ εἰπεῖν τὸν Παρμενίδην· ὦ Σώκρατες, φάναι, ὡς ἄξιος εἶ

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Parmenides confirmed this when Socrates stopped speaking, by saying,

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PA: “Socrates, you deserve to be admired for your drive towards arguments, but tell me this. Do you, as you say, distinguish as separate, certain forms by themselves, and as separate too, whatever partakes of the forms? And do you think that likeness itself is something separate from the likeness that we have, and indeed one and many and everything else you heard of just now from Zeno?”

ἄγασθαι τῆς ὀρμῆς τῆς ἐπὶ τοὺς λόγους, καὶ μοι εἰπέ, αὐτὸς σὺ οὕτω διήρησαι ὡς λέγεις, χωρὶς μὲν εἶδη αὐτὰ ἅττα, χωρὶς δὲ τὰ τούτων αὖ μετέχοντα; καὶ τί σοι δοκεῖ εἶναι αὐτὴ ὁμοιότης χωρὶς ἧς ἡμεῖς ὁμοιότητος ἔχομεν, καὶ ἐν δὴ καὶ πολλὰ καὶ πάντα ὅσα νυνδὴ Ζήνωνος ἤκουες; ἔμοιγε, φάναι τὸν Σωκράτη· ἢ καὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα, εἰπεῖν τὸν Παρμενίδην, οἷον δικαίου τι εἶδος αὐτὸ καθ' αὐτὸ καὶ καλοῦ καὶ ἀγαθοῦ καὶ πάντων αὖ τῶν τοιούτων; ναί, φάναι.

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S: “I do, indeed,” said Socrates.

PA: “And what about things of this sort,” said Parmenides, “things like the just, beautiful and good and everything of this sort? Is there a form just by itself in each case?”

S: “Yes,” he said.

PA: “And what about a form of human being separate from us and from all those who are like us? Is there a form itself of human being, or fire, or even water?”

S: “I have often been in perplexity about these, as to whether I should speak of them just as I spoke of the others, or speak of them differently.”

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PA: “What about the following things, Socrates, which may seem ridiculous, for example, hair, mud and dirt, or anything else totally contemptible or commonplace? Are you perplexed as to whether or not you should say there is also a separate form of each of these which, in turn, is different from anything we handle?”

τί δ', ἀνθρώπου εἶδος χωρὶς ἡμῶν καὶ τῶν οἷοι ἡμεῖς ἐσμεν πάντων, αὐτό τι εἶδος ἀνθρώπου ἢ πυρὸς ἢ καὶ ὕδατος; ἐν ἀπορίᾳ, φάναι, πολλάκις δὴ, ὃ Παρμενίδη, περὶ αὐτῶν γέγονα, πότερα χρή φάναι ὥσπερ περὶ ἐκείνων ἢ ἄλλως; ἢ καὶ περὶ τῶνδε, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἃ καὶ γελοῖα δόξειεν ἂν εἶναι, οἷον θρίξ καὶ πηλὸς καὶ ῥύπος ἢ ἄλλο τι ἀτιμώτατόν τε καὶ φαυλότατον, ἀπορεῖς εἴτε χρή φάναι καὶ τούτων

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S: “Not at all,” said Socrates. “No, these are just what we see them to be. Surely it would be most strange to think that there is a form belonging to these. At that stage, I am troubled sometimes lest there might be something that is the same about all these. Then, whenever I end up in that predicament I take flight, afraid that I might sink into some pit of nonsense and be undone. Finally, getting back to those things which we have just said have forms, I spend my time dealing with these.”

ἐκάστου εἶδος εἶναι χωρίς, ὃν ἄλλο αὐτῷ ἢ ὧν τι ἡμεῖς μεταχειριζόμεθα, εἴτε καὶ μή; οὐδαμῶς, φάναι τὸν Σωκράτη, ἀλλὰ ταῦτα μὲν γε ἅπερ ὁρώμεν, ταῦτα καὶ εἶναι· εἶδος δέ τι αὐτῶν οἰηθῆναι εἶναι μὴ λίαν ἢ ἄτοπον. ἤδη μέντοι ποτέ με καὶ ἔθραξε μὴ τι ἢ περὶ πάντων ταῦτόν· ἔπειτα ὅταν ταῦτη στῶ, φεύγων οἴχομαι, δείσας μὴ ποτε εἰς τινα βυθὸν φλυαρίας ἐμπεσὼν διαφθαρέω· ἐκέῖσε δ’ οὖν ἀφικόμενος, εἰς ἃ νυνδὴ ἐλέγομεν εἶδη ἔχειν, περὶ ἐκεῖνα πραγματευόμενος διατρίβω.

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PA: “You are still young, Socrates,” said Parmenides, “and philosophy has not yet taken hold of you as, in my opinion, it will in the future when you will hold none of these things in contempt. For the moment however, because of your youth, you still look to the opinions of other people. In any case, tell me this: does it seem to you, as you say, that there are certain forms of which these other things get a share and adopt their names? For example, getting a share of likeness, do they become like, getting a share of largeness do they become large, and getting a share of beauty and of justice do they become just and beautiful?”

νέος γὰρ εἶ ἔτι, φάναι τὸν Παρμενίδην, ὃ Σώκρατες, καὶ οὐπω σου ἀντείληπται φιλοσοφία ὥς ἔτι ἀντιλήψεται κατ’ ἐμὴν δόξαν, ὅτε οὐδὲν αὐτῶν ἀτιμάσεις· νῦν δὲ ἔτι πρὸς ἀνθρώπων ἀποβλέπεις δόξας διὰ τὴν ἡλικίαν. τόδε δ’ οὖν μοι εἰπέ. δοκεῖ σοι, ὥς φῆς, εἶναι εἶδη ἅττα, ὧν τάδε τὰ ἄλλα μεταλαμβάνοντα τὰς ἐπωνυμίας αὐτῶν ἴσχειν, οἷον

S: “Indeed so,” replied Socrates.

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PA: “Doesn’t whatever gets a share in each case get a share either of the whole form or of a part? Or could there be some other way of getting a share besides these two?”

ὁμοιότητος μὲν μεταλαμβάνοντα ὅμοια, μεγέθους δὲ μεγάλα, κάλλους δὲ καὶ δικαιοσύνης δίκαιά τε καὶ καλὰ γίνεσθαι; πάνυ γε, φάναι τὸν Σωκράτη. οὐκοῦν ἦτοι ὅλου τοῦ εἶδους ἢ μέρους ἕκαστον τὸ μεταλαμβάνον μεταλαμβάνει; ἢ ἄλλη τις ἂν μετάληψις χωρὶς τούτων γένοιτο; καὶ πῶς ἄν; εἶπεν. πότερον οὖν δοκεῖ σοι ὅλον τὸ εἶδος ἐν ἐκάστῳ εἶναι τῶν πολλῶν ἐν ὧν, ἢ πῶς; τί γὰρ κωλύει, φάναι τὸν Σωκράτη, ὧ Παρμενίδη, ἐν εἶναι;

S: “How could there be?”

PA: “Do you think that the whole form, being one, is in each of the many? Or what do you think?”

S: “What’s to prevent this, Parmenides?” said Socrates.

PA: “So, being one and the same, it will be present simultaneously as a whole in things that are many and separate, and would thus be separate from itself.”

131b

S: “No, Parmenides,” said he, “not if it is like a day, which being one and the same is in many places simultaneously, and is, nevertheless, not separate from itself. If this were the case, each of the forms could simultaneously be one and the same in all things.”

ἐν ἅρᾳ ὧν καὶ ταῦτόν ἐν πολλοῖς καὶ χωρὶς οὓσιν ὅλον ἅμα ἐνέσται, καὶ οὕτως αὐτὸ αὐτοῦ χωρὶς ἂν εἴη. οὐκ ἄν, εἴ γε, φάναι, οἷον εἰ ἡμέρα εἴη μία καὶ ἡ αὐτὴ οὓσα πολλαχοῦ ἅμα ἐστὶ καὶ οὐδέν τι μᾶλλον αὐτὴ αὐτῆς χωρὶς ἐστίν, εἰ οὕτω καὶ ἕκαστον τῶν εἰδῶν ἐν ἐν πᾶσιν ἅμα ταῦτόν εἴη. ἡδέως γε, φάναι, ὧ Σώκρατες, ἐν ταῦτόν ἅμα πολλαχοῦ ποιεῖς, οἷον εἰ ἰστίῳ καταπετάσας πολλοὺς ἀνθρώπους φαίης ἐν ἐπὶ πολλοῖς εἶναι ὅλον· ἢ οὐ τὸ τοιοῦτον ἡγῇ λέγειν;

PA: “Socrates, how nicely you make the one and the same be in many places simultaneously, as if you were to throw a sail over many people and maintain that one, as a whole, is over many. Don’t you think something like this is what you are saying?”

S: “Perhaps.”

PA: “Would the sail as a whole be on each person or just a part of this, and another part on another person?”

S: “A part.”

131c

PA: “So, forms themselves are divisible, Socrates, and things that partake of them would partake of a part, and would no longer be in each as a whole, but a part of each form would be in each.”

ἴσως, φάναι. ἢ οὖν ὅλον ἐφ’ ἐκάστω τὸ ἰστίον εἴη ἄν, ἢ μέρος αὐτοῦ ἄλλο ἐπ’ ἄλλω; μέρος μεριστὰ ἄρα, φάναι, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἔστιν αὐτὰ τὰ εἶδη, καὶ τὰ μετέχοντα αὐτῶν μέρος ἂν μετέχοι, καὶ οὐκέτι ἐν ἐκάστω ὅλον, ἀλλὰ μέρος ἐκάστου ἂν εἴη. φαίνεται οὕτω γε. ἢ οὖν ἐθελήσεις, ὃ Σώκρατες, φάναι τὸ ἐν εἶδος ἡμῖν τῇ ἀληθείᾳ μερίζεσθαι, καὶ ἔτι ἐν ἔσται; οὐδαμῶς, εἰπεῖν. ὅρα γάρ, φάναι, εἰ αὐτὸ τὸ μέγεθος μεριεῖς καὶ ἕκαστον

S: “Apparently so.”

PA: “Well then, Socrates, do you wish to maintain that our one form is in truth divided and will still be one?”

S: “Not at all.”

131d

PA: “Indeed, look at it this way. If you are going to divide largeness itself, and each of the many large things is to be large by a part of largeness, smaller than largeness itself, won’t that appear unreasonable?”

τῶν πολλῶν μεγάλων μεγέθους μέρος σμικροτέρῳ αὐτοῦ τοῦ μεγέθους μέγα ἔσται, ἄρα οὐκ ἄλογον φανεῖται; πάνυ γ’, ἔφη. τί δέ; τοῦ ἴσου μέρος

ἕκαστον σμικρὸν ἀπολαβόν τι ἔξει ὧ ἐλάττονι ὄντι αὐτοῦ τοῦ ἴσου τὸ ἔχον ἴσον τῷ ἔσται; ἀδύνατον. ἀλλὰ τοῦ σμικροῦ μέρος τις ἡμῶν ἔξει, τούτου δὲ αὐτοῦ τὸ σμικρὸν μεῖζον ἔσται ἅτε μέρους ἑαυτοῦ ὄντος, καὶ οὕτω δὴ αὐτὸ τὸ σμικρὸν μεῖζον ἔσται ὧ δ' ἂν προστεθῇ τὸ

S: “Very much so.”

PA: “What about this? Will each thing that has received a small part of the equal be equal to anything else by possessing a part that is less than the equal itself?”

S: “Impossible.”

131e

PA: “But some of us will have a part of the small, and the small will be greater than this part since this is a part of itself, and the small itself will in this way be larger, while whatever the subtracted part is added to will be smaller, not larger, than before.”

ἀφαιρεθέν, τοῦτο σμικρότερον ἔσται ἀλλ' οὐ μεῖζον ἢ πρίν. οὐκ ἂν γένοιτο, φάναι, τοῦτό γε τίνα οὖν τρόπον, εἰπεῖν, ὧ Σώκρατες, τῶν εἰδῶν σοι τὰ ἄλλα μεταλήψεται, μήτε κατὰ μέρη μήτε κατὰ ὅλα μεταλαμβάνειν δυνάμενα; οὐ μὰ τὸν Δία, φάναι, οὐ μοι δοκεῖ εὐκόλον εἶναι τὸ τοιοῦτον οὐδαμῶς διορίσασθαι. τί δὲ δή; πρὸς τόδε πῶς ἔχεις; τὸ ποῖον;

S: “Well, that couldn’t happen,” he said.

PA: “In that case, Socrates, in what way will the others get a share of your forms when they are unable to get a share either on the basis of parts or on the basis of wholes?”

S: “No, by Zeus,” he responded, “I don’t think it is easy to decide such a question at all.”

PA: “What about this then? Where do you stand on the following question?”

S: “Which is?”

132a

PA: “I presume that you think that each form is one for some such reason as this. Whenever many things seem to you to be large, perhaps there seems to be one characteristic that is the same as you survey them all. Hence you think that the large is one.”

οἷμαί σε ἐκ τοῦ τοιοῦδε ἐν ἑκαστον εἶδος οἶσθαι εἶναι· ὅταν πόλλ’ ἄττα μεγάλα σοι δόξη εἶναι, μία τις ἴσως δοκεῖ ἰδέα ἡ αὐτὴ εἶναι ἐπὶ πάντα ἰδόντι, ὅθεν ἐν τὸ μέγα ἡγῆ εἶναι. ἀληθῆ λέγεις, φάναι. τί δ’ αὐτὸ τὸ μέγα καὶ τᾶλλα τὰ μεγάλα, ἐὰν ὡσαύτως τῇ ψυχῇ ἐπὶ πάντα ἴδῃς, οὐχὶ ἐν τι αὖ μέγα φανεῖται, ὃ ταῦτα πάντα μεγάλα φαίνεσθαι; οἷκεν. ἄλλο ἄρα εἶδος μεγέθους ἀναφανήσεται, παρ’ αὐτό τε τὸ μέγεθος γεγονὸς καὶ τὰ μετέχοντα αὐτοῦ· καὶ ἐπὶ τούτοις αὖ

S: “That’s true.”

PA: “What about the large itself and the other large things? If you survey all these in the same way with the soul, won’t some one large appear, in turn, by which all these large things appear large?”

S: “So it seems.”

132b

PA: “So, another form of largeness will make an appearance alongside the largeness itself that has come into being, and whatever partakes of this, and another, in turn, over all these, by which all these will be large, and each of your forms will be one no longer but unlimited in multiplicity.”

πᾶσιν ἕτερον, ὃ ταῦτα πάντα μεγάλα ἔσται· καὶ οὐκέτι δὴ ἐν ἑκαστόν σοι τῶν εἰδῶν ἔσται, ἀλλὰ ἅπειρα τὸ πλῆθος, ἀλλά, φάναι, ὦ Παρμενίδη, τὸν Σωκράτη, μὴ τῶν εἰδῶν ἑκαστον ἢ τούτων νόημα, καὶ οὐδαμοῦ αὐτῷ προσήκη ἐγγίγνεσθαι ἄλλοθι ἢ ἐν ψυχαῖς· οὕτω γὰρ ἂν ἐν γε ἑκαστον εἴη καὶ οὐκ ἂν ἔτι πάσχοι ἃ νυνδὴ ἐλέγετο. τί οὖν; φάναι, ἐν ἑκαστόν ἐστι τῶν νοημάτων, νόημα δὲ οὐδενός; ἀλλ’ ἀδύνατον, εἰπεῖν. ἀλλὰ τινός; ναί.

S: “But Parmenides,” said Socrates, “couldn’t each of the forms be a thought of these, and it would not be appropriate for this to arise

anywhere else besides in souls? For in this way, each form could be one and would no longer be affected by everything that has just been described.”

PA: “Then,” Parmenides replied, “is each of the thoughts one, but a thought of nothing?”

S: “No, that’s impossible,” he said.

PA: “So, it is a thought of something?”

S: “Yes.”

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PA: “Of something that is or something that is not?”

ὄντος ἢ οὐκ ὄντος; ὄντος, οὐχ ἑνός τινος, ὃ ἐπὶ πᾶσιν ἐκεῖνο τὸ νόημα ἐπὶ νοεῖ, μίαν τινὰ οὖσαν ιδέαν; ναί. εἴτα οὐκ εἶδος ἔσται τοῦτο τὸ νοούμενον ἐν εἶναι, ἀεὶ δὲ τὸ αὐτὸ ἐπὶ πᾶσιν; ἀνάγκη αὖ φαίνεται. τί δὲ δῆ; εἰπεῖν τὸν Παρμενίδην, οὐκ ἀνάγκη ἢ τᾶλλα φῆς τῶν εἰδῶν μετέχειν ἢ δοκεῖ σοι ἐκ νοημάτων ἕκαστον εἶναι καὶ πάντα νοεῖν, ἢ νοήματα ὄντα ἀνόητα εἶναι; ἀλλ’ οὐδὲ τοῦτο, φάναι, ἔχει λόγον, ἀλλ’, ὧ Παρμενίδη,

S: “Something that is.”

PA: “Isn’t it of some one which that thought thinks is set over all of them as one characteristic?”

S: “Yes.”

PA: “That something, which is thought to be one, being always the same over all of them, won’t that be a form?”

S: “Again, this appears necessary.”

PA: “What about this, then?” asked Parmenides. “By the necessity by which you maintain that the others partake of the forms, do you think either that each is from thoughts and everything thinks, or although they are thoughts, they are devoid of thinking?”

132d

S: “No, this is not reasonable either,” he said. “But Parmenides, what appears most obvious to me is that these forms stand like patterns in nature, while the others resemble these and are likenesses, and for the others this partaking of forms turns out to be nothing else but resembling them.”

μάλιστα ἔμοιγε καταφαίνεται ὧδε ἔχειν· τὰ μὲν εἶδη ταῦτα ὥσπερ παραδείγματα ἐστάναι ἐν τῇ φύσει, τὰ δὲ ἄλλα τούτοις εἰκέναι καὶ εἶναι ὁμοιώματα, καὶ ἡ μέθεξις αὕτη τοῖς ἄλλοις γίγνεσθαι τῶν εἰδῶν οὐκ ἄλλη τις ἢ εἰκασθῆναι αὐτοῖς. εἰ οὖν τι, ἔφη, ἔοικεν τῷ εἶδει, οἷόν τε ἐκεῖνο τὸ εἶδος μὴ ὅμοιον εἶναι τῷ εἰκασθέντι, καθ’ ὅσον αὐτῷ ἀφωμοιώθη; ἢ ἔστι τις μηχανὴ τὸ ὅμοιον μὴ ὁμοίῳ ὅμοιον εἶναι; οὐκ ἔστι. τὸ δὲ ὅμοιον τῷ ὁμοίῳ ἄρ’ οὐ μεγάλη ἀνάγκη ἐνὸς τοῦ

132e

PA: “Now,” Parmenides replied, “if something resembles the form, can that form fail to be like whatever resembles it, insofar as that has been made like the form? Or is there some way that the like is unlike its like?”

αὐτοῦ εἶδους μετέχειν; ἀνάγκη. οὐ δ’ ἂν τὰ ὅμοια μετέχοντα ὅμοια ἦ, οὐκ ἐκεῖνο ἔσται αὐτὸ τὸ εἶδος; παντάπασιν μὲν οὖν. οὐκ ἄρα οἷόν τέ τι τῷ εἶδει ὅμοιον εἶναι, οὐδὲ τὸ εἶδος ἄλλω· εἰ δὲ μή, παρὰ τὸ εἶδος αἰεὶ ἄλλο ἀναφανήσεται εἶδος,

S: “There is not.”

PA: “And isn’t there a strong necessity that the like partakes of one and the same thing as what it is like?”

S: “It is necessary.”

PA: “But what do the likes partake of so as to be like? Won’t that be the form itself?”

S: “Entirely so.”

133a

PA: “So nothing can be like the form, nor can the form be like anything else. Otherwise, alongside the form another form will always make an appearance. And if that form is like something, yet another form will appear, and the continual generation of a new form will never cease if the form turns out to be like whatever partakes of it.”

καὶ ἂν ἐκεῖνό τῳ ὅμοιον ᾦ, ἕτερον αὖ, καὶ οὐδέποτε παύσεται ἀεὶ καινὸν εἶδος γιγνόμενον, ἐὰν τὸ εἶδος τῷ ἑαυτοῦ μετέχοντι ὅμοιον γίγνηται. ἀληθέστατα λέγεις. οὐκ ἄρα ὁμοιότητι τᾶλλα τῶν εἰδῶν μεταλαμβάνει, ἀλλὰ τι ἄλλο δεῖ ζητεῖν ὃ μεταλαμβάνει. ἔοικεν. ὁρᾷς οὖν, φάναι, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὅση ἡ ἀπορία ἐάν τις ὡς εἶδη ὄντα αὐτὰ καθ' αὐτὰ διορίζηται; καὶ μάλα. εὖ τοίνυν ἴσθι, φάναι, ὅτι ὡς ἔπος εἰπεῖν οὐδέπω ἅπτη

S: “Very true.”

PA: “Since it is not by likeness that the others get a share of the forms, we must rather look for something else by which they get a share.”

S: “So it seems.”

PA: “Do you see then, Socrates,” said he, “the extent of the difficulty once someone distinguishes forms as being just by themselves?”

S: “Very much so.”

133b

PA: “Mark my words, you have not yet, so to speak, grasped the extent of the difficulty that arises if you propose one form for each of the things that are, in each case, by continually separating something off.”

αὐτῆς ὅση ἐστὶν ἡ ἀπορία, εἰ ἐν εἶδος ἕκαστον τῶν ὄντων ἀεὶ τι ἀφοριζόμενος θήσεις. πῶς δὴ; εἰπεῖν. πολλὰ μὲν καὶ ἄλλα, φάναι, μέγιστον δὲ τόδε. εἴ τις φαίη μηδὲ προσήκειν αὐτὰ γιγνώσκεισθαι ὄντα τοιαῦτα οἷά φαμεν δεῖν εἶναι τὰ εἶδη, τῷ ταῦτα λέγοντι οὐκ ἂν ἔχοι τις ἐνδείξασθαι ὅτι ψεύδεται, εἰ μὴ πολλῶν μὲν τύχοι ἔμπειρος ὢν ὁ ἀμφισβητῶν καὶ μὴ ἀφύης, ἐθέλοι δὲ πάνυ πολλὰ καὶ πόρρωθεν πραγματευομένου τοῦ ἐνδεικνυμένου ἔπεσθαι, ἀλλ'

S: “How so?”

PA: “Though there are various other reasons, the main one is this. If someone were to maintain that if forms are such as we say they must be, it is not in their nature even to be known, no one would be able to show someone who says so that he is wrong, unless the objector happened to be naturally gifted, and have lots of experience and a willingness to follow a very extensive and far-reaching demonstration dealing with the issue. Otherwise, the person who insists that the forms are unknowable would remain unconvinced.”

S: “Why is that Parmenides?” Socrates asked.

133c

PA: “Because, Socrates, I would imagine that you and anyone else who proposes that there is, for each, some being just by itself, would agree in the first place that none of these are among us.”

ἀπίθανος εἶη ὁ ἄγνωστα ἀναγκάζων αὐτὰ εἶναι. πῇ δὴ, ὦ Παρμενίδη; φάναι τὸν Σωκράτη. ὅτι, ὦ Σώκρατες, οἶμαι ἂν καὶ σὲ καὶ ἄλλον, ὅστις αὐτὴν τινα καθ’ αὐτὴν ἐκάστου οὐσίαν τίθεται εἶναι, ὁμολογῆσαι ἂν πρῶτον μὲν μηδεμίαν αὐτῶν εἶναι ἐν ἡμῖν. πῶς γὰρ ἂν αὐτὴ καθ’ αὐτὴν ἔτι εἴη; φάναι τὸν Σωκράτη. καλῶς λέγεις, εἰπεῖν. οὐκοῦν καὶ ὅσαι τῶν ἰδεῶν πρὸς ἀλλήλας εἰσὶν αἷ εἰσιν, αὐταὶ πρὸς αὐτάς τὴν οὐσίαν ἔχουσιν, ἀλλ’ οὐ πρὸς τὰ παρ’

S: “Indeed not. How could it still be just by itself?”

PA: “Well said,” Parmenides replied. “Therefore, those characteristics that are what they are in relation to one another have their being in relation to themselves, and not in relation to whatever is with us, whether someone posits likeness or whatever else he suggests we partake of and are named after in each case. While those that are with us, although they have the same names as the forms, are, in turn, what they are in relation to themselves and not in relation to the forms. And whatever things are named in this way refer to themselves and not to those forms.”

133d

S: “What do you mean?” asked Socrates.

ἡμῖν εἴτε ὁμοιώματα εἴτε ὅπῃ δὴ τις αὐτὰ τίθεται, ὧν ἡμεῖς μετέχοντες εἶναι ἕκαστα ἐπονομαζόμεθα· τὰ δὲ παρ’ ἡμῖν ταῦτα ὁμώνυμα ὄντα ἐκείνοις αὐτὰ αὖ πρὸς αὐτὰ ἐστὶν ἄλλ’ οὐ πρὸς τὰ εἶδη, καὶ ἑαυτῶν ἄλλ’ οὐκ ἐκείνων ὅσα αὖ ὀνομάζεται οὕτως· πῶς λέγεις; φάναι τὸν Σωκράτη· οἶον, φάναι τὸν Παρμενίδην, εἴ τις ἡμῶν τοῦ δεσπότης ἢ δοῦλός ἐστιν, οὐκ αὐτοῦ δεσπότου δήπου, ὃ ἔστι δεσπότης,

PA: “For instance,” said Parmenides, “if one of us is the master or slave of someone, he is not, of course, the slave of master itself, what master is; nor is a master, master of slave itself, what slave is. Rather, as human beings, we are master or slave of a fellow human. Mastery itself, on the other hand, is what it is of slavery itself, while slavery itself, in like manner, is slavery of mastery itself.

133e

PA: But the things among us do not have their power towards those, nor do those have their power towards us. Rather, as I say, these are what they are, of themselves and in relation to themselves, while things with us are, in like manner, relative to themselves. Or do you not understand what I am saying?”

ἐκείνου δοῦλός ἐστιν, οὐδὲ αὐτοῦ δούλου, ὃ ἔστι δοῦλος, δεσπότης ὁ δεσπότης, ἀλλ’ ἄνθρωπος ὦν ἀνθρώπου ἀμφοτέρω ταῦτ’ ἐστίν· αὐτὴ δὲ δεσποτεία αὐτῆς δουλείας ἐστὶν ὃ ἐστὶ, καὶ δουλεία ὡσαύτως αὐτὴ δουλεία αὐτῆς δεσποτείας, ἀλλ’ οὐ τὰ ἐν ἡμῖν πρὸς ἐκεῖνα τὴν δύναμιν ἔχει οὐδὲ ἐκεῖνα πρὸς ἡμᾶς, ἀλλ’, ὃ λέγω, αὐτὰ αὐτῶν καὶ πρὸς αὐτὰ ἐκεῖνά τέ ἐστι, καὶ

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S: “I understand,” said Socrates, “very much so.”

τὰ παρ’ ἡμῖν ὡσαύτως πρὸς αὐτά. ἢ οὐ μανθάνεις ὃ λέγω; πάνυ γ’, εἰπεῖν τὸν Σωκράτη, μανθάνω. οὐκοῦν καὶ ἐπιστήμη, φάναι, αὐτὴ μὲν ὃ ἔστι ἐπιστήμη τῆς ὃ ἔστιν ἀλήθεια αὐτῆς ἂν ἐκείνης εἴῃ ἐπιστήμη; πάνυ γε. ἐκάστη δὲ αὖ τῶν ἐπιστημῶν, ἢ ἔστιν, ἐκάστου τῶν ὄντων, ὃ ἔστιν,

εἴη ἂν ἐπιστήμη ἢ οὐ; ναί. ἡ δὲ παρ' ἡμῖν ἐπιστήμη οὐ τῆς παρ' ἡμῖν ἂν ἀληθείας εἴη, καὶ αὖ ἐκάστη ἡ παρ' ἡμῖν ἐπιστήμη τῶν παρ' ἡμῖν

PA: “And is it also the case that knowledge itself, what knowledge is, would be knowledge of that truth itself, what truth is?”

S: “Entirely so.”

PA: “Then again, each of the instances of knowledge, what each is, would be knowledge of particular things that are. Isn't this so?”

S: “Yes.”

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PA: “The knowledge with us would be knowledge of the truth with us, and furthermore, particular knowledge with us would turn out to be knowledge of particular things that are with us?”

ὄντων ἐκάστου ἂν ἐπιστήμη συμβαίνοι εἶναι; ἀνάγκη. ἀλλὰ μὴν αὐτά γε τὰ εἶδη, ὡς ὁμολογεῖς, οὔτε ἔχομεν οὔτε παρ' ἡμῖν οἷόν τε εἶναι. οὐ γὰρ οὖν γιγνώσκεται δέ γέ που ὑπ' αὐτοῦ τοῦ εἶδους τοῦ τῆς ἐπιστήμης αὐτὰ τὰ γένη ἃ ἔστιν ἕκαστα; ναί. ὃ γε ἡμεῖς οὐκ ἔχομεν. οὐ γάρ. οὐκ ἄρα ὑπὸ γε ἡμῶν γιγνώσκεται τῶν εἰδῶν οὐδέν, ἐπειδὴ αὐτῆς ἐπιστήμης οὐ μετέχομεν. οὐκ ἔοικεν. ἄγνωστον ἄρα ἡμῖν καὶ αὐτὸ τὸ καλὸν ὃ ἔστι καὶ

S: “Necessarily.”

PA: “But the forms themselves, as you agree, we neither possess nor can they be with us.”

S: “No, indeed not.”

PA: “And presumably each of the kinds themselves is known by the form of knowledge itself?”

S: “Yes.”

PA: “Which we do not possess.”

S: “We do not.”

PA: “So none of the forms is known by us since we do not partake of knowledge itself.”

S: “Apparently not.”

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PA: “So what beauty itself is, and the good, and indeed everything we understand as being characteristics themselves, are unknown to us.”

τὸ ἀγαθὸν καὶ πάντα ἃ δὴ ὡς ιδέας αὐτὰς οὔσας ὑπολαμβάνομεν. κινδυνεύει. ὅρα δὴ ἔτι τούτου δεινότερον τόδε. τὸ ποῖον; φαίης ἄν που, εἴπερ ἔστιν αὐτό τι γένος ἐπιστήμης, πολὺ αὐτὸ ἀκριβέστερον εἶναι ἢ τὴν παρ’ ἡμῖν ἐπιστήμην, καὶ κάλλος καὶ τᾶλλα πάντα οὕτω. ναί. οὐκοῦν εἴπερ τι ἄλλο αὐτῆς ἐπιστήμης μετέχει, οὐκ ἄν τινα μᾶλλον ἢ θεὸν φαίης ἔχειν τὴν ἀκριβεστάτην ἐπιστήμην; ἀνάγκη.

S: “Quite likely.”

PA: “Then consider something even more daunting.”

S: “Which is?”

PA: “You would say, I presume, that if there is indeed a kind, just by itself, of knowledge, it is much more precise than the knowledge with us, and the same holds for beauty and all the others.”

S: “Yes.”

PA: “Now, if anything else partakes of knowledge itself, wouldn’t you say that a god, more so than anyone, possesses the most precise knowledge?”

S: “Necessarily.”

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PA: “In that case, will a god possessing knowledge itself be able to know things in our realm?”

ἄρ’ οὖν οἷός τε αὖ ἔσται ὁ θεὸς τὰ παρ’ ἡμῖν γινώσκειν αὐτὴν ἐπιστήμην ἔχων; τί γὰρ οὐ; ὅτι, ἔφη ὁ Παρμενίδης, ὠμολόγηται ἡμῖν, ὧ Σώκρατες, μῆτε ἐκεῖνα τὰ εἶδη πρὸς τὰ παρ’ ἡμῖν τὴν δύναμιν ἔχειν ἢν

ἔχει, μήτε τὰ παρ' ἡμῖν πρὸς ἐκεῖνα, ἀλλ' αὐτὰ πρὸς αὐτὰ ἐκάτερα. ὠμολόγηται γάρ. οὐκοῦν εἰ παρὰ τῷ θεῷ αὕτη ἐστὶν ἡ ἀκριβεστάτη δεσποτεία καὶ αὕτη ἡ ἀκριβεστάτη ἐπιστήμη, οὐτ' ἂν ἡ δεσποτεία ἢ ἐκείνων ἡμῶν ποτὲ ἂν δεσπόσειεν, οὐτ' ἂν

S: “Why not?”

PA: “Because, Socrates,” said Parmenides, “we have agreed that those forms do not have the power that they have, in relation to the things that are with us, nor do the things with us have their power in relation to those forms. The power in each case is in relation to themselves.”

S: “Yes, we agreed on that.”

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PA: “Well then, if this most precise mastery is with a god, and this most precise knowledge too, the gods’ mastery would never exercise mastery over us, nor would their knowledge know us nor anything else that is with us. Rather, just as we neither rule over them with our rule nor do we know anything of the divine with our knowledge, they in turn by the same argument, are not the masters of us nor do they have knowledge of human affairs, although they are gods.”

ἐπιστήμη ἡμᾶς γνοίη οὐδέ τι ἄλλο τῶν παρ' ἡμῖν, ἀλλὰ ὁμοίως ἡμεῖς τε ἐκείνων οὐκ ἄρχομεν τῇ παρ' ἡμῖν ἀρχῇ οὐδὲ γινώσκουμεν τοῦ θεοῦ οὐδὲν τῇ ἡμετέρᾳ ἐπιστήμῃ, ἐκεῖνοί τε αὖ κατὰ τὸν αὐτὸν λόγον οὔτε δεσπόται ἡμῶν εἰσὶν οὔτε γινώσκουσι τὰ ἀνθρώπεια πράγματα θεοὶ ὄντες. ἀλλὰ μὴ λίαν, ἔφη, ἧ θαυμαστός ὁ λόγος, εἴ τις τὸν θεὸν ἀποστερήσει τοῦ εἰδέναι. ταῦτα μέντοι, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔφη ὁ Παρμενίδης, καὶ ἔτι

S: “But surely if someone were to deprive a god of knowledge, the argument would be most surprising.”

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PA: “Indeed, Socrates,” said Parmenides, “the forms inevitably possess these difficulties and many others besides these, if there are these

characteristics of things that are, and someone marks off each form as something by itself. And the person who hears about them gets perplexed and contends that these forms do not exist, and even if they do it is highly necessary that they be unknowable to human nature. And in saying all this he seems to be making sense, and as we said before, it is extraordinarily difficult to persuade him otherwise. Indeed, this will require a highly gifted

ἄλλα πρὸς τούτοις πάνυ πολλὰ ἀναγκαῖον ἔχειν τὰ εἶδη, εἰ εἰσὶν αὗται αἱ ἰδέαι τῶν ὄντων καὶ ὀριεῖται τις αὐτό τι ἕκαστον εἶδος· ὥστε ἀπορεῖν τε τὸν ἀκούοντα καὶ ἀμφισβητεῖν ὡς οὔτε ἔστι ταῦτα, εἴ τε ὅτι μάλιστα εἴη, πολλὴ ἀνάγκη αὐτὰ εἶναι τῇ ἀνθρωπίνῃ φύσει ἄγνωστα, καὶ ταῦτα λέγοντα δοκεῖν τε τι λέγειν καί, ὃ ἄρτι ἐλέγομεν, θαυμαστῶς ὡς δυσανάπειστον εἶναι. καὶ ἀνδρὸς πάνυ μὲν εὐφυοῦς τοῦ δυνησομένου μαθεῖν ὡς ἔστι γένος τι ἐκάστου καὶ οὐσία αὐτῇ

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PA: man who will have the ability to understand that there is, for each, some kind, a being just by itself, and someone even more extraordinary who will make this discovery and be capable of teaching someone else who has scrutinised all these issues thoroughly enough for himself.”

καθ’ αὐτήν, ἔτι δὲ θαυμαστοτέρου τοῦ εὐρήσοντος καὶ ἄλλον δυνησομένου διδάξαι ταῦτα πάντα ἱκανῶς διευκρινησάμενον. συγχωρῶ σοι, ἔφη, ὦ Παρμενίδη, ὁ Σωκράτης· πάνυ γάρ μοι κατὰ νοῦν λέγεις. ἀλλὰ μέντοι, εἶπεν ὁ Παρμενίδης, εἴ γέ τις δῆ, ὦ Σώκρατες, αὐτὸ μὴ ἔασει εἶδη τῶν ὄντων εἶναι, εἰς πάντα τὰ νυνδὴ καὶ ἄλλα τοιαῦτα ἀποβλέψας, μὴδέ τι ὀριεῖται εἶδος ἑνὸς ἐκάστου, οὐδὲ ὅποι τρέψει τὴν διάνοιαν ἔξει, μὴ ἔω

S: “I agree with you, Parmenides,” said Socrates. “What you are saying is very much to my mind.”

PA: “Yet on the other hand Socrates,” said Parmenides, “if someone, in the light of our present considerations and others like them, will not allow that there are forms of things that are, and won’t mark off a

form for each one, he will not even have anywhere to turn his thought, since he does not allow that a characteristic of each of the things that are is always the same. And in this way he will utterly destroy the power of dialectic. However, I think you are well aware of such an issue.”

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S: “That’s true.”

ιδέαν τῶν ὄντων ἐκάστου τὴν αὐτὴν αἰεὶ εἶναι, καὶ οὕτως τὴν τοῦ διαλέγεσθαι δύνάμιν παντάπασι διαφθερεῖ. τοῦ τοιούτου μὲν οὖν μοι δοκεῖς καὶ μᾶλλον ἡσθῆσθαι. ἀληθῆ λέγεις, φάναι. τί οὖν ποιήσεις φιλοσοφίας πέρι; πῇ τρέψῃ ἀγνοουμένων τούτων; οὐ πάντῃ μοι δοκῶ καθορᾶν ἔν γε τῷ παρόντι. πρῶ γάρ, εἰπεῖν, πρὶν γυμνασθῆναι, ὧ Σώκρατες, ὀρίζεσθαι ἐπιχειρεῖς καλόν τέ τι καὶ δίκαιον καὶ ἀγαθὸν καὶ ἔν

PA: “Well then, what will you do about philosophy? In what direction will you turn while these are unknown?”

S: “Well at the moment I don’t think I can see an answer.”

PA: “Socrates,” said he, “that is because you are trying to mark off something beautiful, just and good, and each one of the forms too soon before you have been trained. Indeed, I noticed this earlier as I listened to you in discussion here with this man Aristoteles. Now, mark my words, although the drive you bring to arguments is noble and divine, you must bestir yourself while you are still young and get more training in something that seems useless and which most people call idle talk, or else the truth will escape you.”

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S: “What is the manner of the training, Parmenides?” he asked.

ἐκαστον τῶν εἰδῶν. ἐνενόησα γὰρ καὶ πρόφην σου ἀκούων διαλεγομένου ἐνθάδε Ἀριστοτέλει τῷδε. καλὴ μὲν οὖν καὶ θεία, εὖ ἴσθι, ἡ ὁρμὴ ἣν ὁρμᾶς ἐπὶ τοὺς λόγους· ἔλκυσσον δὲ σαυτὸν καὶ γύμνασαι μᾶλλον διὰ τῆς δοκούσης ἀχρήστου εἶναι καὶ καλουμένης ὑπὸ τῶν

πολλῶν ἀδολεσχίας, ἕως ἔτι νέος εἶ· εἰ δὲ μή, σὲ διαφεύζεται ἡ ἀλήθεια. τίς οὖν ὁ τρόπος, φάναι, ὦ Παρμενίδη, τῆς γυμνασίας; οὗτος, εἶπεν, ὄνπερ ἤκουσας Ζήνωνος. πλὴν τοῦτό γέ

PA: “The same as what you heard from Zeno,” he replied, “with the following exception. I was indeed delighted when you said that you would not allow the enquiry to be about visible things or to consider their wandering. It was rather to consider things that one apprehends mainly by reason and might think to be forms.”

S: “That,” said he, “is because by the other approach I think it is all too easy to show things that are, being characterised as both like and unlike or as anything else at all.”

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PA: “And you are right to say so,” he said. “But it is also necessary to do something else in addition. It is not enough to consider the consequences that follow from hypothesising that each is, but you must also hypothesise that this same thing is not, if you wish to be better trained.”

σου καὶ πρὸς τοῦτον ἡγάσθην εἰπόντος, ὅτι οὐκ εἷας ἐν τοῖς ὀρωμένοις οὐδὲ περὶ ταῦτα τὴν πλάνην ἐπισκοπεῖν, ἀλλὰ περὶ ἐκεῖνα ἃ μάλιστα τις ἂν λόγῳ λάβοι καὶ εἶδῃ ἂν ἡγήσασαιτο εἶναι. δοκεῖ γάρ μοι, ἔφη, ταύτη γε οὐδὲν χαλεπὸν εἶναι καὶ ὅμοια καὶ ἀνόμοια καὶ ἄλλο ὅτιοῦν τὰ ὄντα πᾶσχοντα ἀποφαίνειν. καὶ καλῶς γ', ἔφη. χρὴ δὲ καὶ τόδε ἔτι πρὸς τούτῳ ποιεῖν, μὴ μόνον εἰ ἔστιν ἕκαστον ὑποτιθέμενον σκοπεῖν τὰ

S: “How do you mean?” he asked.

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PA: “Take for instance, if you like,” said he, “this hypothesis that Zeno proposed, ‘if many are’.⁶ What are the consequences for the many themselves in relation to themselves and in relation to the one, and for the one in relation to itself and in relation to the many. And furthermore, if many are not, you need to consider what the consequences will be both for the one and for the many in relation to themselves and one another. And again, if you hypothesise ‘if likeness

is' or 'if likeness is not', what will follow from either hypothesis, both for the things hypothesised themselves, and for the others, both in relation to themselves and one another. And the same argument applies when dealing

συμβαίνοντα ἐκ τῆς ὑποθέσεως, ἀλλὰ καὶ εἰ μὴ ἔστι τὸ αὐτὸ τοῦτο ὑποτίθεσθαι, εἰ βούλει μᾶλλον γυμνασθῆναι. πῶς λέγεις; φάναι. οἶον, ἔφη, εἰ βούλει, περὶ ταύτης τῆς ὑποθέσεως ἦν Ζήνων ὑπέθετο, εἰ πολλά ἐστι, τί χρή συμβαίνειν καὶ αὐτοῖς τοῖς πολλοῖς πρὸς αὐτὰ καὶ πρὸς τὸ ἓν καὶ τῷ ἓνι πρὸς τε αὐτὸ καὶ πρὸς τὰ πολλά· καὶ αὖ εἰ μὴ ἐστι πολλά, πάλιν σκοπεῖν τί συμβήσεται καὶ τῷ ἓνι καὶ τοῖς πολλοῖς καὶ πρὸς

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PA: with unlikeness, with movement, with rest, with generation, with destruction, with being itself, and with non-being. And in a word, whatever you may ever hypothesise as being, or as not being, or as characterised by any other characteristic whatsoever, you should consider the consequences both in relation to itself and in relation to each of the others, whichever you choose, and in relation to a number of them, and in relation to them all together in the same way, and the others too for their part, both in relation to themselves and in relation to anything else you may ever choose,

αὐτὰ καὶ πρὸς ἄλληλα· καὶ αὖθις αὖ ἐὰν ὑποθῇ εἰ ἔστιν ὁμοιότης ἢ εἰ μὴ ἔστιν, τί ἐφ' ἐκατέρας τῆς ὑποθέσεως συμβήσεται καὶ αὐτοῖς τοῖς ὑποτεθεῖσιν καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις καὶ πρὸς αὐτὰ καὶ πρὸς ἄλληλα. καὶ περὶ ἀνομοίου ὁ αὐτὸς λόγος καὶ περὶ κινήσεως καὶ περὶ στάσεως καὶ περὶ γενέσεως καὶ φθορᾶς καὶ περὶ αὐτοῦ τοῦ εἶναι καὶ τοῦ μὴ εἶναι· καὶ ἐνὶ λόγῳ, περὶ ὅτου ἂν αἰεὶ ὑποθῇ ὡς ὄντος καὶ ὡς οὐκ ὄντος καὶ ὅτι οὖν ἄλλο πάθος πάσχοντος, δεῖ σκοπεῖν τὰ συμβαίνοντα

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PA: whether you hypothesise it as being or as not being, if you are to be perfectly trained to have a supreme vision of the truth."

πρὸς αὐτὸ καὶ πρὸς ἓν ἕκαστον τῶν ἄλλων, ὅτι ἂν προέλῃ, καὶ πρὸς πλείῳ καὶ πρὸς σύμπαντα ὡσαύτως· καὶ τᾶλλα αὖ πρὸς αὐτὰ τε καὶ πρὸς

ἄλλο ὅτι ἂν προαιρῇ αἰεὶ, ἐάντε ὡς ὃν ὑποθῇ ὃ ὑπετίθεσο, ἄντε ὡς μὴ ὄν, εἰ μέλλεις τελέως γυμνασάμενος κυρίως διόψεσθαι τὸ ἀληθές, ἀμήχανόν γ' ἔφη, λέγεις, ὦ Παρμενίδη, πραγματεῖαν, καὶ οὐ σφόδρα μανθάνω. ἀλλὰ μοι τί οὐ διήλθες αὐτὸς ὑποθέμενός τι, ἵνα μᾶλλον καταμάθω;

S: “Parmenides,” said he, “you are describing an enormous undertaking which I do not really understand. Why don’t you go through the process yourself for me by hypothesising something so that I may better understand this.”

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PA: “For a man of my age, Socrates,” he replied, “you are assigning a huge task.”

πολὺ ἔργον, φάναι, ὦ Σώκρατες, προστάττεις ὡς τηλικῶδε. ἀλλὰ σύ, εἰπεῖν τὸν Σωκράτη, Ζήνων, τί οὐ διήλθες ἡμῖν; καὶ τὸν Ζήνωνα ἔφη γελάσαντα φάναι αὐτοῦ, ὦ Σώκρατες, δεώμεθα Παρμενίδου· μὴ γὰρ οὐ φαῦλον ἢ ὃ λέγει. ἢ οὐχ ὁρᾷς ὅσον ἔργον προστάττεις; εἰ μὲν οὖν πλείους ἦμεν, οὐκ ἂν ἄξιον ἦν δεῖσθαι· ἀπρεπῇ γὰρ τὰ τοιαῦτα πολλῶν ἐναντίον λέγειν ἄλλως τε καὶ τηλικούτῳ.

S: “Well, Zeno,” said Socrates, “why don’t you go through a hypothesis for us?”

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And Pythodorus said that Zeno laughed and replied,

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Z: “We should ask Parmenides himself, for he is describing something that is far from commonplace. Don’t you see the extent of the task you are assigning him? Now, if there were more of us here it wouldn’t be right to ask him, for it is not appropriate to speak of such matters in front of lots of people, especially at his age. Indeed, most people are unaware that without this detailed and extensive exploration it is impossible to encounter the truth and acquire reason. And so, Parmenides, I join Socrates in his request so that I too may hear you out to the very end after all these years.”

ἀγνοοῦσιν γὰρ οἱ πολλοὶ ὅτι ἄνευ ταύτης τῆς διὰ πάντων διεξόδου τε καὶ πλάνης ἀδύνατον ἐντυχόντα τῷ ἀληθεῖ νοῦν σχεῖν. ἐγὼ μὲν οὖν, ὦ Παρμενίδη, Σωκράτει συνδέομαι, ἵνα καὶ αὐτὸς διακούσω διὰ χρόνου. ταῦτα δὲ εἰπόντος τοῦ Ζήνωνος, ἔφη ὁ Ἀντιφῶν φάναι τὸν Πυθόδωρον, αὐτόν τε δεῖσθαι τοῦ Παρμενίδου καὶ τὸν Ἀριστοτέλη καὶ τοὺς ἄλλους, ἐνδείξασθαι ὃ λέγοι καὶ μὴ ἄλλως ποιεῖν. τὸν οὖν Παρμενίδην· ἀνάγκη, φάναι, πείθεσθαι. καίτοι δοκῶ μοι τὸ τοῦ Ἴβυκείου ἵππου πεπονθέναι,

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When Zeno had said all this, Antiphon told us that Pythodorus said that he himself, along with Aristoteles and the others, implored Parmenides to demonstrate what he was speaking of, nothing else would do. So Parmenides said,

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PA: “I must comply although I feel as if I am in the same predicament as the horse in Ibycus’ poem,⁷ the aged competitor who is about to compete in a chariot race and, because of past experience, trembles at the prospect. The poet comparing himself to this animal said that he himself, an old man, was being compelled against his will to embark upon amorous pursuits. And as I think back, I too, it seems, am fearful as to how at my age I am to swim across such a vast sea of arguments. Nevertheless, I should oblige you since indeed, as Zeno says, we are by ourselves. So, where shall we begin and what shall we hypothesise first? Or

ὦ ἐκεῖνος ἀθλητῇ ὄντι καὶ πρεσβυτέρῳ, ὅφ’ ἄρματι μέλλοντι ἀγωνιεῖσθαι καὶ δι’ ἐμπειρίαν τρέμοντι τὸ μέλλον, ἑαυτὸν ἀπεικάζων ἄκων ἔφη καὶ αὐτὸς οὕτω πρεσβύτης ὢν εἰς τὸν ἔρωτα ἀναγκάζεσθαι ἰέναι· κἀγὼ μοι δοκῶ μεμνημένος μάλα φοβεῖσθαι πῶς χρὴ τηλικόνδε ὄντα διανεῦσαι τοιοῦτόν τε καὶ τοσοῦτον πέλαγος λόγων· ὅμως δὲ δεῖ γὰρ χαρίζεσθαι, ἐπειδὴ καί, ὃ Ζήνων λέγει, αὐτοῖ ἐσμεν. πόθεν οὖν δὴ

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PA: since it seems I am to play this laborious game, would you like me to begin with myself and my own hypothesis by hypothesising about

the one itself, and what the consequences must be if it is one or not one?”⁸

ἀρξόμεθα καὶ τί πρῶτον ὑποθησόμεθα; ἢ βούλεσθε, ἐπειδήπερ δοκεῖ πραγματεῖωδὴ παιδιὰν παίζειν, ἀπ’ ἐμαυτοῦ ἄρξωμαι καὶ τῆς ἐμαυτοῦ ὑποθέσεως, περὶ τοῦ ἐνὸς αὐτοῦ ὑποθέμενος, εἴτε ἓν ἐστὶν εἴτε μὴ ἓν, τί χρὴ συμβαίνειν; πάνυ μὲν οὖν, φάναι τὸν Ζήνωνα. τίς οὖν, εἰπεῖν, μοὶ ἀποκρινεῖται; ἢ ὁ νεώτατος; ἥκιστα γὰρ ἂν πολυπραγμονοῖ, καὶ ἃ οἴεται μάλιστα ἂν ἀποκρίνοιτο· καὶ ἅμα ἐμοὶ ἀνάπαυλα ἂν εἴη ἢ ἐκείνου ἀπόκρισις.

Z: “Yes, certainly,” said Zeno.

PA: “Who,” asked Parmenides, “will respond to me? Perhaps the youngest? Yes, he will make least trouble and will be most inclined to answer based upon what he thinks, and at the same time his answering would give me a rest.”

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AR: “I’m ready for that, Parmenides,” said Aristoteles, “since you are referring to me when you refer to the youngest. So ask your questions and I will answer you.”

137c

PA: “Very well,” said he. “If one is,⁹ the one would not be many, would it?”

ἔτοιμός σοι, ὦ Παρμενίδη, φάναι, τοῦτο, τὸν Ἀριστοτέλη· ἐμὲ γὰρ λέγεις τὸν νεώτατον λέγων. ἀλλὰ ἐρώτα ὡς ἀποκρινουμένου. εἶεν δὴ, φάναι· εἰ ἓν ἐστὶν, ἄλλο τι οὐκ ἂν εἴη πολλὰ τὸ ἓν; πῶς γὰρ ἂν; οὔτε ἄρα μέρος αὐτοῦ οὔτε ὅλον αὐτὸ δεῖ εἶναι. τί δὴ; τὸ μέρος που ὅλου μέρος ἐστίν. ναί. τί δὲ τὸ ὅλον; οὐχὶ οὗ ἂν μέρος μὴδὲν ἀπὴ ὅλον ἂν εἴη; πάνυ γε. ἀμφοτέρως ἄρα τὸ ἓν ἐκ μερῶν ἂν εἴη, ὅλον τε ὃν καὶ μέρη ἔχον. ἀνάγκη. ἀμφοτέρως ἂν ἄρα

AR: “No, how could it be?”

PA: “So, of this there is no part, neither could it be a whole.”

AR: “Why is that?”

PA: “The part is presumably part of a whole.”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “And what about the whole? Wouldn’t that from which no part is missing be a whole?”

AR: “Certainly.”

PA: “So in both cases the one would consist of parts both by constituting a whole and by having parts.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

137d

PA: “So in both cases the one would thus be many, but not one.”

οὕτως τὸ ἐν πολλὰ εἶη ἀλλ’ οὐχ ἓν. ἀληθῆ. δεῖ δέ γε μὴ πολλὰ ἀλλ’ ἐν αὐτὸ εἶναι. δεῖ. οὐτ’ ἄρα ὅλον ἔσται οὔτε μέρη ἔξει, εἰ ἐν ἔσται τὸ ἓν. οὐ γάρ. οὐκοῦν εἰ μηδὲν ἔχει μέρος, οὐτ’ ἂν ἀρχὴν οὔτε τελευτὴν οὔτε μέσον ἔχοι· μέρη γὰρ ἂν ἤδη αὐτοῦ τὰ τοιαῦτα εἶη. ὀρθῶς. καὶ μὴν τελευτὴ γε καὶ ἀρχὴ πέρας ἐκάστου. πῶς δ’ οὐ; ἄπειρον ἄρα τὸ ἓν, εἰ μήτε ἀρχὴν μήτε τελευτὴν ἔχει. ἄπειρον. καὶ ἄνευ σχήματος ἄρα οὔτε γὰρ

AR: “True.”

PA: “But it should not be many, but just one.”

AR: “It should.”

PA: “So, if the one is to be one, it will neither be a whole nor will it have parts.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “Now, if it does not have a part it would not have a beginning, an end, or a middle, for these sorts of things would already be parts of it.”

AR: “Correct.”

PA: “And indeed, a beginning and an end are a limit of each thing.”

AR: “Of course.”

137e

PA: “So the one is limitless if it has neither a beginning nor an end.”

στρογγύλου οὔτε εὐθέος μετέχει. πῶς; στρογγύλον γέ πού ἐστι τοῦτο οὗ ἂν τὰ ἔσχατα πανταχῇ ἀπὸ τοῦ μέσου ἴσον ἀπέχῃ. ναί. καὶ μὴν εὐθύ γε, οὗ ἂν τὸ μέσον ἀμφοῖν τοῖν ἐσχάτοιν ἐπίπροσθεν ᾗ. οὕτως. οὐκοῦν μέρη ἂν ἔχοι τὸ ἐν καὶ πολλὰ ἂν εἴη, εἴτε εὐθέος σχήματος εἴτε περιφεροῦς μετέχοι. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. οὔτε ἄρα εὐθὺ οὔτε

AR: “Limitless.”

PA: “So it is without shape, for it partakes neither of round nor straight.”

AR: “How so?”

PA: “Well, whatever has its extremities everywhere the same distance from the middle is presumably round.”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “And indeed, something is straight if the middle intercepts both extremities.”

AR: “Quite so.”

PA: “Then the one would have parts and would be many if it were to partake of straight or round shape.”

AR: “Yes certainly.”

PA: “So it is neither straight nor round since, in fact, it does not have parts.”

AR: “Correct.”

138a

PA: “And indeed, being like this, it would be nowhere at all, for it would neither be in another nor in itself.”

περιφερές ἐστίν, ἐπεὶ οὐδὲ μέρη ἔχει. ὀρθῶς. καὶ μὴν τοιοῦτόν γε ὄν οὐδαμοῦ ἂν εἴη· οὐτε γὰρ ἐν ἄλλῳ οὔτε ἐν ἑαυτῷ εἴη. πῶς δὴ; ἐν ἄλλῳ μὲν ὄν κύκλῳ που ἂν περιέχοιτο ὑπ' ἐκείνου ἐν ᾧ ἐνείη, καὶ πολλαχοῦ ἂν αὐτοῦ ἄπτοιτο πολλοῖς· τοῦ δὲ ἐνός τε καὶ ἀμεροῦς καὶ κύκλου μὴ μετέχοντος ἀδύνατον πολλαχῇ κύκλῳ ἄπτεσθαι. ἀδύνατον. ἀλλὰ μὴν αὐτό γε ἐν ἑαυτῷ ὄν καὶ ἐν ἑαυτῷ εἴη περιέχον οὐκ ἄλλο ἢ αὐτό, εἴπερ καὶ ἐν

AR: “How so?”

PA: “Being in another, it would presumably be encompassed in a circle by whatever it was contained in, and would touch this in many places with many parts. However, since it is one, and devoid of parts, and does not partake of circularity, it is impossible for it to touch in many places in a circle.”

AR: “Impossible.”

138b

PA: “Then again, being in itself it would, by itself, encompass nothing other than itself, if it were actually in itself, for it is impossible for anything to be in something and not be encompassed by it.”

ἐαυτῷ εἴη· ἐν τῷ γὰρ τι εἶναι μὴ περιέχοντι ἀδύνατον. ἀδύνατον γάρ. οὐκοῦν ἕτερον μὲν ἂν τι εἴη αὐτὸ τὸ περιέχον, ἕτερον δὲ τὸ περιεχόμενον· οὐ γὰρ ὅλον γε ἅμφω ταῦτόν ἅμα πείσεται καὶ ποιήσει· καὶ οὕτω τὸ ἐν οὐκ ἂν εἴη ἔτι ἐν ἄλλῳ δύο. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. οὐκ ἄρα ἐστίν που τὸ ἐν, μήτε ἐν αὐτῷ μήτε ἐν ἄλλῳ ἐνόν. οὐκ ἔστιν. ὅρα δὴ, οὕτως ἔχον εἰ οἷόν τέ ἐστιν ἐστάναι ἢ κινεῖσθαι. τί δὴ γὰρ οὐ; ὅτι κινούμενόν γε ἢ φέροιτο ἢ

AR: “Impossible, indeed.”

PA: “In that case, whatever encompasses would be one thing, and whatever is encompassed would be another, for the same thing will not simultaneously, as a whole, be both active and passive, and thus the one would no longer be one but two.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “So the one is not anywhere, neither in itself nor in another.”

AR: “It is not.”

138c

PA: “This being the case, consider whether it can be at rest or in motion.”

ἀλλοιοῖτο ἄν· αὐταὶ γὰρ μόναι κινήσεις. ναί. ἀλλοιούμενον δὲ τὸ ἐν ἑαυτοῦ ἀδύνατον· που ἐν ἔτι εἶναι. ἀδύνατον. οὐκ ἄρα κατ’ ἀλλοιώσιν γε κινεῖται. οὐ φαίνεται. ἀλλ’ ἄρα τῷ φέρεσθαι; ἴσως. καὶ μὴν εἰ φέροιτο τὸ ἐν, ἦτοι ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ ἂν περιφέροιτο κύκλῳ ἢ μεταλλάττοι χώραν ἑτέραν ἐξ ἑτέρας. ἀνάγκη. οὐκοῦν κύκλῳ μὲν περιφερόμενον ἐπὶ μέσου βεβηκέναι ἀνάγκη, καὶ τὰ περὶ τὸ μέσον φερόμενα ἄλλα μέρη ἔχειν ἑαυτοῦ· ὧς δὲ

AR: “Why could it not be?”

PA: “Because being in motion it would either be transported or altered, for these are the only motions.”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “But it is impossible, presumably, for the one still to be one while being altered from itself.”

AR: “Impossible.”

PA: “So it does not move by alteration at least.”

AR: “Apparently not.”

PA: “In that case, is it transported?”

AR: “Perhaps.”

PA: “And yet, if the one were transported it would either be borne around in a circle in the same place, or change location from one place to another.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

138d

PA: “Now, being borne around in a circle, it must stand upon a centre and have all that is borne around that centre as other parts of itself. But in what way is that to which neither centre nor parts belong, ever to be borne in a circle upon a centre?”

μήτε μέσου μήτε μερῶν προσήκει, τίς μηχανή τοῦτο κύκλῳ ποτ’ ἐπὶ τοῦ μέσου ἐνεχθῆναι; οὐδεμία. ἀλλὰ δὴ χώραν ἀμείβον ἄλλοτ’ ἄλλοθι γίγνεται καὶ οὕτω κινεῖται; εἴπερ γε δὴ. οὐκοῦν εἶναι μὲν που ἔν τινι αὐτῷ ἀδύνατον ἐφάνη; ναί. ἄρ’ οὖν γίγνεσθαι ἔτι ἀδυνατώτερον; οὐκ ἐννοῶ ὅπη. εἰ ἔν τῷ τι γίγνεται, οὐκ ἀνάγκη μήτε πῶ ἐν ἐκείνῳ εἶναι ἔτι ἐγγιγνόμενον, μήτ’ ἔτι ἔξω ἐκείνου παντάπασιν, εἴπερ ἤδη ἐγγίγνεται; ἀνάγκη. εἰ ἄρα τι

AR: “There is no way.”

PA: “Well then, does it come to be in different places at different times by changing place? Is that how it moves?”

AR: “If it actually does move.”

PA: “Didn’t it appear impossible for it to be somewhere, in something?”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “So isn’t it even more impossible for it to come to be somewhere in something?”

AR: “I don’t understand how.”

PA: “If it is coming to be in something, isn’t it necessary that it not yet be in that something while it is still coming to be in that? Nor can it still be entirely outside that if indeed it is already coming to be in it.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

138e

PA: “Now, if this is to happen to anything, it could only happen to something that has parts, for some of it could already be in that thing while, at the same time, some is outside. But that which has no parts

will presumably not be able, in any way, to be neither wholly inside something nor wholly outside, at the same time.”

ἄλλο πείσεται τοῦτο, ἐκεῖνο ἂν μόνον πάσχοι οὐ μέρη εἶη· τὸ μὲν γὰρ ἂν τι αὐτοῦ ἦδη ἐν ἐκείνῳ, τὸ δὲ ἔξω εἶη ἅμα· τὸ δὲ μὴ ἔχον μέρη οὐχ οἶόν τέ που ἔσται τρόπῳ οὐδενὶ ὅλον ἅμα μήτε ἐντὸς εἶναι τινος μήτε ἔξω. ἀληθῆ. οὐ δὲ μήτε μέρη εἰσὶ μήτε ὅλον τυγχάνει ὄν, οὐ πολὺ ἔτι ἀδυνατώτερον ἐγγίγνεσθαι που, μήτε κατὰ μέρη μήτε κατὰ ὅλον ἐγγιγνόμενον; φαίνεται. οὐτ’ ἄρα ποιῶν καὶ ἔν

AR: “True.”

PA: “But isn’t it even more impossible for that which has no parts and is not a whole, to come to be in something, somewhere, since it cannot come to be in something else, either part by part, or as a whole?”

AR: “Apparently.”

139a

PA: “So it does not change place by going somewhere or coming to be in something, nor is it borne about in the same place, nor is it altered.”

τῷ γιγνόμενον χώραν ἀλλάττει, οὐτ’ ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ περιφερόμενον οὔτε ἀλλοιούμενον. οὐκ ἔοικε. κατὰ πᾶσαν ἄρα κίνησιν τὸ ἐν ἀκίνητον. ἀκίνητον. ἀλλὰ μὴν καὶ εἶναι γέ φαμεν ἔν τινι αὐτὸ ἀδύνατον. φαιμέν γάρ. οὐδ’ ἄρα ποτὲ ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ ἐστίν. τί δὴ; ὅτι ἦδη ἂν ἐν ἐκείνῳ εἶη ἐν ᾧ τῷ αὐτῷ ἐστίν. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ἀλλ’ οὔτε ἐν αὐτῷ οὔτε ἐν ἄλλῳ οἶόν τε ἦν αὐτῷ ἐνεῖναι. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. οὐδέποτε ἄρα ἐστὶ τὸ ἐν ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ. οὐκ ἔοικεν.

AR: “It seems not.”

PA: “So, on the basis of every movement, the one is unmoving.”

AR: “Unmoving.”

PA: “And yet we also say that it cannot be in something.”

AR: “Yes, so we say.”

PA: “So it is never in the same.”

AR: “Why?”

PA: “Because it would then be in that, in the same that it is in.”

AR: “Certainly.”

PA: “But it was unable to be either in itself or in another.”

AR: “It was indeed.”

PA: “So the one is never in the same.”

AR: “It seems not.”

139b

PA: “But that which is never in the same is neither still nor at rest.”

ἀλλὰ μὴν τό γε μηδέποτε ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ ὃν οὔτε ἡσυχίαν ἄγει οὔθ' ἔστηκεν. οὐ γὰρ οἶόν τε. τὸ ἐν ἅρα, ὡς ἔοικεν, οὔτε ἔστηκεν οὔτε κινεῖται. οὐκ οὖν δὴ φαίνεται γε. οὐδὲ μὴν ταυτόν γε οὔτε ἐτέρῳ οὔτε ἑαυτῷ ἔσται, οὐδ' αὖ ἕτερον οὔτε αὐτοῦ οὔτε ἐτέρου ἂν εἴη. πῇ δὴ; ἕτερον μὲν που ἑαυτοῦ ὃν ἐνὸς ἕτερον ἂν εἴη καὶ οὐκ ἂν εἴη ἓν. ἀληθῆ. καὶ μὴν ταυτόν γε ἐτέρῳ ὃν ἐκεῖνο ἂν εἴη, αὐτὸ

AR: “Indeed, it cannot be.”

PA: “So the one, it seems, is neither at rest nor in motion.”

AR: “Yes, so it appears anyway.”

139c

PA: “Then it will neither be the same as another or itself, nor would it be different from itself or from another.”

δ' οὐκ ἂν εἴη ὥστε οὐδ' ἂν οὕτως εἴη ὅπερ ἔστιν, ἓν, ἀλλ' ἕτερον ἐνός. οὐ γὰρ οὔν. ταυτόν μὲν ἅρα ἐτέρῳ ἢ ἕτερον ἑαυτοῦ οὐκ ἔσται. οὐ γάρ. ἕτερον δέ γε ἐτέρου οὐκ ἔσται, ἕως ἂν ᾗ ἓν. οὐ γὰρ ἐνὶ προσήκει ἐτέρῳ τινὸς εἶναι, ἀλλὰ μόνῳ ἐτέρῳ ἐτέρου, ἄλλῳ δὲ οὐδενί. ὁρθῶς. τῷ μὲν ἅρα ἐν εἶναι οὐκ ἔσται ἕτερον· ἢ οἶε; οὐ δῆτα. ἀλλὰ μὴν εἰ μὴ τούτῳ, οὐχ ἑαυτῷ ἔσται, εἰ δὲ μὴ αὐτῷ, οὐδὲ αὐτό. αὐτὸ δὲ μηδαμῇ ὃν ἕτερον οὐδενὸς ἔσται

AR: “Why is that?”

PA: “Being somehow different from itself, it would be different from one and would not be one.”

AR: “True.”

PA: “And indeed, being the same as another it would be that and not itself, and so in this way it would not be just what it is, namely one, it would rather be different from one.

AR: “Indeed.”

PA: “So it will not be the same as another, or different from itself.”

AR: “It will not.”

PA: “Yes, and it will not be different from another as long as it is one, for it does not belong to the one to be different from anything. It belongs rather to different alone, and to nothing else to be different from another.”

AR: “Correct.”

PA: “So it will not be different by being one. Or do you think it could?”

AR: “Of course not.”

139d

PA: “And yet, if it will not be different by this, it will not be so by itself, and if not by itself it will not, itself, be different, and being in no way different itself it will be different from nothing.”

ἕτερον. ὀρθῶς. οὐδὲ μὴν ταυτόν γε ἑαυτῷ ἔσται. πῶς δ' οὐ; οὐχ ἥπερ τοῦ ἑνὸς φύσις, αὐτὴ δὴπου καὶ τοῦ ταύτου. τί δὴ; ὅτι οὐκ, ἐπειδὴν ταυτόν γένηται τῷ τι, ἐν γίγνεται. ἀλλὰ τί μὴν; τοῖς πολλοῖς ταυτόν γενόμενον πολλὰ ἀνάγκη γίγνεσθαι ἀλλ' οὐχ ἓν. ἀληθῆ. ἀλλ' εἰ τὸ ἐν καὶ τὸ ταυτόν μηδαμῇ διαφέρει, ὁπότε τι ταυτόν ἐγίγνετο, ἀεὶ ἂν ἐν ἐγίγνετο, καὶ ὁπότε ἓν, ταυτόν.

AR: “Correct.”

PA: “Nor indeed will it be the same as itself.”

AR: “Why not?”

PA: “The nature of the one is not of course the nature of the same.”

AR: “Why is that?”

PA: “Because once something has become the same as something, it does not become one.”

AR: “What happens?”

PA: “Having become the same as many, it must become many and not one.”

AR: “True.”

PA: “But if the one and the same did not differ at all, whenever something became the same it would always come to be one, and whenever it became one it would always come to be the same.”

AR: “Certainly.”

139e

PA: “So, if the one is to be the same as itself, it will not be one with itself, and accordingly, although it is one, it will not be one. But this is indeed impossible. So it is impossible for the one either to be different from another or the same as itself.”

πάνυ γε. εἰ ἄρα τὸ ἐν ἑαυτῷ ταῦτόν ἐσται, οὐχ ἐν ἑαυτῷ ἔσται· καὶ οὕτω ἐν ὃν οὐχ ἐν ἔσται. ἀλλὰ μὴν τοῦτό γε ἀδύνατον· ἀδύνατον ἄρα καὶ τῷ ἐνὶ ἡ ἑτέρου ἕτερον εἶναι ἢ ἑαυτῷ ταῦτόν. ἀδύνατον. οὕτω δὴ ἕτερόν γε ἢ ταῦτόν τὸ ἐν οὔτ' ἂν αὐτῷ οὔτ' ἂν ἐτέρῳ εἴη. οὐ γὰρ οὔν. οὐδὲ μὴν ὁμοίον τινι ἔσται οὐδ' ἀνόμοιον οὔτε αὐτῷ οὔτε ἐτέρῳ. τί δὴ; ὅτι τὸ ταῦτόν που πεπονθὸς ὁμοιον. ναί. τοῦ δέ γε ἐνὸς χωρὶς ἐφάνη τὴν φύσιν τὸ ταῦτόν.

AR: “Impossible.”

PA: “In this way then, the one would neither be different from, nor the same as, itself or another.”

AR: “It would not.”

PA: “Nor indeed will it be like or unlike anything, either itself or another.”

AR: “Why is that?”

PA: “Because whatever is characterised as the same is presumably like.”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “But the same appeared to be separate in nature from the one.”

AR: “So it appeared.”

PA: “And yet if the one were characterised as anything besides being one, it would be characterised as being more than one, and that is impossible.”

AR: “Yes.”

140a

PA: “So the one is not characterised as being like either another or itself.”

ἐφάνη γάρ. ἀλλὰ μὴν εἴ τι πέπονθε χωρὶς τοῦ ἔν εἶναι τὸ ἔν, πλείω ἂν εἶναι πεπόνθοι ἢ ἔν, τοῦτο δὲ ἀδύνατον. ναί. οὐδαμῶς ἔστιν ἄρα ταῦτὸν πεπονθὸς εἶναι τὸ ἔν οὔτε ἄλλω οὔτε ἑαυτῷ. οὐ φαίνεται. οὐδὲ ὅμοιον ἄρα δυνατόν αὐτὸ εἶναι οὔτε ἄλλω οὔτε ἑαυτῷ. οὐκ ὅμοιον. οὐδὲ μὴν ἕτερόν γε πέπονθεν εἶναι τὸ ἔν· καὶ γὰρ οὕτω πλείω ἂν πεπόνθοι εἶναι ἢ ἔν. πλείω γάρ. τό γε μὴν ἕτερον πεπονθὸς ἢ ἑαυτοῦ ἢ ἄλλου ἀνόμοιον ἂν εἴη ἢ ἑαυτῷ

AR: “Apparently not.”

PA: “So it cannot be like either another or itself.”

AR: “It seems not.”

PA: “Nor indeed is the one characterised as being different, for in this way too it would be characterised as being more than one.”

AR: “More indeed.”

140b

PA: “And yet whatever is characterised as different from itself or another would be unlike itself or another, since whatever is characterised as the same is like.”

ἢ ἄλλω, εἴπερ τὸ ταῦτὸν πεπονθὸς ὅμοιον. ὀρθῶς. τὸ δέ γε ἔν, ὡς
 ἔοικεν, οὐδαμῶς ἕτερον πεπονθὸς οὐδαμῶς ἀνόμοιον ἔστιν οὔτε αὐτῷ
 οὔτε ἑτέρῳ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. οὔτε ἄρα ὅμοιον οὔτε ἀνόμοιον οὔθ' ἑτέρῳ
 οὔτε ἑαυτῷ ἂν εἴη τὸ ἔν. οὐ φαίνεται. καὶ μὴν τοιοῦτόν γε ὃν οὔτε ἴσον
 οὔτε ἄνισον ἔσται οὔτε ἑαυτῷ οὔτε ἄλλω. πῆ; ἴσον μὲν ὃν τῶν αὐτῶν
 μέτρων ἔσται ἐκείνῳ ᾧ ἂν ἴσον ᾗ. ναί. μείζον δέ που

AR: “Correct.”

PA: “Then the one, it seems, is not characterised as being in any way different from, or in any way unlike, either itself or another.”

AR: “It is not.”

PA: “So the one would neither be like, nor unlike, either itself or another.”

AR: “Apparently not.”

PA: “And indeed, being like this, it will be neither equal nor unequal to itself or another.”

AR: “Why is that?”

PA: “Being equal it will be of the same measures as that to which it is equal.”

AR: “Yes.”

140c

PA: “And presumably, if it is greater or lesser it will have more measures than whatever is lesser than it, and fewer measures than whatever is greater, in cases where it is commensurable.”

ἢ ἕλαττον ὃν, οἷς μὲν ἂν σύμμετρον ᾗ, τῶν μὲν ἐλαττόνων πλείω μέτρα
 ἔξει, τῶν δὲ μειζόνων ἐλάττω. ναί. οἷς δ' ἂν μὴ σύμμετρον, τῶν μὲν

σμικροτέρων, τῶν δὲ μειζόνων μέτρων ἔσται. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; οὐκοῦν ἀδύνατον τὸ μὴ μετέχον τοῦ αὐτοῦ ἢ μέτρων τῶν αὐτῶν εἶναι ἢ ἄλλων ὠντινωοῦν τῶν αὐτῶν; ἀδύνατον. ἴσον μὲν ἄρα οὐτ' ἂν ἑαυτῷ οὔτε ἄλλῳ εἴη μὴ τῶν αὐτῶν μέτρων ὄν. οὐκ οὖν φαίνεται γέ. ἀλλὰ μὴν πλειόνων γέ μέτρων ὄν ἢ ἐλαττόνων, ὅσων περ μέτρων, τοσοῦτων καὶ μερῶν ἂν εἴη καὶ

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “But in cases where it is not commensurable, its measures will be either smaller or greater.”

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “Now, isn’t it impossible for that which does not partake of the same, to be of the same measures or the same anything else at all?”

AR: “Impossible.”

PA: “In that case, since it is not of the same measures, it would not be equal either to itself or to another.”

AR: “Well, it certainly appears not.”

140d

PA: “Furthermore, being of more measures, or of fewer, it would have as many parts as it has measures, and thus the one would again be one no longer but as many as its measures.”

οὕτω αὖ οὐκέτι ἓν ἔσται ἀλλὰ τοσαῦτα ὅσα περ καὶ τὰ μέτρα. ὁρθῶς. εἰ δέ γε ἐνὸς μέτρου εἴη, ἴσον ἂν γίγνοιτο τῷ μέτρῳ· τοῦτο δὲ ἀδύνατον ἐφάνη, ἴσον τῷ αὐτῷ εἶναι. ἐφάνη γάρ. οὔτε ἄρα ἐνὸς μέτρου μετέχον οὔτε πολλῶν οὔτε ὀλίγων, οὔτε τὸ παράπαν τοῦ αὐτοῦ μετέχον, οὔτε ἑαυτῷ ποτε, ὥς ἔοικεν, ἔσται ἴσον οὔτε ἄλλῳ· οὔτε αὖ μείζον οὐδὲ ἑλαττον οὔτε ἑαυτοῦ οὔτε ἑτέρου. παντάπασιν μὲν οὖν οὕτω.

AR: “Correct.”

PA: “But if it was of one measure it would become equal to that measure, but this appeared impossible; it was impossible for the one to

be equal to anything.”

AR: “It appeared so indeed.”

PA: “So, since the one neither partakes of one measure nor many nor few, and does not at all partake of the same, it will never, it seems, be equal to itself or to another, nor again will it be greater or lesser than itself or another.”

AR: “Entirely so.”

140e

PA: “What about this? Does the one seem capable of being older or younger or the same age as anything?”

τί δέ; πρεσβύτερον ἢ νεώτερον ἢ τὴν αὐτὴν ἡλικίαν ἔχειν τὸ ἐν δοκεῖ τῷ δυνατὸν εἶναι; τί δὴ γὰρ οὐ; ὅτι που ἡλικίαν μὲν τὴν αὐτὴν ἔχον ἢ αὐτῷ ἢ ἄλλῳ ἰσότητος χρόνου καὶ ὁμοιότητος μετέξει, ὧν ἐλέγομεν οὐ μετεῖναι τῷ ἐνί, οὔτε ὁμοιότητος οὔτε ἰσότητος. ἐλέγομεν γὰρ οὖν. καὶ μὴν καὶ ὅτι ἀνομοιοτήτός τε καὶ ἀνισότητος οὐ μετέχει, καὶ τοῦτο ἐλέγομεν. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. πῶς οὖν

AR: “Why could it not be?”

PA: “Because being the same age as itself or another it would partake of equality of time, and of likeness, and we said that the one does not partake either of likeness or of equality.”

AR: “We said so indeed.”

PA: “And indeed, we also said that it does not partake of unlikeness and inequality.”

AR: “Yes, certainly.”

141a

PA: “Well then, since it is like this, in what way can it be older or younger or the same age as anything?”

οἷόν τε ἔσται τινὸς ἢ πρεσβύτερον ἢ νεώτερον εἶναι ἢ τὴν αὐτὴν ἡλικίαν ἔχειν τῷ τοιοῦτον ὄν; οὐδαμῶς. οὐκ ἄρα ἂν εἴη νεώτερόν γε

οὐδὲ πρεσβύτερον οὐδὲ τὴν αὐτὴν ἡλικίαν ἔχον τὸ ἐν οὔτε αὐτῷ οὔτε ἄλλῳ. οὐ φαίνεται. ἄρ' οὖν οὐδὲ ἐν χρόνῳ τὸ παράπαν δύναιτο ἂν εἶναι τὸ ἐν, εἰ τοιοῦτον εἴη; ἢ οὐκ ἀνάγκη, ἐάν τι ᾗ ἐν χρόνῳ, ἀεὶ αὐτὸ αὐτοῦ πρεσβύτερον γίγνεσθαι; ἀνάγκη. οὐκοῦν τό γε πρεσβύτερον ἀεὶ νεωτέρου πρεσβύτερον; τί μήν;

AR: “There is no way.”

PA: “So the one could not be younger or older or the same age either as itself or another.”

AR: “It appears not.”

PA: “Well then, if it were like this, would the one actually be able to be in time at all? Or if something is in time, must it not necessarily be constantly becoming older than itself?”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “Isn’t the older always older than the younger?”

AR: “Indeed.”

141b

PA: “So, whatever is becoming older than itself is also becoming younger than itself at the same time, if indeed it is going to have something to become older than.”

τὸ πρεσβύτερον ἄρα ἑαυτοῦ γιγνόμενον καὶ νεώτερον ἑαυτοῦ ἅμα γίγνεται, εἴπερ μέλλει ἔχειν ὅτου πρεσβύτερον γίγνηται. πῶς λέγεις; ὥδε· διάφορον ἕτερον ἑτέρου οὐδὲν δεῖ γίγνεσθαι ἤδη ὄντος διαφόρου, ἀλλὰ τοῦ μὲν ἤδη ὄντος ἤδη εἶναι, τοῦ δὲ γεγονότος γεγονέναι, τοῦ δὲ μέλλοντος μέλλειν, τοῦ δὲ γιγνομένου οὔτε γεγονέναι οὔτε μέλλειν οὔτε εἶναι πῶ διάφορον, ἀλλὰ γίγνεσθαι καὶ ἄλλως

AR: “How do you mean?”

PA: “As follows. There is no need for something to become different from something else that is already different. Rather, it must already be different from that which is different already, it must have become

different from that which has become so, and be about to be different from that which is about to be so. But it must not have become, nor be about to become, nor be different yet, from that which is becoming different. It must be becoming so, and nothing else.”

AR: “Yes, necessarily.”

141c

PA: “Furthermore, older is difference from younger and not from anything else.”

οὐκ εἶναι. ἀνάγκη γὰρ δὴ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τό γε πρεσβύτερον διαφορότης νεωτέρου ἐστὶν καὶ οὐδενὸς ἄλλου. ἔστι γάρ. τὸ ἄρα πρεσβύτερον ἑαυτοῦ γιγνόμενον ἀνάγκη καὶ νεώτερον ἅμα ἑαυτοῦ γίγνεσθαι. ἔοικεν. ἀλλὰ μὴν καὶ μήτε πλείω ἑαυτοῦ γίγνεσθαι χρόνον μήτε ἐλάττω, ἀλλὰ τὸν ἴσον χρόνον καὶ γίγνεσθαι ἑαυτῷ καὶ εἶναι καὶ γεγενέσθαι καὶ μέλλειν ἔσεσθαι. ἀνάγκη γὰρ οὖν καὶ ταῦτα. ἀνάγκη ἄρα ἐστίν, ὥς ἔοικεν, ὅσα γε ἐν χρόνῳ ἐστὶν

AR: “It is indeed.”

PA: “So that which is becoming older than itself is also, necessarily, becoming younger than itself at the same time.”

AR: “So it seems.”

PA: “Then again, it is not becoming so for more or less time than itself. It is rather for a time equal to itself that it becomes, and is, and has become, and is about to be.”

AR: “This too is necessarily so.”

PA: “So it is necessary, it seems, at least for everything that is in time and partakes of it, that each of them is the same age as itself, and is becoming older than itself and younger than itself at the same time.”

AR: “Very likely.”

141d

PA: “But of course the one did not share in any of these characteristics.”

καὶ μετέχει τοῦ τοιούτου, ἕκαστον αὐτῶν τὴν αὐτὴν τε αὐτὸ αὐτῷ ἡλικίαν ἔχειν καὶ πρεσβύτερόν τε αὐτοῦ ἅμα καὶ νεώτερον γίνεσθαι. κινδυνεύει. ἀλλὰ μὴν τῷ γε ἐνὶ τῶν τοιούτων παθημάτων οὐδὲν μετῆν. οὐ γὰρ μετῆν. οὐδὲ ἄρα χρόνου αὐτῷ μέτεστιν, οὐδ' ἔστιν ἐν τινι χρόνῳ. οὐκ οὖν δὴ, ὥς γε ὁ λόγος αἰρεῖ. τί οὖν; τὸ ἦν καὶ τὸ γέγονε καὶ τὸ ἐγίγνετο οὐ χρόνου μέθεξιν δοκεῖ σημαίνειν τοῦ ποτὲ γεγονότος; καὶ μάλα.

AR: “It did not.”

PA: “Neither then does it have a share of time, nor is it in any time.”

AR: “It certainly is not, as the argument proves.”

PA: “What about this then? Don’t ‘was’ and ‘has become’ and ‘was becoming’ seem to indicate participation in time that has passed?”

AR: “They certainly do.”

PA: “And what about ‘will be’ and ‘will become’ and ‘will have become’? Don’t these indicate participation in time to come?”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “And ‘is’ and ‘becomes’ refer to time that is present now, don’t they?”

AR: “Entirely so.”

141e

PA: “So if the one does not partake of time in any respect, it has never come into being, nor was it coming into being, and it never was, nor has it now come into being, nor is it coming into being, and it is not. Nor will it come into being in the future, nor will it have come into being, nor will it be.”

τί δέ; τὸ ἔσται καὶ τὸ γενήσεται καὶ τὸ γενηθήσεται οὐ τοῦ ἔπειτα τοῦ μέλλοντος; ναί. τὸ δὲ δὴ ἔστι καὶ τὸ γίγνεται οὐ τοῦ νῦν παρόντος; πάννυ μὲν οὖν. εἰ ἄρα τὸ ἐν μηδαμῇ μηδενὸς μετέχει χρόνου, οὔτε ποτὲ γέγονεν οὔτ' ἐγίγνετο οὔτ' ἦν ποτέ, οὔτε νῦν γέγονεν οὔτε γίγνεται

οὔτε ἔστιν, οὔτ' ἔπειτα γενήσεται οὔτε γενηθήσεται οὔτε ἔσται.
ἀληθέστατα. ἔστιν οὖν οὐσίας ὅπως ἂν τι μετάσχοι ἄλλως ἢ κατὰ
τούτων τι; οὐκ ἔστιν. οὐδαμῶς ἄρα τὸ ἐν οὐσίας μετέχει. οὐκ ἔοικεν.
οὐδαμῶς ἄρα ἔστι τὸ ἐν. οὐ φαίνεται. οὐδ' ἄρα οὕτως ἔστιν ὥστε ἐν
εἶναι· εἴη γὰρ ἂν ἦδη ὃν καὶ οὐσίας μετέχον· ἀλλ' ὥς ἔοικεν, τὸ ἐν οὔτε
ἐν ἔστιν οὔτε ἔστιν, εἰ δεῖ τῷ

AR: “Very true.”

PA: “Now, is there any way that anything can partake of being besides one of these ways?”

AR: “There is not.”

PA: “So the one does not partake of being at all.”

AR: “It seems not.”

PA: “So the one is not, at all.”

142a

PA: “So the one is not, not in such a way as to be one, for if it were it would already be, and be partaking of being. But it seems that the one is not one, and is not, if we should be persuaded by this sort of argument.”

τοιῷδε λόγῳ πιστεύειν. κινδυνεύει. ὃ δὲ μὴ ἔστι, τούτῳ τῷ μὴ ὄντι εἴη
ἂν τι αὐτῷ ἢ αὐτοῦ; καὶ πῶς; οὐδ' ἄρα ὄνομα ἔστιν αὐτῷ οὐδὲ λόγος
οὐδέ τις ἐπιστήμη οὐδὲ αἴσθησις οὐδὲ δόξα. οὐ φαίνεται. οὐδ'
ὀνομάζεται ἄρα οὐδὲ λέγεται οὐδὲ δοξάζεται οὐδὲ γινώσκεται, οὐδέ τι
τῶν ὄντων αὐτοῦ αἰσθάνεται. οὐκ ἔοικεν. ἢ δυνατόν οὖν περὶ τὸ ἐν
ταῦτα οὕτως ἔχειν; οὐκ οὐκ ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ.

AR: “Quite likely.”

PA: “What about anything that is not? Would anything be to that, or of that?”

AR: “No, how could it be?”

PA: “So no name belongs to it, nor an account, nor any knowledge, nor perception, nor opinion.”

AR: “It appears not.”

PA: “So it is neither named nor described, nor is it subject to opinion, nor is it known, nor is it perceived by any of the things that are.”

AR: “It seems not.”

PA: “Now, in relation to the one, is it possible that all this is the case?”

AR: “Well, I don’t think so anyway.”

142b

PA: “Do you wish to go back to the hypothesis once more from the beginning in case something different occurs to us as we go back over it?”

βούλει οὖν ἐπὶ τὴν ὑπόθεσιν πάλιν ἐξ ἀρχῆς ἐπανεέλθωμεν, ἐάν τι ἡμῖν ἐπανιοῦσιν ἀλλοῖον φανῇ; πάννυ μὲν οὖν βούλομαι. οὐκοῦν ἐν εἰ ἔστιν, φασκέν, τὰ συμβαίνοντα περὶ αὐτοῦ, ποῖά ποτε τυγχάνει ὄντα, διομολογητέα ταῦτα· οὐχ οὕτω; ναί. ὅρα δὴ ἐξ ἀρχῆς. ἐν εἰ ἔστιν, ἄρα οἷόν τε αὐτὸ εἶναι μέν, οὐσίας δὲ μὴ μετέχειν; οὐχ οἷόν τε. οὐκοῦν καὶ ἡ οὐσία τοῦ ἐνὸς εἴη ἂν οὐ ταῦτὸν οὔσα τῷ ἐνί· οὐ γὰρ ἂν ἐκείνη ἦν ἐκείνου οὐσία, οὐδ’ ἂν

AR: “I certainly do.”

PA: “In that case, if one is, we are saying that the consequences relating to it, whatever they happen to be, must be agreed upon. Isn’t this so?”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “Then consider, from the beginning. If one is, can it be but not partake of being?”

AR: “It cannot.”

PA: “Then there would also be the being of the one, and this is not the same as the one, or else it could not be the being of the one, nor could

that, the one, partake of that being, and saying ‘one is’ would be just like saying ‘one is one’. But the present hypothesis is not what must the consequences be ‘if one is one’, but ‘if one is’. Isn’t this so?”

142c

AR: “It certainly is.”

ἐκεῖνο, τὸ ἓν, ἐκείνης μετεῖχεν, ἀλλ’ ὅμοιον ἂν ἦν λέγειν ἓν τε εἶναι καὶ ἓν ἓν. νῦν δὲ οὐχ αὕτη ἐστὶν ἡ ὑπόθεσις, εἰ ἓν ἓν, τί χρή συμβαίνειν, ἀλλ’ εἰ ἓν ἔστιν· οὐχ οὕτω; πάννυ μὲν οὖν. οὐκοῦν ὥς ἄλλο τι σημαῖνον τὸ ἔστι τοῦ ἓν; ἀνάγκη. ἄρα οὖν ἄλλο ἢ ὅτι οὐσίας μετέχει τὸ ἓν, τοῦτ’ ἂν εἴη τὸ λεγόμενον, ἐπειδὴν τις συλλήβδην εἴπη ὅτι ἓν ἔστιν; πάννυ γε. πάλιν δὴ λέγωμεν, ἓν εἰ ἔστιν, τί συμβήσεται. σκοπεῖ οὖν εἰ οὐκ ἀνάγκη ταύτην τὴν ὑπόθεσιν τοιοῦτον ὄν τὸ ἓν σημαίνειν, οἷον

PA: “Does not the ‘is’ indicate something other than the ‘one’?”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “So, whenever someone makes the succinct statement that ‘one is’, this simply means the one partakes of being.”

AR: “Entirely so.”

PA: “Then we should again state what the consequences will be if one is. Now, consider this hypothesis. Doesn’t it indicate that the one, being like this, has parts?”

142d

AR: “How so?”

μέρη ἔχειν; πῶς; ὥδε· εἰ τὸ ἔστι τοῦ ἑνὸς ὄντος λέγεται καὶ τὸ ἓν τοῦ ὄντος ἑνός, ἔστι δὲ οὐ τὸ αὐτὸ ἢ τε οὐσία καὶ τὸ ἓν, τοῦ αὐτοῦ δὲ ἐκείνου οὗ ὑπεθέμεθα, τοῦ ἑνὸς ὄντος, ἄρα οὐκ ἀνάγκη τὸ μὲν ὅλον ἓν ὄν εἶναι αὐτό, τούτου δὲ γίνεσθαι μέρια τό τε ἓν καὶ τὸ εἶναι; ἀνάγκη. πότερον οὖν ἐκάτερον τῶν μορίων τούτων μόνιον μόνον προσερούμεν, ἢ τοῦ ὅλου μόνιον τό γε μόνιον προσρητέον; τοῦ ὅλου. καὶ ὅλον ἄρα ἐστί, ὃ ἂν ἓν ᾗ, καὶ μόνιον ἔχει. πάννυ γε. τί οὖν; τῶν μορίων ἐκάτερον

PA: “As follows. If we speak of the ‘is’ of the one that is, and the ‘one’ of that which is one, but being and one are not the same although both belong to what we hypothesised, namely the one that is, isn’t it necessary that the one that is, itself, be a whole, and that the one and the being constitute parts of this?”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “Now, shall we refer to each of these two parts as just a part only, or should the part be referred to as a part of the whole?”

AR: “Of the whole.”

PA: “So, whatever would be one is a whole and has a part.”

AR: “Certainly.”

142e

PA: “What about each of these parts of the one that is, the one part and the being part? Is the one ever absent from the being part, or the being from the one part?”

τούτων τοῦ ἑνὸς ὄντος, τό τε ἔν καὶ τὸ ὄν, ἄρα ἀπολείπεσθον ἢ τὸ ἔν τοῦ εἶναι μορίου ἢ τὸ ὄν τοῦ ἑνὸς μορίου; οὐκ ἂν εἴη. πάλιν ἄρα καὶ τῶν μορίων ἑκάτερον τό τε ἔν ἴσχει καὶ τὸ ὄν, καὶ γίγνεται τὸ ἐλάχιστον ἐκ δυοῖν αὖ μορίοις τὸ μόριον, καὶ κατὰ τὸν αὐτὸν λόγον οὕτως αἰεὶ, ὅτιπερ ἂν μόριον γένηται, τούτῳ τὸ μόριον αἰεὶ ἴσχει· τό τε γὰρ ἔν τὸ ὄν αἰεὶ ἴσχει καὶ τὸ ὄν τὸ ἔν· ὥστε ἀνάγκη

AR: “It could not be.”

143a

PA: “So, once again, each of the two parts possesses the one and the being, and the least part, in turn, arises from two parts, and according to the same argument it is always the case that whatever has become a part always possesses these two parts. And so, the one always possesses being and being always possesses the one. And so, of necessity, since it is always becoming two, it is never one.”

δύ' ἀεὶ γιγνόμενον μηδέποτε ἔν εἶναι. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν. οὐκοῦν ἄπειρον ἂν τὸ πλῆθος οὕτω τὸ ἔν ὃν εἴη; ἔοικεν. ἴθι δὴ καὶ τῇδε ἔτι. πῇ; οὐσίας φαμὲν μετέχειν τὸ ἔν, διὸ ἔστιν; ναί. καὶ διὰ ταῦτα δὴ τὸ ἔν ὃν πολλὰ ἐφάνη. οὕτω. τί δέ; αὐτὸ τὸ ἔν, ὃ δὴ φαμεν οὐσίας μετέχειν, ἐὰν αὐτὸ τῇ διανοίᾳ μόνον καθ' αὐτὸ λάβωμεν ἄνευ τούτου οὗ φαμεν μετέχειν, ἄρα γε ἔν μόνον φανήσεται ἢ καὶ πολλὰ τὸ αὐτὸ τοῦτο; ἔν, οἶμαι ἔγωγε.

AR: “Entirely so.”

PA: “Consequently, the one that is would be unlimited in multiplicity, would it not?”

AR: “So it seems.”

PA: “Let’s take the matter even further.”

AR: “In what way?”

PA: “Do we maintain that because the one is, it partakes of being?”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “And for these reasons, the one that is appeared to be many.”

AR: “Quite so.”

143b

PA: “What about the one itself then, which we maintain partakes of being? If we grasp this in thought, on its own just by itself, without that of which we say it partakes, will it appear to be just one, or will the very same thing also appear to be many?”

ἴδωμεν δὴ ἄλλο τι ἕτερον μὲν ἀνάγκη τὴν οὐσίαν αὐτοῦ εἶναι, ἕτερον δὲ αὐτό, εἴπερ μὴ οὐσία τὸ ἔν, ἀλλ' ὥς ἔν οὐσίας μετέσχευ. ἀνάγκη. οὐκοῦν εἰ ἕτερον μὲν ἡ οὐσία, ἕτερον δὲ τὸ ἔν, οὔτε τῷ ἔν τὸ ἔν τῆς οὐσίας ἕτερον οὔτε τῷ οὐσία εἶναι ἡ οὐσία τοῦ ἐνὸς ἄλλο, ἀλλὰ τῷ ἐτέρῳ τε καὶ ἄλλῳ ἕτερα ἀλλήλων. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ὥστε οὐ ταυτόν ἐστιν οὔτε τῷ ἐνὶ οὔτε τῇ οὐσίᾳ τὸ ἕτερον. πῶς γάρ;

AR: “One. That is what I think anyway.”

PA: “Let’s see. If indeed that one is not being, but as one partakes of being, then its being must necessarily be one thing, and itself something different.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “In that case, if the being is one thing and the one is something different, it is not by being one that the one is different from the being, or by being being that the being is other than the one. Rather they are different from one another by the different and the other.”

AR: “Certainly.”

143c

PA: “So the different is not the same as the one or the being.”

τί οὖν; ἐὰν προελώμεθα αὐτῶν εἴτε βούλει τὴν οὐσίαν καὶ τὸ ἕτερον εἴτε τὴν οὐσίαν καὶ τὸ ἐν εἴτε τὸ ἐν καὶ τὸ ἕτερον, ἄρ’ οὐκ ἐν ἐκάστη τῇ προαιρέσει προαιρούμεθά τινα ὡς ὀρθῶς ἔχει καλεῖσθαι ἀμφοτέρω; πῶς; ὥδε· ἔστιν οὐσίαν εἰπεῖν; ἔστιν. καὶ αὖθις εἰπεῖν ἕν; καὶ τοῦτο. ἄρ’ οὖν οὐχ ἐκάτερον αὐτοῖν εἴρηται; ναί. τί δ’ ὅταν εἴπω οὐσία τε καὶ ἕν, ἄρα οὐκ ἀμφοτέρω; πάνυ γε. οὐκοῦν καὶ ἐὰν οὐσία τε καὶ ἕτερον ἢ ἕτερόν τε καὶ ἕν, καὶ οὕτω πανταχῶς ἐφ’ ἐκάστου ἄμφοω λέγω; ναί.

AR: “No, how could it be?”

PA: “Well then, if from these we were to select, say, the being and the different, or the being and the one, or the one and the different, would we not be choosing, with each selection, some pair that is correctly referred to as both?”

AR: “In what way?”

PA: “As follows. Is it possible to mention being?”

AR: “It is.”

PA: “And also, in turn, to mention one?”

AR: “This too.”

PA: “In that case, has each of them been mentioned?”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “And whenever I mention being and one, don’t I mention both?”

AR: “Certainly.”

143d

PA: “And whenever I mention being and different, or different and one, and so on for each possible case, don’t I speak of both?”

ὦ δ’ ἂν ἄμφω ὁρθῶς προσαγορεύησθον, ἄρα οἷόν τε ἄμφω μὲν αὐτῶ εἶναι, δύο δὲ μή; οὐχ οἷόν τε. ὦ δ’ ἂν δύο ᾗτον, ἔστι τις μηχανὴ μὴ οὐχ ἑκάτερον αὐτοῖν ἔν εἶναι; οὐδεμία. τούτων ἄρα ἐπεὶ πρὸς σύνδυο ἕκαστα συμβαίνει εἶναι, καὶ ἔν ἂν εἴη ἕκαστον. φαίνεται. εἰ δὲ ἔν ἕκαστον αὐτῶν ἔστι, συντεθέντος ἑνὸς ὁποιοῦν ἡτινιοῦν συζυγία οὐ τρία γίγνεται τὰ πάντα; ναί. τρία δὲ οὐ περιττὰ καὶ δύο ἄρτια; πῶς δ’ οὐ; τί δέ; δυοῖν ὄντων οὐκ

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “Could things that are correctly referred to as both, be both without being two?”

AR: “They could not.”

PA: “And if they are two, is there any way that each of them can avoid being one?”

AR: “None at all.”

PA: “So although each turns out to be a twofold combination of these, each constituent would be one.”

AR: “So it appears.”

143e

PA: “And if each of them is one, by combining any one whatsoever with any pair whatsoever, won’t they all become three?”

ἀνάγκη εἶναι καὶ δίς, καὶ τριῶν ὄντων τρίς, εἴπερ ὑπάρχει τῷ τε δύο τὸ δίς ἔν καὶ τῷ τρία τὸ τρίς ἔν; ἀνάγκη. δυοῖν δὲ ὄντων καὶ δίς οὐκ ἀνάγκη δύο δίς εἶναι; καὶ τριῶν καὶ τρίς οὐκ ἀνάγκη αὖ τρία τρίς εἶναι;

πῶς δ' οὐ; τί δέ; τριῶν ὄντων καὶ δις ὄντων καὶ δυοῖν ὄντοιν καὶ τρίς ὄντοιν οὐκ ἀνάγκη τε τρία δις εἶναι καὶ δύο τρίς; πολλή γε. ἄρτιά τε ἄρα ἀρτιάκις ἂν εἴη καὶ

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “Isn’t three odd and two even?”

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “What about this? If there are two, is it not necessary that there is also twice, and if there are three, thrice, if indeed two happens to be twice one and three thrice one?”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “And since there are two and twice, isn’t it necessary that there be twice two? And since there are three and thrice, isn’t it necessary, again, that there be thrice three?”

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “What about this? If there are three and they are twice, and if there are two and they are thrice, is it not necessary that there be twice three and thrice two?”

AR: “Very much so.”

144a

PA: “So there would be even times even and odd times odd, and even times odd and odd times even.”

περιττὰ περιττάκις καὶ ἄρτια περιττάκις καὶ περιττὰ ἀρτιάκις. ἔστιν οὕτω. εἰ οὖν ταῦτα οὕτως ἔχει, οἶει τινὰ ἀριθμὸν ὑπολείπεσθαι ὃν οὐκ ἀνάγκη εἶναι; οὐδαμῶς γε. εἰ ἄρα ἔστιν ἓν, ἀνάγκη καὶ ἀριθμὸν εἶναι. ἀνάγκη. ἀλλὰ μὴν ἀριθμοῦ γε ὄντος πολλὰ ἂν εἴη καὶ πλήθος ἄπειρον τῶν ὄντων· ἢ οὐκ ἄπειρος ἀριθμὸς πλήθει καὶ μετέχων οὐσίας γίγνεται; καὶ πάνυ γε. οὐκοῦν εἰ πᾶς ἀριθμὸς οὐσίας μετέχει, καὶ τὸ μῶριον ἕκαστον τοῦ ἀριθμοῦ μετέχει ἂν αὐτῆς; ναί.

AR: “This is so.”

PA: “And if this is how matters stand, do you think there is any remaining number which must not necessarily be?”

AR: “Not at all.”

PA: “So if one is, there must necessarily also be number.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “And yet, if there is number, there would also be many, and a limitless multiplicity of things that are. Or does not number, while being many and partaking of being, become limitless in multiplicity?”

AR: “Yes, certainly.”

PA: “In that case, if all number partakes of being, would not each part of number also partake of this?”

AR: “Yes.”

144b

PA: “So, has being been distributed to all things which are multiple, and is it not absent from any of the things that are, neither from the smallest nor from the largest? Or is this question unreasonable? For how could being be absent from any of the things that are?”

ἐπὶ πάντα ἄρα πολλὰ ὄντα ἡ οὐσία νενέμηται καὶ οὐδενὸς ἀποστατεῖ τῶν ὄντων, οὔτε τοῦ σμικροτάτου οὔτε τοῦ μεγίστου; ἢ τοῦτο μὲν καὶ ἄλογον ἐρέσθαι; πῶς γὰρ ἂν δὴ οὐσία γε τῶν ὄντων του ἀποστατοῖ; οὐδαμῶς. κατακεκερμάτισται ἄρα ὡς οἷόν τε σμικρότατα καὶ μέγιστα καὶ πανταχῶς ὄντα, καὶ μεμέρισται πάντων μάλιστα, καὶ ἔστι

AR: “In no way at all.”

144c

PA: “So being is chopped up into all sorts of things that are, from the very smallest to the very largest, and is the most divided of all things, and there are parts without limit, of being.”

μέρη ἀπέραντα τῆς οὐσίας. ἔχει οὕτω. πλεῖστα ἄρα ἐστὶ τὰ μέρη αὐτῆς. πλεῖστα μέντοι. τί οὖν; ἔστι τι αὐτῶν ὃ ἔστι μὲν μέρος τῆς οὐσίας,

οὐδὲν μέντοι μέρος; καὶ πῶς ἂν τοι τοῦτο γένοιτο; ἀλλ' εἵπερ γε οἶμαι ἔστιν, ἀνάγκη αὐτὸ αἰεὶ, ἕωσπερ ἂν ᾗ, ἔν γέ τι εἶναι, μηδὲν δὲ ἀδύνατον. ἀνάγκη. πρὸς ἅπαντι ἄρα ἐκάστω τῷ τῆς οὐσίας μέρει πρόσεστιν τὸ ἔν, οὐκ ἀπολειπόμενον οὔτε σμικροτέρου οὔτε μείζονος μέρους οὔτε ἄλλου οὐδενός. οὕτω. ἄρα οὖν ἔν

AR: “This is so.”

PA: “So the parts of being are as many as can be.”

AR: “As many as can be, indeed.”

PA: “What about this? Of these parts, is there any that is a part of being without being one part?”

AR: “No, how could that ever happen?”

PA: “Rather, I presume, if it actually is, so long as it is, it is necessarily always one thing, it cannot be no thing.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “So the one is present to every part of being, and is not absent from the smaller or larger part, or from anything else.”

AR: “Indeed so.”

144d

PA: “Well then, being one, is it, as a whole, in many places at the same time? Consider this carefully.”

ὃν πολλαχοῦ ἅμα ὅλον ἐστί; τοῦτο ἄθρει. ἀλλ' ἀθρῶ καὶ ὁρῶ ὅτι ἀδύνατον. μεμερισμένον ἄρα, εἵπερ μὴ ὅλον· ἄλλως γάρ που οὐδαμῶς ἅμα ἅπασι τοῖς τῆς οὐσίας μέρεσιν παρέσται ἢ μεμερισμένον. ναί. καὶ μὴν τό γε μεριστὸν πολλὴ ἀνάγκη εἶναι τοσαῦτα ὅσαπερ μέρη. ἀνάγκη. οὐκ ἄρα ἀληθῆ ἄρτι ἐλέγομεν λέγοντες ὡς πλεῖστα μέρη ἢ οὐσία νενεμημένη εἶη. οὐδὲ γὰρ πλείω τοῦ ἐνὸς νενέμνεται, ἀλλ'

AR: “I am considering this, and I see that it is impossible.”

PA: “Then if it is not so as a whole, it is so as divided, for the one will not, I presume, be present at the same time to all the parts of being in

any other way besides being divided.”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “And indeed, whatever is divided must necessarily be as numerous as its parts.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

144e

PA: “So we were not speaking the truth just now when we said that being has been divided more than anything. For it has not been divided more than the one, but, it seems, equally with the one, since being is not absent from the one, nor the one from being, but being two they are always equal throughout everything.”

ἴσα, ὡς ἔοικε, τῷ ἐνί· οὔτε γὰρ τὸ ὄν τοῦ ἐνὸς ἀπολείπεται οὔτε τὸ ἐν τοῦ ὄντος, ἀλλ’ ἐξισοῦσθον δύο ὄντε αἰὲν παρὰ πάντα. παντάπασιν οὕτω φαίνεται. τὸ ἐν ἄρα αὐτὸ κεκερματισμένον ὑπὸ τῆς οὐσίας πολλά τε καὶ ἅπειρα τὸ πληθός ἐστιν. φαίνεται. οὐ μόνον ἄρα τὸ ὄν ἐν πολλά ἐστιν, ἀλλὰ καὶ αὐτὸ τὸ ἐν ὑπὸ τοῦ ὄντος διανενημενόμενον πολλά ἀνάγκη εἶναι. παντάπασιν μὲν οὔν. καὶ μὴν ὅτι γε ὅλου τὰ μόρια μόρια, πεπερασμένον ἂν εἴη κατὰ τὸ ὅλον τὸ ἐν· ἢ οὐ περιέχεται ὑπὸ τοῦ ὅλου τὰ

AR: “It certainly appears so.”

PA: “So the one, having been itself chopped up by being, is many, and unlimited in multiplicity.”

AR: “So it appears.”

PA: “So not alone is the one that is many, but the one itself having been distributed by being, must also of necessity be many.”

AR: “Entirely so.”

145a

PA: “Furthermore, because the parts are parts of the whole, the one, on the basis of the whole, would be limited. Or are the parts not contained by the whole?”

μόρια; ἀνάγκη. ἀλλὰ μὴν τό γε περιέχον πέρας ἂν εἴη. πῶς δ' οὐ; τὸ ἐν ἄρα ὄν ἐν τέ ἐστί που καὶ πολλά, καὶ ὅλον καὶ μόρια, καὶ πεπερασμένον καὶ ἄπειρον πλήθει. φαίνεται. ἄρ' οὖν οὐκ, ἐπείπερ πεπερασμένον, καὶ ἔσχατα ἔχον; ἀνάγκη. τί δέ; εἰ ὅλον, οὐ καὶ ἀρχὴν ἂν ἔχοι καὶ μέσον καὶ τελευτήν; ἢ οἷόν τε τί ὅλον εἶναι ἄνευ τριῶν τούτων; κἄν του ἐν ὁτιοῦν αὐτῶν ἀποστατῇ, ἐθελήσει ἔτι ὅλον εἶναι; οὐκ ἐθελήσει. καὶ ἀρχὴν δὴ, ὥς ἔοικεν, καὶ

AR: “They must be.”

PA: “And yet whatever contains would be a limit.”

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “So the one, being one, is presumably also many, and a whole, and parts, and is limited and limitless in multiplicity.”

AR: “So it appears.”

PA: “In which case, since it is limited, doesn't it also have extremities?”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “What about this? If it is a whole, would it not also have a beginning, middle and end? Or can anything be a whole without these three? And if any one of these is missing from anything, will it still, of itself, be a whole?”

145b

AR: “Not of itself, no.”

τελευτήν καὶ μέσον ἔχοι ἂν τὸ ἐν. ἔχοι. ἀλλὰ μὴν τό γε μέσον ἴσον τῶν ἐσχάτων ἀπέχει· οὐ γὰρ ἂν ἄλλως μέσον εἴη. οὐ γάρ. καὶ σχήματος δὴ τινος, ὥς ἔοικε, τοιοῦτον ὃν μετέχοι ἂν τὸ ἐν, ἥτοι εὐθέος ἢ στρογγύλου ἢ τινος μεικτοῦ ἐξ ἀμφοῖν. μετέχοι γὰρ ἄν. ἄρ' οὖν οὕτως ἔχον οὐκ αὐτό τε ἐν ἑαυτῷ ἔσται καὶ ἐν ἄλλῳ; πῶς; τῶν μερῶν που ἕκαστον ἐν τῷ ὅλῳ ἐστὶ καὶ οὐδὲν ἐκτὸς τοῦ ὅλου. οὕτω. πάντα δὲ τὰ μέρη ὑπὸ τοῦ

PA: “Then the one, it seems, would also have a beginning, an end and a middle?”

AR: “It would.”

PA: “Now, the middle stands equally between the extremities, for otherwise it would not be a middle.”

AR: “It would not.”

PA: “Then being like this, the one would also partake of some shape, either straight or round or some mixture of both.”

AR: “Yes, it would partake of this.”

PA: “Now, since this is so, won’t it also be in itself and in another?”

AR: “How so?”

PA: “Each of the parts is presumably in the whole, and none are outside the whole.”

AR: “Quite so.”

145c

PA: “Are all the parts contained by the whole?”

ὅλου περιέχεται; ναί. καὶ μὴν τά γε πάντα μέρη τὰ αὐτοῦ τὸ ἓν ἐστι, καὶ οὔτε τι πλέον οὔτε ἔλαττον ἢ πάντα. οὐ γάρ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τὸ ὅλον τὸ ἓν ἐστιν; πῶς δ’ οὐ; εἰ ἄρα πάντα τὰ μέρη ἐν ὅλῳ τυγχάνει ὄντα, ἔστι δὲ τὰ τε πάντα τὸ ἓν καὶ αὐτὸ τὸ ὅλον, περιέχεται δὲ ὑπὸ τοῦ ὅλου τὰ πάντα, ὑπὸ τοῦ ἐνὸς ἂν περιέχοιτο τὸ ἓν, καὶ οὕτως ἂν ἦδη τὸ ἓν αὐτὸ ἐν ἑαυτῷ εἴη. φαίνεται. ἀλλὰ μέντοι τό γε ὅλον αὖ οὐκ ἐν τοῖς μέρεσιν ἐστιν, οὔτε ἐν πᾶσιν οὔτε

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “And indeed, the one is all the parts of itself and neither more nor less than all.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “The one is also the whole, is it not?”

AR: “How could it not be?”

PA: “So, if all the parts happen to be in the whole, and the one is all the parts and the whole itself, and all the parts are contained by the whole, the one would be contained by the one, and the one would itself, in this way, already be in itself.”

AR: “So it appears.”

145d

PA: “Then again, the whole, in turn, is not in any of the parts, nor in them all. For if it is in them all, it must be in one, since without being in any one it would not, presumably, be in them all. And if this one is one of them all, and the whole is not present in this, how will it still be present in them all?”

ἐν τινί. εἰ γὰρ ἐν πᾶσιν, ἀνάγκη καὶ ἐν ἐνί· ἔν τινι γὰρ ἐνὶ μὴ ὄν οὐκ ἂν ἔτι που δύναίτο ἔν γε ἅπασιν εἶναι· εἰ δὲ τοῦτο μὲν τὸ ἐν τῶν ἀπάντων ἐστί, τὸ δὲ ὅλον ἐν τούτῳ μὴ ἐνι, πῶς ἔτι ἔν γε τοῖς πᾶσιν ἐνέσται; οὐδαμῶς. οὐδὲ μὴν ἐν τισὶ τῶν μερῶν· εἰ γὰρ ἐν τισὶ τὸ ὅλον εἴη, τὸ πλεον ἂν ἐν τῷ ἐλάττονι εἴη, ὃ ἐστὶν ἀδύνατον. ἀδύνατον γάρ. μὴ ὄν δ' ἐν πλέοσιν μὴδ' ἐν ἐνὶ μὴδ' ἐν ἅπασιν τοῖς μέρεσι τὸ ὅλον οὐκ ἀνάγκη ἐν ἑτέρῳ τινὶ εἶναι ἢ μηδαμοῦ

AR: “In no way at all.”

PA: “Nor again is it in some of the parts, for if the whole were in some, more would be in less, which is impossible.”

AR: “Yes, impossible.”

145e

PA: “But if the whole is not in more, or in one, or in all of the parts, must it not necessarily be in something different, or no longer be anywhere at all?”

ἔτι εἶναι; ἀνάγκη. οὐκοῦν μηδαμοῦ μὲν ὄν οὐδὲν ἂν εἴη, ὅλον δὲ ὄν, ἐπειδὴ οὐκ ἐν αὐτῷ ἐστὶν, ἀνάγκη ἐν ἄλλῳ εἶναι; πάνυ γε. ἥ μὲν ἄρα τὸ ἐν ὅλον, ἐν ἄλλῳ ἐστίν· ἥ δὲ τὰ πάντα μέρη ὄντα τυγχάνει, αὐτὸ ἐν

ἐαυτῷ· καὶ οὕτω τὸ ἐν ἀνάγκῃ αὐτό τε ἐν ἐαυτῷ εἶναι καὶ ἐν ἑτέρῳ.
ἀνάγκη.οὕτω δὴ πεφυκὸς τὸ ἐν ἅρ' οὐκ ἀνάγκη καὶ κινεῖσθαι καὶ
ἐστάναι; πῆ; ἔστηκε μὲν που, εἴπερ αὐτὸ ἐν ἐαυτῷ

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “Now, being nowhere it would be nothing, but being a whole, since it is not in itself, it is necessarily in another.”

AR: “Certainly.”

PA: “Insofar then as the one is a whole, it is in another, whereas insofar as it happens to be all the parts, it is in itself, and thus the one must itself be in itself, and in another.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “So, if this is the nature of the one, must it not necessarily be in motion and at rest?”

AR: “In what way?”

146a

PA: “If it is indeed in itself it is presumably at rest, for being in one and not changing from that, it would be in the same, in itself.”

ἐστιν· ἐν γὰρ ἐνὶ ὄν καὶ ἐκ τούτου μὴ μεταβαῖνον ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ ἂν εἶη, ἐν ἐαυτῷ. ἔστι γάρ. τὸ δέ γε ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ ἀεὶ ὄν ἐστὸς δήπου ἀνάγκη ἀεὶ εἶναι. πάνυ γε. τί δέ; τὸ ἐν ἑτέρῳ ἀεὶ ὄν οὐ τὸ ἐναντίον ἀνάγκη μηδέποτε ἐν ταύτῳ εἶναι, μηδέποτε δὲ ὄν ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ μηδὲ ἐστάναι, μὴ ἐστὸς δὲ κινεῖσθαι; οὕτως. ἀνάγκη ἄρα τὸ ἔν, αὐτό τε ἐν ἐαυτῷ ἀεὶ ὄν καὶ ἐν ἑτέρῳ, ἀεὶ κινεῖσθαι τε καὶ ἐστάναι. φαίνεται. καὶ μὴν ταυτόν γε δεῖ εἶναι αὐτὸ ἐαυτῷ καὶ ἕτερον

AR: “Indeed so.”

PA: “And that which is always in the same must, surely, always be at rest.”

AR: “Certainly.”

PA: “What about this? Is it not necessarily the case, in contrast, that whatever is always in the different must never be in the same, and never being in the same must never be at rest, and never being at rest must be moving?”

AR: “Quite so.”

PA: “So, is it necessary that the one, because it is always in itself and in something different, is always in motion and at rest?”

AR: “So it appears.”

146b

PA: “And indeed, if it is actually characterised as just indicated, it must be the same as itself and different from itself, and in like manner be both the same as and different from the others.”

ἑαυτοῦ, καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις ὡσαύτως ταῦτόν τε καὶ ἕτερον εἶναι, εἴπερ καὶ τὰ πρόσθεν πέπονθεν. πῶς; πᾶν που πρὸς ἅπαν ὧδε ἔχει, ἢ ταῦτόν ἐστιν ἢ ἕτερον· ἢ ἐὰν μὴ ταῦτόν ἢ μὴδ' ἕτερον, μέρος ἂν εἴη τούτου πρὸς ὃ οὕτως ἔχει, ἢ ὡς πρὸς μέρος ὅλον ἂν εἴη. φαίνεται. ἅρ' οὖν τὸ ἐν αὐτὸ αὐτοῦ μέρος ἐστίν; οὐδαμῶς. οὐδ' ἄρα ὡς πρὸς μέρος αὐτὸ αὐτοῦ ὅλον ἂν εἴη, πρὸς ἑαυτὸ μέρος ὄν. οὐ γὰρ οἶόν

AR: “How so?”

PA: “Everything is presumably related to everything else as follows. It is either the same or different, and if it were neither the same nor different, it would be related to this, either as part to whole, or as whole in relation to part.”

AR: “So it appears.”

PA: “Now, is the one itself part of itself?”

AR: “Not at all.”

PA: “So it would not be related as a whole to itself as part of itself.”

AR: “No, it could not be.”

146c

PA: “But is the one different from one?”

τε. ἀλλ’ ἄρα ἕτερόν ἐστιν ἐνὸς τὸ ἓν; οὐ δῆτα. οὐδ’ ἄρα ἑαυτοῦ γε ἕτερον ἂν εἴη. οὐ μέντοι. εἰ οὖν μήτε ἕτερον μήτε ὅλον μήτε μέρος αὐτὸ πρὸς ἑαυτό ἐστιν, οὐκ ἀνάγκη ἤδη ταυτὸν εἶναι αὐτὸ ἑαυτῷ; ἀνάγκη. τί δέ; τὸ ἐτέρωθι ὃν αὐτὸ ἑαυτοῦ ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ ὄντος ἑαυτῷ οὐκ ἀνάγκη αὐτὸ ἑαυτοῦ ἕτερον εἶναι, εἴπερ καὶ ἐτέρωθι ἔσται; ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ. οὕτω μὴν ἐφάνη ἔχον τὸ ἓν, αὐτὸ τε ἐν ἑαυτῷ ὃν ἅμα καὶ ἐν ἐτέρῳ. ἐφάνη γάρ. ἕτερον ἄρα, ὡς ἔοικεν,

AR: “Of course not.”

PA: “So it would not be different from itself.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “Now, if it is neither related to itself as different, nor as part, nor whole, must it not then necessarily be the same as itself?”

AR: “Necessarily.”

146d

PA: “What about this? Is it not necessary that whatever is in something different from itself, itself being in the same as itself, must be different from itself, if indeed it is also to be in something different?”

εἴη ταύτη ἂν ἑαυτοῦ τὸ ἓν. ἔοικεν. τί οὖν; εἴ τού τι ἕτερόν ἐστιν, οὐχ ἐτέρου ὄντος ἕτερον ἔσται; ἀνάγκη. οὐκοῦν ὅσα μὴ ἐν ἐστίν, ἅπανθ’ ἕτερα τοῦ ἐνός, καὶ τὸ ἐν τῶν μὴ ἐν; πῶς δ’ οὐ; ἕτερον ἄρα ἂν εἴη τὸ ἐν τῶν ἄλλων. ἕτερον. ὅρα δὴ αὐτό τε ταυτὸν καὶ τὸ ἕτερον ἄρ’ οὐκ ἐναντία ἀλλήλοις; πῶς δ’ οὐ; ἢ οὖν ἐθελήσει ταυτὸν ἐν τῷ ἐτέρῳ ἢ τὸ ἕτερον ἐν ταυτῷ ποτε εἶναι; οὐκ ἐθελήσει. εἰ ἄρα τὸ ἕτερον ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ μηδέποτε ἔσται, οὐδὲν ἔστι τῶν ὄντων ἐν ᾧ ἐστὶν τὸ ἕτερον χρόνον οὐδένα·

AR: “Well, I think so.”

PA: “And this appeared to be the case with the one, being both in itself and in another at the same time.”

AR: “It appeared so indeed.”

PA: “So the one, it seems, would in this way be different from itself.”

AR: “So it seems.”

PA: “What about this? If anything is different from something, will it not be different from something that is different?”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “Won’t whatever is not one be different from the one, and the one from whatever is not one?”

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “So the one would be different from the others?”

AR: “Different.”

146e

PA: “Now, look at this. Are not the same itself and the different opposite to one another?”

εἰ γὰρ ὄντινοῦν εἴη ἓν τῷ, ἐκείνον ἂν τὸν χρόνον ἐν ταύτῳ εἴη τὸ ἕτερον. οὐχ οὕτως; οὕτως. ἐπειδὴ δ’ οὐδέποτε ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ ἐστίν, οὐδέποτε ἓν τινι τῶν ὄντων ἂν εἴη τὸ ἕτερον. ἀληθῆ. οὐτ’ ἄρα ἐν τοῖς μὴ ἓν οὔτε ἐν τῷ ἐνὶ ἐνείῃ ἂν τὸ ἕτερον. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. οὐκ ἄρα τῷ ἐτέρῳ γ’ ἂν εἴη τὸ ἐν τῶν μὴ ἓν οὐδὲ τὰ μὴ ἓν τοῦ ἐνὸς ἕτερα. οὐ γάρ. οὐδὲ μὴν ἑαυτοῖς γε ἕτερ’ ἂν εἴη ἀλλήλων, μὴ μετέχοντα

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “In that case will the same ever, of itself, be in the different, or the different be in the same?”

AR: “Not of itself, no.”

PA: “So, if the different will never be in the same, there are none of the things that are in which the different will be present for any time, for if the different were in anything for any time, the different would for that time be in the same. Is this not so?”

AR: “It is so.”

PA: “And since the different is never in the same, it would never be in any of the things that are.”

AR: “True.”

PA: “So the different would not be in things not one, nor in the one.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

147a

PA: “So, not by the different would the one be different from things not one, nor things not one from the one.”

τοῦ ἑτέρου. πῶς γάρ; εἰ δὲ μήτε αὐτοῖς ἕτερα ἔστι μήτε τῷ ἑτέρῳ, οὐ πάντῃ ἥδη ἂν ἐκφεύγοι τὸ μὴ ἕτερα εἶναι ἀλλήλων; ἐκφεύγοι. ἀλλὰ μὴν οὐδὲ τοῦ ἑνός γε μετέχει τὰ μὴ ἔν· οὐ γὰρ ἂν μὴ ἔν ᾤν, ἀλλὰ πῃ ἂν ἔν ᾤν. ἀληθῆ. οὐδ' ἂν ἀριθμὸς εἴη ἄρα τὰ μὴ ἔν· οὐδὲ γὰρ ἂν οὕτω μὴ ἔν ᾤν παντάπασιν, ἀριθμὸν γε ἔχοντα. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. τί δέ; τὰ μὴ ἔν τοῦ ἑνὸς ἄρα μὲν ἔστιν; ἢ καὶ οὕτω μετεῖχε τοῦ ἑνὸς τὰ μὴ ἔν; μετεῖχεν. εἰ ἄρα πάντῃ τὸ μὲν ἔν ἔστι,

AR: “No.”

PA: “Nor by themselves could they be different from one another, since they do not partake of the different.”

AR: “No, how could they?”

PA: “And if they are not different by themselves, nor by the different, wouldn't they totally avoid being different from one another?”

AR: “They would.”

PA: “Furthermore, things not one do not partake of the one, or else they would not be not one, but would somehow be one.”

AR: “True.”

PA: “Neither would things not one be number, for in this way they would not be not one in every respect, because they would at least have

number.”

AR: “Indeed.”

147b

PA: “What about this? Are things not one parts of the one, or in that case too would things not one partake of the one?”

τὰ δὲ μὴ ἓν, οὐτ’ ἂν μόριον τῶν μὴ ἓν τὸ ἓν εἴη οὔτε ὅλον ὡς μορίων· οὔτε αὖ τὰ μὴ ἓν τοῦ ἐνὸς μόρια, οὔτε ὅλα ὡς μορίῳ τῷ ἐνί. οὐ γάρ. ἀλλὰ μὴν ἔφαμεν τὰ μήτε μόρια μήτε ὅλα μήτε ἕτερα ἀλλήλων ταυτὰ ἔσεσθαι ἀλλήλοις. ἔφαμεν γάρ. φῶμεν ἄρα καὶ τὸ ἓν πρὸς τὰ μὴ ἓν οὕτως ἔχον τὸ αὐτὸ εἶναι αὐτοῖς; φῶμεν. τὸ ἓν ἄρα, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἕτερόν τε τῶν ἄλλων ἐστὶν καὶ ἑαυτοῦ καὶ ταυτὸν ἐκείνοις τε καὶ ἑαυτῷ. κινδυνεύει φαίνεσθαι ἐκ γε τοῦ λόγου.

AR: “They would partake of it.”

PA: “So, if in every respect the one is one, and they are not one, the one would neither be a part of things not one, nor a whole with them as its parts. Nor again would things not one be parts of the one, nor wholes with the one as a part.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “And indeed, we said that things that are neither parts, nor wholes, nor different from one another, will be the same as one another.”

AR: “Yes, we said so.”

147c

PA: “Then, should we also say that the one, being related in this way to things not one, is the same as them?”

ἄρ’ οὖν καὶ ὁμοίον τε καὶ ἀνόμοιον ἑαυτῷ τε καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις; ἴσως. ἐπειδὴ γοῦν ἕτερον τῶν ἄλλων ἐφάνη, καὶ τᾶλλα που ἕτερα ἂν ἐκείνου εἴη. τί μὴν; οὐκοῦν οὕτως ἕτερον τῶν ἄλλων, ὥσπερ καὶ τᾶλλα ἐκείνου, καὶ οὔτε μᾶλλον οὔτε ἥττον; τί γὰρ ἄν; εἰ ἄρα μήτε μᾶλλον μήτε ἥττον, ὁμοίως. ναί. οὐκοῦν ἢ ἕτερον εἶναι πέπονθεν τῶν ἄλλων καὶ τᾶλλα

ἐκεῖνου ὡσαύτως, ταύτη ταὐτὸν ἂν πεπονθότα εἶεν τό τε ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις καὶ τᾷλλα τῷ ἐνί.

AR: “We should say so.”

PA: “So the one, it seems, is different both from the others and from itself, and also the same as them, and itself.”

AR: “It certainly appears likely from this argument.”

PA: “Now, is it also like and unlike itself and the others?”

AR: “Perhaps.”

PA: “Well, since it appeared to be different from the others, the others too will presumably be different from it.”

AR: “Indeed.”

PA: “Wouldn’t it then be just as different from the others as the others are from it, neither more nor less?”

AR: “Yes, it would.”

PA: “So, if it is neither more so nor less so, it is so in like manner.”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “Now, being characterised as different from the others, and the others as different from the one in like manner, the one would in this respect be characterised as the same as the others, and the others as the same as the one.”

147d

AR: “How do you mean?”

πῶς λέγεις; ὥδε· ἕκαστον τῶν ὀνομάτων οὐκ ἐπὶ τινι καλεῖς; ἔγωγε. τί οὖν; τὸ αὐτὸ ὄνομα εἴποισ ἂν πλεονάκῃς ἢ ἅπαξ; ἔγωγε. πότερον οὖν ἐὰν μὲν ἅπαξ εἴπῃς, ἐκεῖνο προσαγορεύεις οὐπὲρ ἐστὶ τοῦνομα, ἐὰν δὲ πολλάκις, οὐκ ἐκεῖνο; ἢ ἐάντε ἅπαξ ἐάντε πολλάκις ταὐτὸν ὄνομα φθέγῃς, πολλὴ ἀνάγκη σε ταὐτὸν καὶ λέγειν αἰεὶ; τί μήν; οὐκοῦν καὶ τὸ ἕτερον ὄνομα ἐστὶν ἐπὶ τινι; πάνυ γε.

PA: “As follows. Don’t you apply each of the names you use to something?”

AR: “I do.”

PA: “Yes, and can you speak the same name once or many times?”

AR: “I can.”

PA: “Now, is it the case that when you say the name once, you refer to that of which it is the name, whereas you don’t refer to that when you say it many times? Or is there a strong necessity that you always speak of the same thing, whether you say the same name once or many times?”

AR: “Indeed so.”

PA: “Now, ‘different’ is a name given to something, is it not?”

AR: “Certainly.”

147e

PA: “So whenever you utter it, whether once or many times, you are not referring to something else, or naming anything else apart from that of which it is the name.”

ὅταν ἄρα αὐτὸ φθέγγῃ, ἐάντε ἅπαξ ἐάντε πολλάκις, οὐκ ἐπ’ ἄλλῳ οὐδὲ ἄλλο τι ὀνομάξεις ἢ ἐκεῖνο οὐπὲρ ἦν ὄνομα. ἀνάγκη. ὅταν δὴ λέγωμεν ὅτι ἕτερον μὲν τᾶλλα τοῦ ἐνός, ἕτερον δὲ τὸ ἐν τῶν ἄλλων, δις τὸ ἕτερον εἰπόντες οὐδέν τι μᾶλλον ἐπ’ ἄλλῃ, ἀλλ’ ἐπ’ ἐκείνῃ τῇ φύσει αὐτὸ ἀεὶ λέγομεν ἥσπερ ἦν τοῦνομα. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ἦ ἄρα ἕτερον τῶν

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “Then, whenever we say that the others are different from the one and that the one is different from the others, we say ‘different’ twice, but we are not applying the word to another nature. We are always referring to that nature of which it is the name.”

AR: “Certainly.”

148a

PA: “So, insofar as the one is different from the others and the others from the one, on the basis of being characterised as different, the one would have a characteristic that is not other than the others but is the same. And whatever somehow has a characteristic the same, is like, is it not?”

ἄλλων τὸ ἐν καὶ τᾶλλα τοῦ ενός, κατ’ αὐτὸ τὸ ἕτερον πεπονθέναι οὐκ ἄλλο ἄλλα τὸ αὐτὸ ἂν πεπονθὸς εἴη τὸ ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις· τὸ δέ που ταῦτὸν πεπονθὸς ὅμοιον οὐχί; ναί. ἦι δὴ τὸ ἐν ἕτερον τῶν ἄλλων πέπονθεν εἶναι, κατ’ αὐτὸ τοῦτο ἅπαν ἅπασιν ὅμοιον ἂν εἴη ἅπαν γὰρ ἀπάντων ἕτερόν ἐστιν. ὅκειν. ἀλλὰ μὴν τό γε ὅμοιον τῷ ἀνομοίῳ ἐναντίον. ναί. οὐκοῦν καὶ τὸ ἕτερον τῷ ταύτῳ. καὶ τοῦτο. ἀλλὰ μὴν καὶ τοῦτό γ’ ἐφάνη, ὡς ἄρα τὸ ἐν τοῖς

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “Insofar then as the one is characterised as different from the others, it would on that basis be entirely like them all, since it is entirely different from them all.”

AR: “So it seems.”

148b

PA: “And yet the like is opposite to the unlike.”

ἄλλοις ταῦτόν. ἐφάνη γάρ. τὸ ἐναντίον δέ γε πάθος ἐστὶ τὸ εἶναι ταῦτόν τοῖς ἄλλοις τῷ ἕτερον εἶναι τῶν ἄλλων. πάνυ γε. ἦι γε μὴν ἕτερον, ὅμοιον ἐφάνη. ναί. ἦι ἄρα ταῦτόν, ἀνόμοιον ἔσται κατὰ τὸ ἐναντίον πάθος τῷ ὁμοιοῦντι πάθει. ὁμοίου δέ που τὸ ἕτερον; ναί. ἀνομοιώσει ἄρα τὸ ταῦτόν, ἢ οὐκ ἐναντίον ἔσται τῷ ἐτέρῳ.

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “And the different too is opposite to the same.”

AR: “It is.”

PA: “Then again it appeared to be the case that the one is the same as the others.”

AR: “Yes, it appeared so.”

PA: “And yet being the same as the others is the characteristic opposite to being different from the others.”

AR: “Certainly.”

PA: “But, at least insofar as it was different, it appeared to be like.”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “So, insofar as it is the same, it will be unlike based upon the characteristic opposite to the one by which it was characterised as like. And the different made it like, I presume?”

AR: “Yes.”

148c

PA: “So the same will make it unlike, or else it will not be opposite to the different.”

ἔοικεν. ὅμοιον ἄρα καὶ ἀνόμοιον ἔσται τὸ ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις, ἢ μὲν ἕτερον, ὅμοιον, ἢ δὲ ταυτόν, ἀνόμοιον. ἔχει γὰρ οὖν δὴ, ὡς ἔοικεν, καὶ τοιοῦτον λόγον. καὶ γὰρ τόνδε ἔχει. τίνα; ἢ ταυτόν πέπονθε, μὴ ἄλλοιον πεπονθέναι, μὴ ἄλλοιον δὲ πεπονθὸς μὴ ἀνόμοιον, μὴ ἀνόμοιον δὲ ὅμοιον εἶναι; ἢ δ' ἄλλο πέπονθεν, ἄλλοιον, ἄλλοιον δὲ ὃν ἀνόμοιον εἶναι. ἀληθῆ λέγεις. ταυτόν τε ἄρα ὃν τὸ ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις καὶ ὅτι ἕτερόν ἐστι, κατ' ἀμφοτέρω καὶ κατὰ ἐκάτερον, ὁμοίον

AR: “So it seems.”

PA: “So the one will be like and unlike the others, being like insofar as it is different, and unlike insofar as it is the same.”

AR: “Yes, it seems that such an argument as this also holds.”

PA: “And indeed the following holds too.”

AR: “Which is?”

PA: “Insofar as it has a characteristic that is the same, it has a characteristic that is not of another kind; and having a characteristic

that is not of another kind, it is not unlike; and not being unlike, it is like. Whereas insofar as it has another characteristic, it is of another kind, and being of another kind, is unlike.”

AR: “That’s true.”

148d

PA: “So the one, being the same as the others and because it is different, on both grounds and on either ground, would be both like and unlike the others.”

τε ἂν εἴη καὶ ἀνόμοιον τοῖς ἄλλοις. πάνυ γε. οὐκοῦν καὶ ἑαυτῷ ὡσαύτως, ἐπεὶ περ ἕτερόν τε ἑαυτοῦ καὶ ταύτὸν ἑαυτῷ ἐφάνη, κατ’ ἀμφοτέρω καὶ κατὰ ἑκάτερον ὅμοιον τε καὶ ἀνόμοιον φανήσεται; ἀνάγκη. τί δὲ δή; περὶ τοῦ ἅπτεσθαι τὸ ἐν αὐτοῦ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων καὶ τοῦ μὴ ἅπτεσθαι περὶ πῶς ἔχει, σκοπεῖ. σκοπῶ. αὐτὸ γάρ που ἐν ἑαυτῷ ὅλῳ τὸ ἐν ἐφάνη ὄν. ὀρθῶς. οὐκοῦν καὶ ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις τὸ ἔν; ναί. ἥ μὲν ἄρα ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις,

AR: “Certainly.”

PA: “In relation to itself too, in like manner, since it appeared to be different from itself and the same as itself, on both grounds and on either, it will prove to be both like and unlike itself.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “What about this? Consider the question of the one touching and not touching itself and the others.”

AR: “I am.”

PA: “Indeed, the one somehow appeared to be in itself as a whole.”

AR: “Correct.”

PA: “Now, won’t the one also be in the others?”

AR: “Yes.”

148e

PA: “Then, insofar as it is in the others, it would touch the others, while insofar as it is in itself, it would be prevented from touching the others, and being in itself, would touch itself.”

τῶν ἄλλων ἄπτοιο ἄν· ἥ δὲ αὐτὸ ἐν ἑαυτῷ, τῶν μὲν ἄλλων ἀπείργοιτο ἄπτεσθαι, αὐτὸ δὲ αὐτοῦ ἄπτοιο ἄν ἐν ἑαυτῷ ὄν. φαίνεται. οὕτω μὲν δὴ ἄπτοιο ἄν τὸ ἐν αὐτοῦ τε καὶ τῶν ἄλλων. ἄπτοιο. τί δὲ τῆδε; ἄρ' οὐ πᾶν τὸ μέλλον ἄψεσθαι τινος ἐφεξῆς δεῖ κεῖσθαι ἐκείνῳ οὗ μέλλει ἄπτεσθαι, ταύτην τὴν ἔδραν κατέχον ἢ ἄν μετ' ἐκείνην ἥ ἔδρα ἥ ἄν κέηται, ἄπτεται; ἀνάγκη. καὶ τὸ ἐν ἄρα εἰ μέλλει αὐτὸ αὐτοῦ ἄψεσθαι, ἐφεξῆς δεῖ εὐθὺς μετὰ ἑαυτὸ κεῖσθαι, τὴν ἐχομένην χώραν κατέχον ἐκείνης ἐν ἣ αὐτὸ ἐστίν. δεῖ γὰρ οὖν. οὐκοῦν δύο μὲν ὄν τὸ ἐν ποιήσειεν

AR: “So it appears.”

PA: “Thus the one, then, would touch both itself and the others.”

AR: “It would.”

PA: “What about this then? Mustn't everything that is going to touch something lie next to whatever it is going to touch, occupying the position that lies alongside the position occupied by whatever it touches?”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “So the one then, if it is going to touch itself, must lie right next to itself, occupying a place adjacent to the place that itself is in.”

AR: “Yes, it must do this.”

149a

PA: “Now, the one could do this by being two. It could then be in two places at the same time. But as long as it is one, how could it do so of itself?”

ἄν ταῦτα καὶ ἐν δυοῖν χώραιν ἅμα γένοιτο· ἕως δ' ἂν ἥ ἓν, οὐκ ἐθελήσει; οὐ γὰρ οὖν. ἡ αὐτὴ ἄρα ἀνάγκη τῷ ἐνὶ μήτε δύο εἶναι μήτε ἄπτεσθαι αὐτῷ αὐτοῦ. ἡ αὐτή. ἀλλ' οὐδὲ μὴν τῶν ἄλλων ἄπτεται. τί δὴ; ὅτι, φαμέν, τὸ μέλλον ἄψεσθαι χωρὶς ὄν ἐφεξῆς δεῖ ἐκείνῳ εἶναι οὗ μέλλει

ἄψεσθαι, τρίτον δὲ αὐτῶν ἐν μέσῳ μηδὲν εἶναι. ἀληθῆ. δύο ἄρα δεῖ τὸ ὀλίγιστον εἶναι, εἰ μέλλει ἅψις εἶναι. δεῖ. ἐὰν δὲ τοῖν δυοῖν ὅροιν τρίτον προσγένηται ἐξῆς, αὐτὰ

AR: “It could not.”

PA: “So by the same necessity that makes it the case that the one is not two, it must not touch itself either.”

AR: “The same.”

PA: “Nor indeed will it touch the others.”

AR: “Why is that?”

PA: “Because, according to us, whatever is going to touch must be separate from and next to whatever it will touch, without any third thing in between them.”

AR: “True.”

PA: “So, if there is to be contact, there must be at least two things.”

AR: “There must.”

149b

PA: “And if to the two, the two distinct things, a third is added next to them, they will be three, and the contacts two.”

μὲν τρία ἔσται, αἱ δὲ ἅψεις δύο. ναί. καὶ οὕτω δὴ αἰεὶ ἐνὸς προσγιγνομένου μία καὶ ἅψις προσγίγνεται, καὶ συμβαίνει τὰς ἅψεις τοῦ πλήθους τῶν ἀριθμῶν μιᾷ ἐλάττους εἶναι. ᾧ γὰρ τὰ πρῶτα δύο ἐπλεονέκτησεν τῶν ἅψεων εἰς τὸ πλείω εἶναι τὸν ἀριθμὸν ἢ τὰς ἅψεις, τῷ ἴσῳ τούτῳ καὶ ὁ ἔπειτα ἀριθμὸς πᾶς πασῶν τῶν ἅψεων πλεονεκτεῖ· ἥδη

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “And in this way then, by continually adding one thing, one contact is also added, and it follows that the contacts are fewer by one than the quantity of numbers. For by whatever the first two exceed the contacts, in being more in a number than the contacts, any succeeding

number also exceeds all the contacts by an amount equal to this. For with every remaining addition, one is added to the number and one contact is added to the contacts at the same time.”

149c

AR: “Correct.”

γὰρ τὸ λοιπὸν ἅμα ἔν τε τῷ ἀριθμῷ προσγίγνεται καὶ μία ἄψις ταῖς ἄψεσιν. ὀρθῶς. ὅσα ἄρα ἐστὶν τὰ ὄντα τὸν ἀριθμόν, ἀεὶ μιᾷ αἱ ἄψεις ἐλάττους εἰσὶν αὐτῶν. ἀληθῆ. εἰ δέ γε ἔν μόνον ἐστίν, δυὰς δὲ μὴ ἔστιν, ἄψις οὐκ ἂν εἴη. πῶς γάρ; οὐκουν, φαμέν, τὰ ἄλλα τοῦ ἐνὸς οὔτε ἔστιν οὔτε μετέχει αὐτοῦ, εἴπερ ἄλλα ἐστίν. οὐ γάρ. οὐκ ἄρα ἔνεστιν ἀριθμὸς ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις, ἐνὸς μὴ ἐνόοντος ἐν αὐτοῖς. πῶς γάρ; οὔτ’ ἄρα ἔστι τὰ ἄλλα οὔτε δύο οὔτε

PA: “So, whatever the number of things that are, the contacts are always one fewer than them.”

AR: “True.”

PA: “And yet if there is only one, and there is no two, there could be no contact.”

AR: “No, how could there be?”

PA: “Now, according to us, things other than one are neither one, nor do they partake of it if they are indeed other.”

AR: “No indeed.”

PA: “So number is not in the others since one is not in them.”

AR: “Certainly not.”

149d

PA: “So the others are neither one nor two, nor do they possess the name of any other number.”

ἄλλου ἀριθμοῦ ἔχοντα ὄνομα οὐδέν. οὐ. τὸ ἐν ἄρα μόνον ἐστὶν ἔν, καὶ δυὰς οὐκ ἂν εἴη. οὐ φαίνεται. ἄψις ἄρα οὐκ ἔστιν δυοῖν μὴ ὄντοιν. οὐκ ἔστιν. οὔτ’ ἄρα τὸ ἐν τῶν ἄλλων ἄπτεται οὔτε τὰ ἄλλα τοῦ ἐνός, ἐπέπερ

ἄψις οὐκ ἔστιν. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. οὕτω δὴ κατὰ πάντα ταῦτα τὸ ἐν τῶν τε ἄλλων καὶ ἑαυτοῦ ἄπτεταί τε καὶ οὐχ ἄπτεται. ἔοικεν. ἄρ' οὖν καὶ ἴσον ἐστὶ καὶ ἄνισον αὐτῷ τε καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις; πῶς; εἰ μείζον εἶη τὸ ἐν ἢ τᾶλλα ἢ ἔλαττον,

AR: "They do not."

PA: "So the one alone is one, and there could not be two."

AR: "Apparently not."

PA: "And in the absence of two, there is no contact."

AR: "There is not."

PA: "So the one does not touch the others nor the others the one, since there is no contact."

AR: "Indeed not."

PA: "Accordingly, on the basis of all this, the one both touches and does not touch itself and the others."

AR: "So it seems."

PA: "Well then, is the one also equal and unequal both to itself and to the others?"

AR: "In what way?"

149e

PA: "If the one were greater or lesser than the others, or the others for their part were greater or lesser than the one, they could not be greater or lesser than one another by their own being, by the one being one and the others being other than one, could they? But if in addition to being like this each were to possess equality, they would be equal to one another. But if the others had greatness while the one had smallness, or the one had greatness while the others had smallness, whatever form had greatness added to it would be greater, while that to which smallness was added would be lesser."

ἢ αὖ τὰ ἄλλα τοῦ ἐνὸς μείζω ἢ ἐλάττω, ἄρα οὐκ ἂν τῷ μὲν ἐν εἶναι τὸ ἐν καὶ τᾶλλα ἄλλα τοῦ ἐνὸς οὔτε τι μείζω οὔτε τι ἐλάττω ἂν εἴη ἀλλήλων αὐταῖς γε ταύταις ταῖς οὐσίαις; ἀλλ' εἰ μὲν πρὸς τῷ τοιαῦτα εἶναι ἐκάτερα ἰσότητα ἔχοιεν, ἴσα ἂν εἴη πρὸς ἀλλήλα· εἰ δὲ τὰ μὲν μέγεθος, τὸ δὲ σμικρότητα, ἢ καὶ μέγεθος μὲν τὸ ἐν, σμικρότητα δὲ τᾶλλα, ὁποτέρῳ μὲν τῷ εἶδει μέγεθος προσείη, μείζον ἂν εἴη, ᾧ δὲ σμικρότης, ἔλαττον; ἀνάγκη. οὐκοῦν ἐστὸν γέ τινε τούτῳ εἶδη, τό τε μέγεθος καὶ ἡ σμικρότης; οὐ γὰρ ἂν που μὴ ὄντε γε ἐναντίῳ τε ἀλλήλοιν εἴτην καὶ ἐν τοῖς

150a

AR: “Necessarily.”

οὔσιν ἐγγιγνοίσθην. πῶς γὰρ ἂν; εἰ ἄρα ἐν τῷ ἐνὶ σμικρότης ἐγγίγνεται, ἦτοι ἐν ὅλῳ ἂν ἢ ἐν μέρει αὐτοῦ ἐνείη. ἀνάγκη. τί δ' εἰ ἐν ὅλῳ ἐγγίγνοιτο; οὐχὶ ἢ ἐξ ἴσου ἂν τῷ ἐνὶ δι' ὅλου αὐτοῦ τεταμένη εἴη ἢ περιέχουσα αὐτό; δῆλον δῆ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐκ ἐξ ἴσου μὲν οὔσα ἡ σμικρότης τῷ ἐνὶ ἴσῃ ἂν αὐτῷ εἴη, περιέχουσα δὲ μείζων; πῶς δ' οὐ; δυνατόν οὖν σμικρότητα ἴσῃ τῳ εἶναι ἢ μείζω τινός, καὶ πράττειν τὰ μεγέθους τε καὶ ἰσότητος, ἀλλὰ

PA: “So there are these two forms, largeness and smallness, are there not? For if somehow there were not, they could not be opposite to one another, nor could they occur in things that are.”

AR: “No, how could they?”

PA: “Now, if smallness occurs in the one, it would be present either in the whole or in part of it.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “What if it were to occur in the whole? Wouldn't it either be extended equally throughout the whole of the one, or else encompass it?”

AR: “Of course.”

150b

PA: “Now, smallness, by being equally with the one, would be equal to it, while by encompassing the one, wouldn’t it be greater than the one?”

μη τὰ ἐαυτῆς; ἀδύνατον. ἐν μὲν ὅλῳ ἄρα τῷ ἐνὶ οὐκ ἂν εἴη σμικρότης, ἀλλ’ εἴπερ, ἐν μέρει. ναί. οὐδέ γε ἐν παντὶ αὖ τῷ μέρει· εἰ δὲ μή, ταῦτα ποιήσει ἅπερ πρὸς τὸ ὅλον· ἴση ἔσται ἢ μείζων τοῦ μέρους ἐν ᾧ ἂν αἰεὶ ἐνῇ. ἀνάγκη. οὐδενί ποτε ἄρα ἐνέσται τῶν ὄντων σμικρότης, μήτ’ ἐν μέρει μήτ’ ἐν ὅλῳ ἐγγιγνομένη· οὐδέ τι ἔσται σμικρὸν πλὴν αὐτῆς σμικρότητος. οὐκ ἔοικεν. οὐδ’ ἄρα μέγεθος ἐνέσται ἐν αὐτῷ· μείζον γὰρ ἂν τι εἴη ἄλλο καὶ

AR: “Inevitably.”

PA: “Now, can smallness be equal to or greater than something, and do what belongs to equality or to greatness rather than what belongs to itself?”

AR: “Impossible.”

PA: “So smallness could not be in the one as a whole, but in part, if so at all.”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “But not in the entire part, otherwise it will act in the same way as it did towards the whole. It will either be equal to or greater than whatever part it would always be in.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

150c

PA: “So smallness will never be in any of the things that are, since it occurs neither in a part nor in the whole, nor will anything be small except smallness itself.”

πλὴν αὐτοῦ μεγέθους, ἐκεῖνο ἐν ᾧ τὸ μέγεθος ἐνεῖη, καὶ ταῦτα σμικροῦ αὐτῷ οὐκ ὄντος, οὗ ἀνάγκη ὑπερέχειν, ἔάνπερ ἦ μέγα· τοῦτο δὲ ἀδύνατον, ἐπειδὴ σμικρότης οὐδαμοῦ ἔνι. ἀληθῆ. ἀλλὰ μὴν αὐτὸ μέγεθος οὐκ ἄλλου μείζον ἢ αὐτῆς σμικρότητος, οὐδὲ σμικρότης ἄλλου

ἔλαττον ἢ αὐτοῦ μεγέθους. οὐ γάρ. οὔτε ἄρα τὰ ἄλλα μείζω τοῦ ἐνὸς οὐδὲ ἐλάττω, μήτε μέγεθος μήτε σμικρότητα ἔχοντα, οὔτε

AR: “It seems not.”

PA: “So largeness will not be in the one either, for in that case, besides largeness itself, something else, whatever largeness was in, would be larger, and that would happen in the absence of the small, which the larger necessarily exceeds if it is actually to be large. But this is impossible since smallness is not in anything anywhere.”

AR: “True.”

150d

PA: “Furthermore, largeness itself is not larger than anything except smallness itself, nor is smallness less than anything but largeness itself.”

αὐτῷ τούτῳ πρὸς τὸ ἐν ἔχετον τὴν δύναμιν τὴν τοῦ ὑπερέχειν καὶ ὑπερέχεσθαι, ἀλλὰ πρὸς ἀλλήλῳ, οὔτε αὖ τὸ ἐν τούτοις οὐδὲ τῶν ἄλλων μείζον ἢ οὐδ’ ἔλαττον εἶη, μήτε μέγεθος μήτε σμικρότητα ἔχον. οὐκοῦν φαίνεται γε. ἄρ’ οὖν, εἰ μήτε μείζον μήτε ἔλαττον τὸ ἐν τῶν ἄλλων, ἀνάγκη αὐτὸ ἐκείνων μήτε ὑπερέχειν μήτε ὑπερέχεσθαι; ἀνάγκη. οὐκοῦν τό γε μήτε ὑπερέχον μήτε ὑπερεχόμενον πολλὴ ἀνάγκη ἐξ ἴσου εἶναι, ἐξ ἴσου δὲ ὃν ἴσον εἶναι. πῶς γὰρ

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “So the others are neither greater nor lesser than the one, since they possess neither greatness nor smallness. Nor do these two themselves possess the power of exceeding and being exceeded in relation to the one, but only in relation to one another. Nor again would the one be greater or lesser than these two or the others, since it possesses neither greatness nor smallness.”

AR: “It certainly appears not.”

PA: “Now, if the one is neither greater nor lesser than the others, must it necessarily neither exceed them nor be exceeded by them?”

AR: “Necessarily.”

150e

PA: “Now, that which neither exceeds nor is exceeded must necessarily be equally so, and being equally so, must be equal.”

οὐ; καὶ μὴν καὶ αὐτό γε τὸ ἐν πρὸς ἑαυτὸ οὕτως ἂν ἔχοι· μήτε μέγεθος ἐν ἑαυτῷ μήτε σμικρότητα ἔχον οὐτ’ ἂν ὑπερέχοιτο οὐτ’ ἂν ὑπερέχοι ἑαυτοῦ, ἀλλ’ ἐξ ἴσου ὃν ἴσον ἂν εἴη ἑαυτῷ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. τὸ ἐν ἄρα ἑαυτῷ τε καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις ἴσον ἂν εἴη. φαίνεται. καὶ μὴν αὐτό γε ἐν ἑαυτῷ ὃν καὶ περὶ ἑαυτὸ ἂν εἴη ἔξωθεν, καὶ περιέχον μὲν μεῖζον

AR: “Inevitably.”

PA: “And indeed the one itself would also be related in this way to itself, having neither largeness nor smallness in itself, it would neither exceed nor be exceeded by itself, but being equally so, it would be equal to itself.”

AR: “Yes, certainly.”

PA: “So the one would be equal to itself and the others.”

AR: “So it appears.”

151a

PA: “And indeed the one, because it is in itself, would surround itself from outside, and by encompassing itself would be greater than itself, while by being encompassed it would be lesser than itself, and thus the one would be greater than and lesser than itself.”

ἂν ἑαυτοῦ εἴη, περιεχόμενον δὲ ἔλαττον, καὶ οὕτω μεῖζον ἂν καὶ ἔλαττον εἴη αὐτὸ ἑαυτοῦ τὸ ἐν. εἴη γὰρ ἄν. οὐκοῦν καὶ τόδε ἀνάγκη, μηδὲν εἶναι ἐκτὸς τοῦ ἐνός τε καὶ τῶν ἄλλων; πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ἀλλὰ μὴν καὶ εἶναί που δεῖ τό γε ὃν ἀεί. ναί. οὐκοῦν τό γε ἔν τῳ ὃν ἐν μεῖζονι ἔσται ἔλαττον ὄν; οὐ γὰρ ἂν ἄλλως ἕτερον ἐν ἐτέρῳ εἴη. οὐ γάρ. ἐπειδὴ δὲ οὐδὲν ἕτερον ἔστι χωρὶς τῶν ἄλλων καὶ τοῦ ἐνός, δεῖ δὲ αὐτὰ ἐν τῳ εἶναι, οὐκ ἀνάγκη ἥδη ἐν ἀλλήλοις εἶναι, τά τε ἄλλα ἐν τῷ ἐνὶ καὶ τὸ ἐν ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις,

AR: “It would indeed.”

PA: “Is it necessary then, that outside of the one and the others, there is nothing?”

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “And yet what is, must always be somewhere.”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “Won’t whatever is in something, be so as a lesser in a greater? For in no other way could one thing be in another.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

151b

PA: “But since there is nothing else apart from the others and the one, and since they must be in something, mustn’t they necessarily then be in one another, the others in the one and the one in the others, or else be nowhere at all?”

ἢ μηδαμοῦ εἶναι; φαίνεται. ὅτι μὲν ἄρα τὸ ἐν ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις ἔνεστι, μείζω ἂν εἴη τὰ ἄλλα τοῦ ἐνός, περιέχοντα αὐτό, τὸ δὲ ἐν ἔλαττον τῶν ἄλλων, περιεχόμενον· ὅτι δὲ τὰ ἄλλα ἐν τῷ ἐνί, τὸ ἐν τῶν ἄλλων κατὰ τὸν αὐτὸν λόγον μείζον ἂν εἴη, τὰ δὲ ἄλλα τοῦ ἐνός ἐλάττω. ἔοικεν. τὸ ἐν ἄρα ἴσον τε καὶ μείζον καὶ ἔλαττόν ἐστιν αὐτό τε αὐτοῦ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων. φαίνεται. καὶ μὴν εἴπερ μείζον καὶ ἔλαττον καὶ ἴσον, ἴσων ἂν εἴη μέτρων καὶ πλειόνων καὶ ἐλαττόνων

AR: “Apparently so.”

PA: “So, because the one is in the others, the others would be greater than the one since they encompass it, while the one, since it is encompassed, would be lesser than the others. But because the others are in the one, the one would, by the same argument, be greater than the others and the others lesser than the one.”

AR: “So it seems.”

PA: “So the one is both equal to, and greater and lesser than, itself and the others.”

AR: “Apparently.”

151c

PA: “And indeed, if it is actually greater, and lesser, and equal, it would be of equal measures with itself and the others, and of more and fewer measures too, and since of measures, also of parts.”

αὐτῷ καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις, ἐπειδὴ δὲ μέτρων, καὶ μερῶν. πῶς δ' οὐ; ἴσων μὲν ἄρα μέτρων ὃν καὶ πλειόνων καὶ ἑλαττόνων, καὶ ἀριθμῷ ἕλαττον ἂν καὶ πλέον εἴη αὐτό τε αὐτοῦ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων καὶ ἴσον αὐτῷ τε καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις κατὰ ταῦτά. πῶς; ὥνπερ μεῖζόν ἐστι, πλειόνων που καὶ μέτρων ἂν εἴη αὐτῶν, ὅσων δὲ μέτρων, καὶ μερῶν καὶ ὥν ἕλαττον, ὡσαύτως καὶ οἷς ἴσον, κατὰ ταῦτά. οὕτως. οὐκοῦν ἑαυτοῦ μεῖζον καὶ ἕλαττον ὃν καὶ ἴσον ἴσων ἂν εἴη

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “Then being of equal measures and more and less, it would also be less and more in number than itself and the others, and equal both to itself and the others on the same basis.”

AR: “In what way?”

PA: “It would presumably be of more measures and parts than whatever it is greater than, and of as many parts as of measures, and likewise for whatever it is less than, and the same holds for whatever it is equal to.”

AR: “Quite so.”

151d

PA: “Then being greater and lesser than and equal to itself, wouldn't it be of equal and more and fewer measures to itself, and since of measures, also of parts?”

μέτρων καὶ πλειόνων καὶ ἑλαττόνων αὐτῷ, ἐπειδὴ δὲ μέτρων, καὶ μερῶν; πῶς δ' οὐ; ἴσων μὲν ἄρα μερῶν ὃν αὐτῷ ἴσον ἂν τὸ πλῆθος

αὐτῷ εἴη, πλείονων δὲ πλεον, ἐλαττόνων δὲ ἔλαττον τὸν ἀριθμὸν αὐτοῦ. φαίνεται. οὐκοῦν καὶ πρὸς τᾶλλα ὡσαύτως ἔξει τὸ ἓν; ὅτι μὲν μεῖζον αὐτῶν φαίνεται, ἀνάγκη πλεον εἶναι καὶ τὸν ἀριθμὸν αὐτῶν· ὅτι δὲ μικρότερον, ἔλαττον· ὅτι δὲ ἴσον μεγέθει, ἴσον καὶ τὸ πλῆθος εἶναι τοῖς ἄλλοις; ἀνάγκη. οὕτω δὴ αὖ, ὥς

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “Well then, being of equal parts with itself, it would be equal to itself in multiplicity, and being more than itself and less than itself, it would be more or less in number than itself.”

AR: “So it appears.”

PA: “Wouldn’t the one also relate to the others in the same way? Because it appears greater than them, it is necessarily more than them in number, and on the other hand, because it is smaller it is less in number, and because it appears equal in magnitude, it must be equal in multiplicity to the others.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

151e

PA: “Accordingly, it seems that the one will in turn be equal to, and more and less in number than itself and the others.”

ἔοικε, τὸ ἓν καὶ ἴσον καὶ πλεον καὶ ἔλαττον τὸν ἀριθμὸν αὐτό τε αὐτοῦ ἔσται καὶ τῶν ἄλλων. ἔσται. ἄρ’ οὖν καὶ χρόνου μετέχει τὸ ἓν, καὶ ἐστί τε καὶ γίγνεται νεώτερόν τε καὶ πρεσβύτερον αὐτό τε ἑαυτοῦ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων, καὶ οὔτε νεώτερον οὔτε πρεσβύτερον οὔτε ἑαυτοῦ οὔτε τῶν ἄλλων, χρόνου μετέχον; πῶς; εἶναι μὲν που αὐτῷ ὑπάρχει, εἴπερ ἓν ἔστιν. ναί. τὸ δὲ εἶναι ἄλλο τί ἐστιν ἢ μέθεξις οὐσίας μετὰ χρόνου τοῦ παρόντος, ὥσπερ

AR: “It will.”

152a

PA: “Now, does the one partake of time, and partaking of time, is it and does it come to be younger and older than itself and the others, and

neither younger nor older than itself and the others?"

τὸ ἦν μετὰ τοῦ παρεληλυθότος καὶ αὖ τὸ ἔσται μετὰ τοῦ μέλλοντος οὐσίας ἐστὶ κοινωνία; ἔστι γάρ. μετέχει μὲν ἄρα χρόνου, εἴπερ καὶ τοῦ εἶναι. πάνυ γε. οὐκοῦν πορευομένου τοῦ χρόνου; ναί. ἀεὶ ἄρα πρεσβύτερον γίγνεται ἑαυτοῦ, εἴπερ προέρχεται κατὰ χρόνον. ἀνάγκη. ἄρ' οὖν μεμνήμεθα ὅτι νεωτέρου γιγνομένου τὸ πρεσβύτερον πρεσβύτερον γίγνεται; μεμνήμεθα. οὐκοῦν ἐπειδὴ πρεσβύτερον ἑαυτοῦ γίγνεται τὸ ἔν, νεωτέρου ἂν γιγνομένου ἑαυτοῦ πρεσβύτερον

AR: "How?"

PA: "If one actually is, then 'to be' belongs to it."

AR: "Yes."

PA: "And is 'to be' anything other than participation in being along with present time, just as 'was' is communion with being along with past time, and 'will be' is communion along with future time."

AR: "It is indeed."

PA: "So the one partakes of time if it does indeed partake of being."

AR: "Certainly."

PA: "Of time that is advancing?"

AR: "Yes."

152b

PA: "So the one continually becomes older than itself if it actually advances according to time."

γίγνοιτο; ἀνάγκη. γίγνεται μὲν δὴ νεώτερόν τε καὶ πρεσβύτερον αὐτοῦ οὕτω. ναί. ἔστι δὲ πρεσβύτερον ἄρ' οὐχ ὅταν κατὰ τὸν νῦν χρόνον ἢ γιγνόμενον τὸν μεταξὺ τοῦ ἦν τε καὶ ἔσται; οὐ γάρ που πορευόμενόν γε ἐκ τοῦ ποτὲ εἰς τὸ ἔπειτα ὑπερβήσεται τὸ νῦν. οὐ γάρ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐκ ἐπίσχει τότε τοῦ γίγνεσθαι πρεσβύτερον, ἐπειδὴν

AR: "Necessarily."

PA: “Now, do we remember that whatever becomes older becomes older than something that becomes younger?”

AR: “We do.”

PA: “Therefore, since the one becomes older than itself, wouldn’t it become older while becoming younger than itself?”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “In this way then, it becomes younger and older than itself.”

AR: “Yes.”

152c

PA: “But it is actually older, is it not, whenever in coming to be it is at the present moment, in between what was and what will be? For as it proceeds from what was to what will be, it will not, I presume, step over the present.”

τῷ νῦν ἐντύχῃ, καὶ οὐ γίγνεται, ἀλλ’ ἔστι τότ’ ἤδη πρεσβύτερον; προῖον γὰρ οὐκ ἂν ποτε ληφθεῖν ὑπὸ τοῦ νῦν. τὸ γὰρ προῖον οὕτως ἔχει ὡς ἀμφοτέρων ἐφάπτεσθαι, τοῦ τε νῦν καὶ τοῦ ἔπειτα, τοῦ μὲν νῦν ἀφιέμενον, τοῦ δ’ ἔπειτα ἐπιλαμβάνόμενον, μεταξὺ ἀμφοτέρων γιγνόμενον, τοῦ τε ἔπειτα καὶ τοῦ νῦν. ἀληθῆ. εἰ δέ γε ἀνάγκη μὴ παρελθεῖν τὸ νῦν πᾶν τὸ γιγνόμενον, ἐπειδὴν κατὰ τοῦτο ἦ,

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “Well, won’t it then cease from becoming older whenever it encounters the present? Then it is not becoming older since it is already older. For while advancing it would never be grasped by the present. For that which is advancing is in a situation whereby it is in touch with both the present and what will be, letting go of the present while grasping what will be, as it is becoming in between both what will be and the present.”

AR: “True.”

152d

PA: “But if anything that is becoming must necessarily not evade the present, then whenever it is, at this it ceases from its becoming, and then actually is whatever it happened to be becoming.”

ἐπίσχει αἰεὶ τοῦ γίγνεσθαι καὶ ἔστι τότε τοῦτο ὅτι ἂν τύχη γιγνόμενον. φαίνεται. καὶ τὸ ἐν ἄρα, ὅταν πρεσβύτερον γιγνόμενον ἐντύχη τῷ νῦν, ἐπέσχεν τοῦ γίγνεσθαι καὶ ἔστι τότε πρεσβύτερον. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. οὐκοῦν οὐπὲρ ἐγίγνετο πρεσβύτερον, τούτου καὶ ἔστιν· ἐγίγνετο δὲ αὐτοῦ; ναί. ἔστι δὲ τὸ πρεσβύτερον νεωτέρου πρεσβύτερον; ἔστιν. καὶ νεώτερον ἄρα τότε αὐτοῦ ἐστὶ τὸ ἔν, ὅταν πρεσβύτερον γιγνόμενον ἐντύχη τῷ νῦν. ἀνάγκη. τό γε μὴν

AR: “Apparently.”

PA: “And so the one, as it is becoming older, ceases becoming older and is actually older whenever, as it is becoming older, it encounters the present.”

AR: “Yes, certainly.”

PA: “Now, it is actually older than whatever it was becoming older than, and wasn’t it becoming older than itself?”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “Is the older, older than the younger?”

AR: “It is.”

PA: “And so the one is then younger than itself whenever, as it is becoming older, it encounters the present.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

152e

PA: “And yet, the present is always present to the one throughout its entire being, for whenever the one is, it always is in the present.”

νῦν αἰεὶ πάρεστι τῷ ἐνὶ διὰ παντὸς τοῦ εἶναι· ἔστι γὰρ αἰεὶ νῦν ὅτανπερ ᾗ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; αἰεὶ ἄρα ἐστὶ τε καὶ γίγνεται πρεσβύτερον ἑαυτοῦ καὶ νεώτερον τὸ ἔν. ἔοικεν. πλείω δὲ χρόνον αὐτὸ ἑαυτοῦ ἔστιν ἢ γίγνεται,

ἢ τὸν ἴσον; τὸν ἴσον. ἀλλὰ μὴν τὸν γε ἴσον χρόνον ἢ γιγνόμενον ἢ ὄν τὴν αὐτὴν ἡλικίαν ἔχει. πῶς δ' οὐ; τὸ δὲ τὴν αὐτὴν ἡλικίαν ἔχον οὔτε πρεσβύτερον οὔτε νεώτερόν ἐστιν. οὐ γάρ. τὸ ἐν ἅρα τὸν ἴσον χρόνον αὐτὸ ἑαυτῷ καὶ γιγνόμενον καὶ ὄν οὔτε νεώτερον οὔτε πρεσβύτερον ἑαυτοῦ ἐστιν οὐδὲ γίγνεται. οὐ μοι δοκεῖ. τί δέ; τῶν ἄλλων; οὐκ ἔχω λέγειν.

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “So the one always is, and always becomes, older and younger than itself.”

AR: “So it seems.”

PA: “Now, is it, or is it becoming, for a longer time than itself, or for an equal time?”

AR: “Equal.”

PA: “But whatever is always becoming for an equal time is the same age.”

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “And whatever is the same age is neither younger nor older.”

AR: “Indeed.”

PA: “Then the one, since it is and is becoming for a time that is equal to itself, neither is nor is becoming, younger or older than itself.”

AR: “It seems not.”

PA: “Well then, what about the others?”

AR: “I can’t say.”

153a

PA: “Well, you can say that things other than the one, if they are indeed things that are different rather than a thing that is different, are more than one. For a different thing would be one, while different things are more than one and would be possessed of multiplicity.”

τόδε γε μὴν ἔχεις λέγειν, ὅτι τὰ ἄλλα τοῦ ἑνός, εἴπερ ἕτερά ἐστιν, ἀλλὰ μὴ ἕτερον, πλείω ἐστὶν ἑνός· ἕτερον μὲν γὰρ ὃν ἐν ἅν ἦν, ἕτερα δὲ ὄντα πλείω ἑνός ἐστι καὶ πλῆθος ἅν ἔχοι. ἔχοι γὰρ ἅν. πλῆθος δὲ ὃν ἀριθμοῦ πλείονος ἅν μετέχοι ἢ τοῦ ἑνός. πῶς δ' οὐ; τί οὖν; ἀριθμοῦ φήσομεν τὰ πλείω γίγνεσθαι τε καὶ γεγενέναι πρότερον, ἢ τὰ ἐλάττω; τὰ ἐλάττω. τὸ ὀλίγιστον ἄρα πρῶτον· τοῦτο

AR: “Yes, they would.”

PA: “And being multiple they would have a share of number greater than the one.”

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “What about this? Shall we maintain, with respect to number, that it is the more numerous or the less numerous that come into being, and have come into being earlier?”

AR: “The less numerous.”

153b

PA: “So the least of all is first of all and this is the one. Isn't this so?”

δ' ἔστι τὸ ἓν. ἡ γάρ; ναί. πάντων ἄρα τὸ ἐν πρῶτον γέγονε τῶν ἀριθμὸν ἐχόντων· ἔχει δὲ καὶ τᾶλλα πάντα ἀριθμόν, εἴπερ ἄλλα καὶ μὴ ἄλλο ἐστίν. ἔχει γάρ. πρῶτον δέ γε οἶμαι γεγενὸς πρότερον γέγονε, τὰ δὲ ἄλλα ὕστερον, τὰ δ' ὕστερον γεγενότα νεώτερα τοῦ πρότερον γεγενότος· καὶ οὕτως ἅν εἴη τᾶλλα νεώτερα τοῦ ἑνός, τὸ δὲ ἐν πρεσβύτερον τῶν ἄλλων. εἴη γὰρ ἅν. τί δὲ τόδε; ἄρ' ἅν εἴη τὸ ἐν παρὰ φύσιν τὴν αὐτοῦ

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “So, of everything that possesses number, the one has come into being first, and the others all possess number if they are indeed others, and not just an other.”

AR: “They possess it indeed.”

PA: “But the one, I think, having come into being first, has come into being earlier, while the others have come into being later, and thus the others would be younger than the one and the one older than the others.”

AR: “They would indeed.”

153c

PA: “What about this? Has the one come into being contrary to its own nature, or is that an impossibility?”

γεγονός, ἢ ἀδύνατον; ἀδύνατον. ἀλλὰ μὴν μέρη γε ἔχον ἐφάνη τὸ ἓν, εἰ δὲ μέρη, καὶ ἀρχὴν καὶ τελευτὴν καὶ μέσον. ναί. οὐκοῦν πάντων πρῶτον ἀρχὴ γίγνεται, καὶ αὐτοῦ τοῦ ἑνὸς καὶ ἐκάστου τῶν ἄλλων, καὶ μετὰ τὴν ἀρχὴν καὶ τᾶλλα πάντα μέχρι τοῦ τέλους; τί μὴν; καὶ μὴν μόριά γε φήσομεν ταῦτ' εἶναι πάντα τᾶλλα τοῦ ὅλου τε καὶ ἑνός, αὐτὸ δὲ ἐκεῖνο ἅμα τῇ τελευτῇ γεγονέναι ἓν τε καὶ ὅλον. φήσομεν γάρ. τελευτὴ δέ γε οἶμαι ὕστατον γίγνεται, τούτῳ

AR: “An impossibility.”

PA: “And yet the one was shown to have parts, and having parts, to have a beginning, an end and a middle.”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “Now, of all the parts of the one itself, and of each of the others, doesn't the beginning come into being first, and after the beginning, all the others until the end?”

AR: “Indeed.”

PA: “And shall we also say that all these others are parts of the whole, that is the one, and that this has itself come to be one and whole, simultaneously with the end?”

AR: “Yes, so we should say that.”

153d

PA: “And yet the end, I believe, comes into being last, and simultaneously with this, the one naturally comes into being. So that if

indeed the one itself necessarily comes into being in accord with its nature, it would naturally come into being later than the others, having come into being at the same time as the end.”

δ' ἅμα τὸ ἐν πέφυκε γίγνεσθαι ὥστ' εἴπερ ἀνάγκη αὐτὸ τὸ ἐν μὴ παρὰ φύσιν γίγνεσθαι, ἅμα τελευτῇ ἂν γεγονὸς ὕστατον ἂν τῶν ἄλλων πεφυκὸς εἴη γίγνεσθαι. φαίνεται. νεώτερον ἄρα τῶν ἄλλων τὸ ἐν ἐστὶ, τὰ δ' ἄλλα τοῦ ἐνὸς πρεσβύτερα. οὕτως αὖ μοι φαίνεται. τί δὲ δῆ; ἀρχὴν ἢ ἄλλο μέρος οἰοῦν τοῦ ἐνὸς ἢ ἄλλου ὁτουοῦν, ἐάνπερ μέρος ἢ ἄλλὰ μὴ μέρη, οὐκ ἀναγκαῖον ἐν εἶναι, μέρος γε ὄν; ἀνάγκη. οὐκοῦν τὸ ἐν ἅμα τε τῷ πρώτῳ γιγνομένῳ γίγνοιτ' ἂν καὶ

AR: “So it appears.”

PA: “So the one is younger than the others, and things other than the one are older than the one.”

AR: “Again, that’s how it appears to me.”

PA: “What about the beginning then, or any other part whatsoever of the one or of anything else at all? If it is a part, but is not parts, must it not of necessity be one, at least insofar as it is a part?”

AR: “Necessarily.”

153e

PA: “In that case the one would come into being at the same time as the first part that comes into being, and at the same time as the second, and is not left out of any of the other parts that come into being, whatever is added to anything, until, with the arrival of the last part, one whole has come into being, missing neither the middle part, nor the first, nor the last, nor any other part, in its generation.”

ἅμα τῷ δευτέρῳ, καὶ οὐδενὸς ἀπολείπεται τῶν ἄλλων γιγνομένων, ὅτιπερ ἂν προσγίγηται ὀψοῦν, ἕως ἂν πρὸς τὸ ἔσχατον διελθὼν ὅλον ἐν γένηται, οὔτε μέσου οὔτε πρώτου οὔτε ἐσχάτου οὔτε ἄλλου οὐδενὸς ἀπολειφθὲν ἐν τῇ γενέσει. ἀληθῆ. πᾶσιν ἄρα τοῖς ἄλλοις τὴν αὐτὴν ἡλικίαν ἴσχει τὸ ἐν· ὥστ' εἰ μὴ παρὰ φύσιν πέφυκεν αὐτὸ τὸ ἐν, οὔτε πρότερον οὔτε ὕστερον τῶν ἄλλων γεγονὸς ἂν εἴη, ἀλλ' ἅμα.

AR: “True.”

154a

PA: “Therefore, the one is the same age as all the others, and so, if the one itself is not by nature opposed to its own nature, it would not have come into being either before or after the others, but at the same time. And according to this account, the one would be neither older nor younger than the others, nor the others than the one. But according to the previous argument the one is both older and younger than the others, and the others are in like manner both older and younger than the one.”

καὶ κατὰ τοῦτον τὸν λόγον τὸ ἐν τῶν ἄλλων οὔτε πρεσβύτερον οὔτε νεώτερον ἂν εἴη, οὐδὲ τᾶλλα τοῦ ἐνός· κατὰ δὲ τὸν πρόσθεν πρεσβύτερόν τε καὶ νεώτερον, καὶ τᾶλλα ἐκείνου ὡσαύτως, πάνυ μὲν οὔν. ἔστι μὲν δὴ οὕτως ἔχον τε καὶ γεγονός. ἀλλὰ τί αὖ περὶ τοῦ γίνεσθαι αὐτὸ πρεσβύτερόν τε καὶ νεώτερον τῶν ἄλλων καὶ τᾶλλα τοῦ ἐνός, καὶ μήτε νεώτερον μήτε πρεσβύτερον γίνεσθαι; ἄρα ὥσπερ περὶ τοῦ εἶναι, οὕτω καὶ περὶ τοῦ γίνεσθαι ἔχει, ἢ ἐτέρως; οὐκ

AR: “Yes, certainly.”

PA: “So the one is, and has come into being in this way. But what about the one becoming both older and younger than the others, and the others than the one, and becoming neither older nor younger? Is whatever is the case in relation to being also the case in relation to becoming, or is it different?”

AR: “I cannot say.”

154b

PA: “Well, I can say this much at least. If one thing is indeed older than another, it would not be able to become even older by an age difference greater than the age difference when it first came into being, nor for its part could the younger become even younger by an increased amount. For equal amounts added to unequal amounts of time, or anything else at all, always make them differ by an amount equal to the initial difference.”

ἔχω λέγειν. ἀλλ' ἐγὼ τοσόνδε γε· εἰ καὶ ἔστιν πρεσβύτερον ἕτερον ἑτέρου, γίνεσθαι γε αὐτὸ πρεσβύτερον ἔτι ἢ ὡς τὸ πρῶτον εὐθὺς γενόμενον διήνεγκε τῇ ἡλικίᾳ οὐκ ἂν ἔτι δύναιτο, οὐδ' αὖ τὸ νεώτερον ὃν ἔτι νεώτερον γίνεσθαι· ἀνίσοις γὰρ ἴσα προστιθέμενα, χρόνῳ τε καὶ ἄλλῳ ὁπωρὺν, ἴσῳ ποιεῖ διαφέρειν ἀεὶ ὅσῳ περ ἂν τὸ πρῶτον διενέγκῃ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; οὐκ ἄρα τό γε ὃν τοῦ ἐνὸς ὄντος γίγνοιτ'

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “So that which is older or younger could never become older or younger if it does indeed always differ in age by an equal amount. It is, and has come to be, older in one case and younger in the other, but it is not becoming older or younger.”

AR: “True.”

154c

PA: “Then the one does not ever become either older or younger than the others that are older or younger than it.”

ἂν ποτε πρεσβύτερον οὐδὲ νεώτερον, εἴπερ ἴσῳ διαφέρει ἀεὶ τὴν ἡλικίαν· ἀλλ' ἔστι καὶ γέγονε πρεσβύτερον, τὸ δὲ νεώτερον, γίγνεται δ' οὐ. ἀληθῆ. καὶ τὸ ἐν ἄρα ὃν τῶν ἄλλων ὄντων οὔτε πρεσβύτερόν ποτε οὔτε νεώτερον γίγνεται. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. ὅρα δὲ εἰ τῇδε πρεσβύτερα καὶ νεώτερα γίγνεται. πῇ δὴ; ἥι τό τε ἐν τῶν ἄλλων ἐφάνη πρεσβύτερον καὶ τᾶλλα τοῦ ἐνός. τί οὖν; ὅταν τὸ ἐν τῶν ἄλλων πρεσβύτερον ᾖ, πλείῳ που χρόνον γέγονεν ἢ τὰ

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “But let's see if they become older or younger in the following way.”

AR: “How?”

PA: “In the way that the one appeared to be older than the others, and the others than the one.”

AR: “What of it?”

PA: “Whenever the one is older than the others, it has been becoming for a longer period of time than the others.”

AR: “Yes.”

154d

PA: “Consider this, then. If we add an equal amount of time to the greater and to the lesser time periods, will the greater differ from the lesser by an equal portion of time, or by a smaller portion?”

ἄλλα. ναί. πάλιν δὴ σκόπει· ἐὰν πλέονι καὶ ἐλάττονι χρόνῳ προστιθῶμεν τὸν ἴσον χρόνον, ἄρα τῷ ἴσῳ μορίῳ διοίσει τὸ πλεον τοῦ ἐλάττονος ἢ σμικροτέρῳ; σμικροτέρῳ. οὐκ ἄρα ἔσται, ὅτιπερ τὸ πρῶτον ἦν πρὸς τᾶλλα ἡλικία διαφέρον τὸ ἔν, τοῦτο καὶ εἰς τὸ ἔπειτα, ἀλλὰ ἴσον λαμβάνον χρόνον τοῖς ἄλλοις ἔλαττον αἰὲ τῇ ἡλικίᾳ διοίσει αὐτῶν ἢ πρότερον· ἢ οὐ; ναί. οὐκοῦν τό γε ἔλαττον διαφέρειν

AR: “By a smaller portion.”

PA: “So, whatever was the initial age difference between the one and the others, this will not be the same thereafter. Rather, having taken a time increment that is equal to the others, the one will always differ from them by a lesser portion than before. Isn’t this so?”

AR: “Yes.”

154e

PA: “Now, wouldn’t that which is lesser in age than it was before in relation to something else, become younger than before in relation to whatever it was previously older than?”

ἡλικία πρὸς τι ἢ πρότερον νεώτερον γίγνοιτ’ ἂν ἢ ἐν τῷ πρόσθεν πρὸς ἐκεῖνα πρὸς ᾧ ἦν πρεσβύτερον πρότερον; νεώτερον. εἰ δὲ ἐκεῖνο νεώτερον, οὐκ ἐκεῖνα αὖ τὰ ἄλλα πρὸς τὸ ἐν πρεσβύτερα ἢ πρότερον; πάνν γε. τὸ μὲν νεώτερον ἄρα γεγονὸς πρεσβύτερον γίγνεται πρὸς τὸ πρότερον γεγονός τε καὶ πρεσβύτερον ὄν, ἔστι δὲ οὐδέποτε πρεσβύτερον, ἀλλὰ γίγνεται αἰὲ ἐκείνου πρεσβύτερον· ἐκεῖνο μὲν γὰρ ἐπὶ τὸ νεώτερον ἐπιδίδωσιν, τὸ δ’ ἐπὶ τὸ πρεσβύτερον.

AR: “Yes, younger.”

PA: “And if that becomes younger, won’t those others, in turn, become older than before in relation to the one?”

AR: “Certainly.”

155a

PA: “So that which has come to be younger, becomes younger in relation to that which had previously come to be and still is older, yet although it is always becoming older than that, it never actually is older. For that advances towards the younger, while the younger advances towards the older. And the older, for its part, becomes younger than the younger in the very same way. For as they are both proceeding towards their opposites, they are becoming opposite to one another; the younger is becoming older than the older, while the older is becoming younger than the younger. But they could not actually become so. For if they had become so, they would no longer be becoming so, but would actually be so. But as matters stand, they are becoming older and younger than one another; the one is becoming younger than the others because it proved to be older and to have come into being earlier, while the others are becoming older than the one because they came into being later. And by the same argument, the others are also related in the same way to the one, since they proved to be older than the one and to have come into being earlier.”

τὸ δ' αὖ πρεσβύτερον τοῦ νεωτέρου νεώτερον γίγνεται ὡσαύτως. ἰόντε γὰρ αὐτοῖν εἰς τὸ ἐναντίον τὸ ἐναντίον ἀλλήλοιν γίνεσθον, τὸ μὲν νεώτερον πρεσβύτερον τοῦ πρεσβυτέρου, τὸ δὲ πρεσβύτερον νεώτερον τοῦ νεωτέρου· γενέσθαι δὲ οὐκ ἂν οἶω τε εἶτην. εἰ γὰρ γένοιτο, οὐκ ἂν ἔτι γίγνοιτο, ἀλλ' εἶεν ἄν. νῦν δὲ γίγνονται μὲν πρεσβύτερα ἀλλήλων καὶ νεώτερα· τὸ μὲν ἐν τῶν ἄλλων νεώτερον γίγνεται, ὅτι πρεσβύτερον ἐφάνη ὄν καὶ πρότερον

155b

AR: “Yes, this appears to be the case.”

γεγονός, τὰ δὲ ἄλλα τοῦ ἐνὸς πρεσβύτερα, ὅτι ὕστερα γέγονε. κατὰ δὲ τὸν αὐτὸν λόγον καὶ τᾶλλα οὕτω πρὸς τὸ ἐν ἴσχει, ἐπειδήπερ αὐτοῦ πρεσβύτερα ἐφάνη καὶ πρότερα γεγονότα. φαίνεται γὰρ οὖν οὕτως. οὐκοῦν ἢ μὲν οὐδὲν ἕτερον ἐτέρου πρεσβύτερον γίγνεται οὐδὲ νεώτερον, κατὰ τὸ ἴσῳ ἀριθμῷ ἀλλήλων ἀεὶ διαφέρειν, οὔτε τὸ ἐν τῶν ἄλλων πρεσβύτερον γίγνεται ἂν οὐδὲ νεώτερον, οὔτε τᾶλλα τοῦ ἐνός· ἢ δὲ ἄλλω ἀεὶ μορίῳ διαφέρειν ἀνάγκη

155c

PA: “Isn’t it the case then, that in so far as nothing becomes younger or older than anything else on the basis of always differing by an equal number, the one would not become older or younger than the others, nor the others than the one. While insofar as things that have come into being earlier necessarily differ from things that have come into being later, and the later from the earlier, by a portion that is never the same, things must in this way be becoming both older and younger than one another, the others than the one, and the one than the others?”

τὰ πρότερα τῶν ὑστέρων γενόμενα καὶ τὰ ὕστερα τῶν προτέρων, ταύτῃ δὴ ἀνάγκη πρεσβυτέρα τε καὶ νεώτερα ἀλλήλων γίνεσθαι τὰ τε ἄλλα τοῦ ἐνός καὶ τὸ ἐν τῶν ἄλλων; πάνυ μὲν οὖν. κατὰ δὴ πάντα ταῦτα τὸ ἐν αὐτό τε αὐτοῦ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων πρεσβύτερον καὶ νεώτερον ἔστι τε καὶ γίγνεται, καὶ οὔτε πρεσβύτερον οὔτε νεώτερον οὔτ’ ἔστιν οὔτε γίγνεται οὔτε αὐτοῦ οὔτε τῶν ἄλλων. παντελῶς μὲν οὖν. ἐπειδὴ δὲ χρόνου μετέχει τὸ ἐν καὶ τοῦ

AR: “Yes, certainly.”

PA: “Based upon all this then, the one is itself both older and younger than the others, and is becoming so, and neither is, nor is becoming, either older or younger than itself or the others.”

AR: “Yes, entirely so.”

155d

PA: “And since the one partakes of time and of becoming older and younger, mustn’t it necessarily partake of ‘was’, ‘will be’, and of ‘now’, if

it does indeed partake of time?”

πρεσβύτερόν τε καὶ νεώτερον γίνεσθαι, ἄρ' οὐκ ἀνάγκη καὶ τοῦ ποτὲ μετέχειν καὶ τοῦ ἔπειτα καὶ τοῦ νῦν, εἴπερ χρόνου μετέχει; ἀνάγκη. ἦν ἄρα τὸ ἐν καὶ ἔστι καὶ ἔσται καὶ ἐγίγνετο καὶ γίγνεται καὶ γενήσεται. τί μήν; καὶ εἴη ἄν τι ἐκείνῳ καὶ ἐκείνου, καὶ ἦν καὶ ἔστιν καὶ ἔσται. πάνυ γε. καὶ ἐπιστήμη δὴ εἴη ἄν αὐτοῦ καὶ δόξα καὶ αἴσθησις, εἴπερ καὶ νῦν ἡμεῖς περὶ αὐτοῦ πάντα ταῦτα πράττομεν. ὀρθῶς λέγεις. καὶ ὄνομα δὴ καὶ λόγος ἔστιν αὐτῷ, καὶ

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “So the one was, and is, and will be, and has become, and is becoming, and will become.”

AR: “Indeed.”

PA: “And something could be to that, and of that, and was, and is, and will be.”

AR: “Certainly.”

PA: “And there could then be knowledge of this, and opinion, and awareness, if we are in fact even now engaging in all these in relation to this.”

AR: “Correct.”

155e

PA: “And a name and an account belong to it, and it is named and described, and anything of this sort that happens to apply to the others applies also to the one.”

AR: “Yes, this is how matters stand, entirely so.”

155e

PA: “Then, let’s say for yet a third time: if the one is, as we have described it, being both one and many, and neither one nor many, and partaking of time, must it not of necessity sometimes partake of being because one is, and, indeed, sometimes not partake of being because one is not?”

ονομάζεται καὶ λέγεται· καὶ ὅσαπερ καὶ περὶ τὰ ἄλλα τῶν τοιούτων τυγχάνει ὄντα, καὶ περὶ τὸ ἐν ἔστιν. παντελῶς μὲν οὖν ἔχει οὕτως. ἔτι δὴ τὸ τρίτον λέγωμεν. τὸ ἐν εἰ ἔστιν οἶον διεληλύθαμεν, ἄρ' οὐκ ἀνάγκη αὐτό, ἐν τε ὄν καὶ πολλὰ καὶ μήτε ἐν μήτε πολλὰ καὶ μετέχον χρόνου, ὅτι μὲν ἔστιν ἐν, οὐσίας μετέχειν ποτέ, ὅτι δ' οὐκ ἔστι, μὴ μετέχειν αὖ ποτε οὐσίας; ἀνάγκη. ἄρ' οὖν, ὅτε μετέχει, οἶόν τε ἔσται τότε μὴ μετέχειν, ἢ ὅτε μὴ μετέχει, μετέχειν; οὐχ οἶόν τε. ἐν ἄλλῳ ἄρα χρόνῳ μετέχει καὶ ἐν ἄλλῳ οὐ μετέχει· οὕτω γὰρ ἂν μόνως τοῦ αὐτοῦ μετέχοι τε καὶ οὐ μετέχοι.

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “Now, when it is partaking will it then be able not to partake, or to partake when it is not partaking?”

AR: “It will not be able.”

156a

PA: “So it partakes at one time and does not partake at another, for only in this way could it partake and not partake of the same thing.”

ὀρθῶς. οὐκοῦν ἔστι καὶ οὗτος χρόνος, ὅτε μεταλαμβάνει τοῦ εἶναι καὶ ὅτε ἀπαλλάττεται αὐτοῦ; ἢ πῶς οἶόν τε ἔσται τοτὲ μὲν ἔχειν τὸ αὐτό, τοτὲ δὲ μὴ ἔχειν, ἐὰν μὴ ποτε καὶ λαμβάνῃ αὐτὸ καὶ ἀφίῃ; οὐδαμῶς. τὸ δὴ οὐσίας μεταλαμβάνειν ἄρα γε οὐ γίγνεσθαι καλεῖς; ἔγωγε. τὸ δὲ ἀπαλλάττεσθαι οὐσίας ἄρα οὐκ ἀπόλλυσθαι; καὶ πάνυ γε. τὸ ἐν δὴ, ὥς ἔοικε, λαμβάνον τε καὶ ἀφιέν οὐσίαν γίγνεται

AR: “Correct.”

PA: “Isn’t there also this time when it gets a share of being and gets rid of it? Or how will it be able to have something at one time, and not have the same thing at another, if it does not ever take hold of this and let it go?”

AR: “In no way at all.”

PA: “Well don’t you refer to getting a share of being as coming to be?”

AR: “I do.”

PA: “And to departing from being as ceasing to be?”

AR: “Yes, indeed.”

PA: “Then the one, it seems, in grasping and letting go of being, is coming into being and ceasing to be.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

156b

PA: “And being both one and many, and coming into being and ceasing to be, isn’t it the case that whenever it becomes one, its being many ceases to be, and whenever it becomes many, its being one ceases to be.”

τε καὶ ἀπόλλυται. ἀνάγκη. ἔν δὲ καὶ πολλὰ ὄν καὶ γιγνόμενον καὶ ἀπολλύμενον ἄρ’ οὐχ, ὅταν μὲν γίγνηται ἓν, τὸ πολλὰ εἶναι ἀπόλλυται, ὅταν δὲ πολλὰ, τὸ ἓν εἶναι ἀπόλλυται; πάνυ γε. ἔν δὲ γιγνόμενον καὶ πολλὰ ἄρ’ οὐκ ἀνάγκη διακρίνεσθαι τε καὶ συγκρίνεσθαι; πολλή γε. καὶ μὴν ἀνόμοιον γε καὶ ὅμοιον ὅταν γίγνηται, ὁμοιοῦσθαι τε καὶ ἀνομοιοῦσθαι; ναί. καὶ ὅταν μεῖζον καὶ ἔλαττον καὶ ἴσον, αὐξάνεσθαι τε καὶ φθίνειν καὶ ἰσοῦσθαι; οὕτως.

AR: “Certainly.”

PA: “And in becoming one and many mustn’t it necessarily be separated and combined?”

AR: “Very much so.”

PA: “And indeed whenever it becomes unlike and like, mustn’t it necessarily be likened and unlikened?”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “And whenever it becomes greater or lesser or equal, isn’t it increased, diminished or equalised?”

AR: “Quite so.”

156c

PA: “And whenever being in motion it comes to rest, and whenever being at rest it changes to moving, it must not itself be in any time at

all.”

ὅταν δὲ κινούμενόν τε ἴσται καὶ ὅταν ἐστὸς ἐπὶ τὸ κινεῖσθαι μεταβάλλῃ, δεῖ δήπου αὐτό γε μηδ’ ἐν ἐνὶ χρόνῳ εἶναι. πῶς δὴ; ἐστὸς τε πρότερον ὕστερον κινεῖσθαι καὶ πρότερον κινούμενον ὕστερον ἐστάναι, ἄνευ μὲν τοῦ μεταβάλλειν οὐχ οἶόν τε ἔσται ταῦτα πάσχειν. πῶς γάρ; χρόνος δέ γε οὐδεὶς ἔστιν, ἐν ᾧ τι οἶόν τε ἅμα μήτε κινεῖσθαι μήτε ἐστάναι. οὐ γὰρ οὕν. ἀλλ’ οὐδὲ μὴν μεταβάλλει ἄνευ τοῦ μεταβάλλειν. οὐκ εἰκός. πότ’ οὕν μεταβάλλει; οὔτε γὰρ ἐστὸς ὃν οὔτε κινούμενον μεταβάλλει, οὔτε ἐν

AR: “How so?”

PA: “Being previously at rest and afterwards in motion, or previously in motion and subsequently at rest, are impossible unless it undergoes change.”

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “And yet there is no time in which something can, simultaneously, be neither in motion nor at rest.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “But it cannot undergo change without changing.”

AR: “Not likely.”

156d

PA: “So when does it undergo change? For it does not change whilst at rest, or whilst in motion, or whilst in time.”

χρόνῳ ὃν. οὐ γὰρ οὕν. ἄρ’ οὕν ἔστι τὸ ἄτοπον τοῦτο, ἐν ᾧ τότ’ ἂν εἴη, ὅτε μεταβάλλει; τὸ ποῖον δὴ; τὸ ἐξαίφνης. τὸ γὰρ ἐξαίφνης τοιόνδε τι ἔοικε σημαίνειν, ὡς ἐξ ἐκείνου μεταβάλλον εἰς ἑκάτερον. οὐ γὰρ ἔκ γε τοῦ ἐστάναι ἐστῶτος ἔτι μεταβάλλει, οὐδ’ ἐκ τῆς κινήσεως κινουμένης ἔτι μεταβάλλει· ἀλλὰ ἡ ἐξαίφνης αὕτη φύσις ἄτοπός τις ἐγκάθεται μεταξὺ τῆς κινήσεως τε καὶ στάσεως,

AR: “It does not.”

PA: “Well, in that case, is there this strange thing in which it would then be when it changes?”

AR: “What sort of thing?”

156e

PA: “The moment. Indeed the moment seems to indicate something of this sort, such that there is change from the moment to either state. For a thing does not change from resting while still being at rest, nor does it change from moving while still being in motion. But the moment is this strange nature, inserted between motion and rest, being in no time at all, and indeed to this, and from this, the moving changes to being at rest and the resting to being in motion.”

ἐν χρόνῳ οὐδενὶ οὔσα, καὶ εἰς ταύτην δὴ καὶ ἐκ ταύτης τό τε κινούμενον μεταβάλλει ἐπὶ τὸ ἐστάναι καὶ τὸ ἐστὸς ἐπὶ τὸ κινεῖσθαι. κινδυεύει. καὶ τὸ ἐν δὴ, εἴπερ ἔστηκέ τε καὶ κινεῖται, μεταβάλλοι ἂν ἐφ’ ἐκάτερα—μόνως γὰρ ἂν οὕτως ἀμφοτέρα ποιοῖ—μεταβάλλον δ’ ἐξαίφνης μεταβάλλει, καὶ ὅτε μεταβάλλει, ἐν οὐδενὶ χρόνῳ ἂν εἴη, οὐδὲ κινεῖται ἂν τότε, οὐδ’ ἂν σταίη. οὐ γάρ. ἄρ’ οὖν οὕτω καὶ πρὸς τὰς ἄλλας μεταβολὰς ἔχει, ὅταν ἐκ τοῦ εἶναι εἰς τὸ ἀπόλλυσθαι

AR: “Quite likely.”

157a

PA: “And the one then, if indeed it is both at rest and in motion, would change to both states, for only in this way could it do both. But in changing it changes in a moment, and when it changes it would be in no time at all, nor would it then be in motion, nor would it be at rest.”

μεταβάλλῃ ἢ ἐκ τοῦ μὴ εἶναι εἰς τὸ γίγνεσθαι, μεταξύ τινων τότε γίγνεται κινήσεων τε καὶ στάσεων, καὶ οὔτε ἔστι τότε οὔτε οὐκ ἔστι, οὔτε γίγνεται οὔτε ἀπόλλυται; ἔοικε γοῦν. κατὰ δὴ τὸν αὐτὸν λόγον καὶ ἐξ ἐνὸς ἐπὶ πολλὰ ἰὸν καὶ ἐκ πολλῶν ἐφ’ ἐν οὔτε ἓν ἐστίν οὔτε πολλά, οὔτε διακρίνεται οὔτε συγκρίνεται. καὶ ἐξ ὁμοίου ἐπὶ ἀνόμοιον καὶ ἐξ ἀνομοίου ἐπὶ ὁμοιον ἰὸν οὔτε ὁμοιον οὔτε ἀνόμοιον, οὔτε ὁμοιούμενον οὔτε ἀνομοιούμενον· καὶ

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “Is this also the case in relation to the other changes? Whenever it changes from being to ceasing to be, or from not being to coming into being, is it then coming to be in between certain motions and rests? And is it then the case that it neither is, nor is not, and is neither coming to be, nor ceasing to be?”

AR: “So it seems at any rate.”

157b

PA: “And by the same argument too, when going from one to many and from many to one, it is neither one nor many, neither separated nor combined. And when going from like to unlike and from unlike to like, it is neither like nor unlike, neither likened nor unlikened. When going from small to large, and to equal, and to their opposites, it is neither small nor large nor equal, and it would be neither increasing nor diminishing nor becoming equal.”

ἐκ μικροῦ ἐπὶ μέγα καὶ ἐπὶ ἴσον καὶ εἰς τὰ ἐναντία ἰὼν οὔτε μικρὸν οὔτε μέγα οὔτε ἴσον, οὔτε αὐξανόμενον οὔτε φθίνον οὔτε ἰσούμενον εἴη ἄν. οὐκ ἔοικε. ταῦτα δὴ τὰ παθήματα πάντ’ ἂν πάσχειν τὸ ἓν, εἰ ἔστιν. πῶς δ’ οὔ; τί δὲ τοῖς ἄλλοις προσήκοι ἂν πάσχειν, ἓν εἰ ἔστιν, ἄρα οὐ σκεπτέον; σκεπτέον. λέγωμεν δὴ, ἓν εἰ ἔστι, τᾶλλα τοῦ ἐνὸς τί χρὴ πεπονθέναι; λέγωμεν. οὐκοῦν ἐπεὶ περ ἄλλα τοῦ ἐνός ἐστιν, οὔτε τὸ ἓν ἐστι τᾶλλα· οὐ

AR: “It seems not.”

PA: “So, if the one is, it would undergo all these affections.”

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “Well, shouldn’t we also consider what it would be appropriate for the others to undergo if one is?”

AR: “We should consider this.”

PA: “In that case, should we state what things other than the one must undergo, if one is?”

AR: “We should.”

157c

PA: “Now, since they are indeed other than the one, the others are not the one, or else they would not be other than the one.”

γὰρ ἂν ἄλλα τοῦ ἑνὸς ἦν. ὀρθῶς. οὐδὲ μὴν στέρεται γε παντάπασι τοῦ ἑνὸς τᾶλλα, ἀλλὰ μετέχει πη. πῇ δὴ; ὅτι που τὰ ἄλλα τοῦ ἑνὸς μόρια ἔχοντα ἄλλα ἐστίν· εἰ γὰρ μόρια μὴ ἔχοι, παντελῶς ἂν ἔν εἴη. ὀρθῶς. μόρια δέ γε, φαμέν, τούτου ἐστὶν ὃ ἂν ὅλον ἦ. φαμέν γάρ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τό γε ὅλον ἔν ἐκ πολλῶν ἀνάγκη εἶναι, οὔ ἔσται μόρια τὰ μόρια ἕκαστον γὰρ τῶν μορίων οὐ πολλῶν μόριον χρή εἶναι, ἀλλὰ ὅλου. πῶς τοῦτο; εἴ τι πολλῶν μόριον εἴη,

AR: “Correct.”

PA: “But the others are not entirely deprived of the one either, but partake of it in some way.”

AR: “In what way?”

PA: “Things other than the one are presumably other because they have parts. Indeed if they were not to have parts they would be entirely one.”

AR: “Correct.”

PA: “But parts, we say, are parts of this, this whole.”

AR: “So we say.”

PA: “And yet the whole is necessarily one composed of many, of which the parts will be parts, for each of the parts must be a part not of multiplicities but of a whole.”

AR: “Why is that?”

157d

PA: “If something were to be a part of a multiplicity, among which it is itself included, it would presumably be part of itself which is impossible. And it would be a part of each of the others too if it were

actually part of them all. Indeed, not being part of this one, it will be a part of the others except for this one, and thus will not be part of each one, but not being part of each it will be part of none of the many. But it is not possible for something that is not a part of all of them to be a part or anything else at all of those things of which it is not a part of any one.”

ἐν οἷς αὐτὸ εἶη, ἑαυτοῦ τε δήπου μόριον ἔσται, ὃ ἐστὶν ἀδύνατον, καὶ τῶν ἄλλων δὴ ἑνὸς ἐκάστου, εἶπερ καὶ πάντων. ἑνὸς γὰρ μὴ ὄν μόριον, πλὴν τούτου τῶν ἄλλων ἔσται, καὶ οὕτως ἑνὸς ἐκάστου οὐκ ἔσται μόριον, μὴ ὄν δὲ μόριον ἐκάστου οὐδενὸς τῶν πολλῶν ἔσται. μηδενὸς δὲ ὄν πάντων τούτων τι εἶναι, ὧν οὐδενὸς οὐδέν ἐστι, καὶ μόριον καὶ ἄλλο ὅτιοῦν ἀδύνατον εἶναι. φαίνεται γέ δή. οὐκ ἄρα τῶν πολλῶν οὐδὲ πάντων τὸ μόριον μόριον, ἀλλὰ μιᾶς τινὸς ἰδέας καὶ

AR: “Apparently so.”

157e

PA: “So a part is not a part of a multiplicity or of all; it is rather a part of some one form that we call a whole, a complete one that has arisen from them all. A part would be part of this.”

ἑνὸς τινος ὃ καλοῦμεν ὅλον, ἐξ ἀπάντων ἓν τέλειον γεγονός, τούτου μόριον ἂν τὸ μόριον εἶη. παντάπασιν μὲν οὖν. εἰ ἄρα τᾶλλα μόρια ἔχει, καὶ τοῦ ὅλου τε καὶ ἑνὸς μετέχῃ. πάντῃ γε. ἓν ἄρα ὅλον τέλειον μόρια ἔχον ἀνάγκη εἶναι τᾶλλα τοῦ ἑνός. ἀνάγκη. καὶ μὴν καὶ περὶ τοῦ μορίου γε ἐκάστου ὁ αὐτὸς λόγος· καὶ γὰρ τοῦτο ἀνάγκη μετέχειν

AR: “Entirely so.”

PA: “So, if the others have parts, they would also have a share of the one and of the whole.”

AR: “Certainly.”

PA: “So things other than one must necessarily be one complete whole possessing parts.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

158a

PA: “And indeed, the same argument applies to each part. For these too must necessarily have a share of the one. For if each of them is a part, being each presumably indicates being distinct from the others and being by itself, if indeed it is to be each.”

τοῦ ἑνός. εἰ γὰρ ἕκαστον αὐτῶν μόνιον ἐστι, τό γε ἕκαστον εἶναι ἐν δήπου σημαίνει, ἀφωρισμένον μὲν τῶν ἄλλων, καθ’ αὐτὸ δὲ ὄν, εἴπερ ἕκαστον ἔσται. ὀρθῶς. μετέχοι δέ γε ἂν τοῦ ἑνός δηλον ὅτι ἄλλο ὄν ἢ ἔν· οὐ γὰρ ἂν μετεῖχεν, ἀλλ’ ἦν ἂν αὐτὸ ἔν. νῦν δὲ ἐνὶ μὲν εἶναι πλήν αὐτῷ τῷ ἐνὶ ἀδύνατόν που. ἀδύνατον. μετέχειν δέ γε τοῦ ἑνός ἀνάγκη τῷ τε ὅλῳ καὶ τῷ μορίῳ. τὸ μὲν γὰρ ἐν ὅλον ἔσται, οὗ μόρια τὰ μόρια· τὸ δ’ αὖ ἕκαστον ἐν μόνιον τοῦ ὅλου, ὃ ἂν ἦ

AR: “Correct.”

PA: “And yet it would of course have a share of the one while being other than one, or else it would not have a share of the one but would itself be one. But it is presumably impossible now for anything except the one itself to be one.”

AR: “Impossible.”

PA: “So both the whole and the part necessarily share in the one. For the whole will be one and the parts will be parts of that. While each part, in turn, that is part of the whole, would be one part of the whole.”

AR: “Quite so.”

158b

PA: “Won’t whatever shares in the one have a share while being different from the one?”

μόριον ὅλου. οὕτως. οὐκοῦν ἕτερα ὄντα τοῦ ἑνός μεθέξει τὰ μετέχοντα αὐτοῦ; πῶς δ’ οὐ; τὰ δ’ ἕτερα τοῦ ἑνός πολλά που ἂν εἴη· εἰ γὰρ μήτε ἐν μήτε ἑνός πλείω εἴη τᾶλλα τοῦ ἑνός, οὐδὲν ἂν εἴη. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. ἐπεὶ δέ γε πλείω ἑνός ἐστι τὰ τε τοῦ ἑνός μορίου καὶ τὰ τοῦ ἑνός ὅλου μετέχοντα, οὐκ ἀνάγκη ἤδη πλήθει ἁπειρα εἶναι αὐτά γε ἐκεῖνα τὰ μεταλαμβάνοντα

τοῦ ἑνός; πῶς; ὥδε ἴδωμεν. ἄλλο τι οὐχ ἔν ὄντα οὐδὲ μετέχοντα τοῦ ἑνὸς τότε, ὅτε μεταλαμβάνει αὐτοῦ, μεταλαμβάνει; δῆλα δῆ.

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “Things that are different from the one would presumably be many. Indeed if things other than the one were neither one nor more than one, they would be nothing.”

AR: “Indeed so.”

PA: “But since whatever gets a share of one part or one whole is more than one, it is necessary, is it not, that those things themselves that partake of the one must already be unlimited in multiplicity?”

AR: “How so?”

158c

PA: “Let’s look at the following. When they partake of the one they partake while neither being one, nor having a share of the one.”

οὐκοῦν πλήθῃ ὄντα, ἐν οἷς τὸ ἐν οὐκ ἔνι; πλήθῃ μέντοι. τί οὖν; εἰ ἐθέλομεν τῇ διανοίᾳ τῶν τοιούτων ἀφελεῖν ὥς οἱοί τέ ἐσμεν ὅτι ὀλίγιστον, οὐκ ἀνάγκη καὶ τὸ ἀφαιρεθὲν ἐκεῖνο, εἴπερ τοῦ ἑνὸς μὴ μετέχοι, πλήθος εἶναι καὶ οὐχ ἔν; ἀνάγκη. οὐκοῦν οὕτως αἰ σκοποῦντες αὐτὴν καθ’ αὐτὴν τὴν ἑτέραν φύσιν τοῦ εἶδους ὅσον ἂν αὐτῆς αἰ ὀρῶμεν ἄπειρον ἔσται πλήθει; παντάπασιν μὲν οὖν. καὶ μὴν ἐπειδάν γε

AR: “Obviously.”

PA: “Then they partake, don’t they, while being multiplicities in which the one is not present?”

AR: “Multiplicities indeed.”

PA: “What about this? If we wished, in thought, to take away as little as we possibly could from such multiplicities, wouldn’t the part that has been taken away necessarily be a multiplicity and not one, if in fact it does not partake of the one?”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “Now, continuing to consider the nature just by itself, different from the form, in this way won’t as much of it as we can ever discern be unlimited in multiplicity?”

AR: “Entirely so.”

158d

PA: “And indeed, whenever each part has become one part, the parts then have limit in relation to one another, and in relation to the whole, and so too does the whole in relation to the parts.”

ἐν ἑκάστων μῶριον μῶριον γένηται, πέρας ἤδη ἔχει πρὸς ἄλληλα καὶ πρὸς τὸ ὅλον, καὶ τὸ ὅλον πρὸς τὰ μῶρια. κομιδῇ μὲν οὖν. τοῖς ἄλλοις δὴ τοῦ ἐνὸς συμβαίνει ἐκ μὲν τοῦ ἐνὸς καὶ ἐξ ἑαυτῶν κοινωνησάντων, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἕτερόν τι γίνεσθαι ἐν ἑαυτοῖς, ὃ δὴ πέρας παρέσχε πρὸς ἄλληλα· ἢ δ’ ἑαυτῶν φύσις καθ’ ἑαυτὰ ἀπειρίαν. φαίνεται. οὕτω δὴ τὰ ἄλλα τοῦ ἐνὸς καὶ ὅλα καὶ κατὰ μῶρια ἄπειρά τέ ἐστι καὶ πέρατος μετέχει. πάνυ γε.

AR: “Yes, exactly.”

PA: “In that case, the consequence for things other than the one from the communion of themselves and the one is, it seems, that something different arises among themselves which provides limit in relation to one another, while by themselves their own nature provides limitlessness.”

AR: “So it appears.”

PA: “In this way then, things other than the one, both as wholes, or based upon parts, are limitless and have a share of limit.”

AR: “Certainly.”

158e

PA: “Are they not also both like and unlike one another and themselves?”

οὐκοῦν καὶ ὅμοιά τε καὶ ἀνόμοια ἀλλήλοις τε καὶ ἑαυτοῖς; πῇ δὴ; ἢ μὲν που ἄπειρά ἐστι κατὰ τὴν ἑαυτῶν φύσιν πάντα, ταῦτ' ὅν πεπονθότα ἂν εἴη ταῦτη. πάνυ γε. καὶ μὴν ἢ γε ἅπαντα πέρατος μετέχει, καὶ ταῦτη πάντ' ἂν εἴη ταῦτ' ὅν πεπονθότα. πῶς δ' οὐ; ἢ δέ γε πεπερασμένα τε εἶναι καὶ ἄπειρα πέπονθεν, ἐναντία πάθη ἀλλήλοις ὄντα ταῦτα τὰ

AR: “In what way?”

PA: “Insofar as they are all presumably unlimited based upon their own nature, they would in this way be characterised as the same.”

AR: “Certainly.”

PA: “And indeed, insofar as they all have a share of limit, they would all in this way also be characterised as the same.”

AR: “Of course.”

159a

PA: “And yet insofar as they have been characterised as both limited and limitless, they have been characterised by characteristics that are opposite to one another.”

πάθη πέπονθεν. ναί. τὰ δ' ἐναντία γε ὡς οἶόν τε ἀνομοιότατα. τί μὴν; κατὰ μὲν ἄρα ἐκότερον τὸ πάθος ὅμοια ἂν εἴη αὐτὰ τε αὐτοῖς καὶ ἀλλήλοις, κατὰ δ' ἀμφοτέρω ἀμφοτέρως ἐναντιώτατά τε καὶ ἀνομοιότατα. κινδυνεύει. οὕτω δὴ τὰ ἄλλα αὐτὰ τε αὐτοῖς καὶ ἀλλήλοις ὅμοιά τε καὶ ἀνόμοια ἂν εἴη. οὕτως. καὶ ταῦτα δὴ καὶ ἕτερα ἀλλήλων, καὶ κινούμενα καὶ ἐστῶτα, καὶ πάντα τὰ ἐναντία πάθη οὐκέτι χαλεπῶς εὐρήσομεν πεπονθότα τᾶλλα τοῦ ἑνός, ἐπεὶ περ καὶ

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “And the opposites are as unlike as possible.”

AR: “Indeed.”

PA: “So on the basis of either characteristic, they would be like themselves and one another, while on the basis of both characteristics,

they would be as unlike as possible, and as opposite as possible, in both ways.”

AR: “Quite likely.”

PA: “In this way then, the others themselves would be both like and unlike themselves and one another.”

AR: “So they would.”

159b

PA: “And since they actually proved to have these characteristics, we shall find with no further difficulty that things other than the one are the same as, and different from, one another, are in motion and at rest, and are characterised by all the opposite characteristics.”

ταῦτα ἐφάνη πεπονθότα. ὀρθῶς λέγεις. οὐκοῦν, εἰ ταῦτα μὲν ἤδη ἐῶμεν ὥς φανερά, ἐπισκοποῖμεν δὲ πάλιν ἐν εἰ ἔστιν, ἄρα καὶ οὐχ οὕτως ἔχει τὰ ἄλλα τοῦ ἐνός ἢ οὕτω μόνον; πάνυ μὲν οὖν. λέγωμεν δὴ ἐξ ἀρχῆς ἐν εἰ ἔστι, τί χρὴ τὰ ἄλλα τοῦ ἐνός πεπονθέναι. λέγωμεν γάρ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐ χωρὶς μὲν τὸ ἐν τῶν ἄλλων, χωρὶς δὲ τὰ ἄλλα τοῦ ἐνός εἶναι; τί δή; ὅτι που οὐκ ἔστι παρὰ ταῦτα ἕτερον, ὃ ἄλλο μὲν ἐστι τοῦ ἐνός, ἄλλο δὲ τῶν ἄλλων.

AR: “Correct.”

PA: “Well then, if at this stage we accept these outcomes as obvious, should we consider once more if one is, are things other than the one not so, or just so?”

AR: “Certainly.”

PA: “Then let us say from the beginning how things other than the one must be characterised if one is.”

AR: “Let’s say so.”

PA: “Now, must not the one be separate from the others, and the others be separate from the one?”

AR: “Why is that?”

159c

PA: “Because there is not, I presume, anything else besides these, that is other than the one and other than the others, for once the one and the others have been mentioned, everything has been spoken of.”

πάντα γὰρ εἴρηται, ὅταν ῥηθῇ τό τε ἓν καὶ τᾶλλα. πάντα γάρ. οὐκ ἄρα ἔτ' ἔστιν ἕτερον τούτων, ἐν ᾧ τό τε ἓν ἂν εἴη τῷ αὐτῷ καὶ τᾶλλα. οὐ γάρ. οὐδέποτε ἄρα ἐν αὐτῷ ἔστι τὸ ἓν καὶ τᾶλλα. οὐκ ἔοικεν. χωρὶς ἄρα· ναί. οὐδὲ μὴν μόριά γε ἔχειν φαμέν τὸ ὡς ἀληθῶς ἓν. πῶς γάρ; οὔτ' ἄρα ὅλον εἴη ἂν τὸ ἓν ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις οὔτε μόρια αὐτοῦ, εἰ χωρὶς τέ ἐστι τῶν ἄλλων καὶ μόρια μὴ ἔχει. πῶς

AR: “Yes, everything.”

PA: “So there is nothing further that is different from these, in which both the one and the others could be in the same.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “So the one and the others are never in the same.”

AR: “It seems not.”

PA: “So are they separate?”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “Now, according to us that which is truly one does not have parts.”

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “So the one as a whole, would not be in the others, nor would parts of it, if it is separate from the others and does not have parts.”

159d

AR: “Of course.”

γάρ; οὐδενὶ ἄρα τρόπῳ μετέχοι ἂν τᾶλλα τοῦ ἐνός, μήτε κατὰ μόνιον τι αὐτοῦ μήτε κατὰ ὅλον μετέχοντα. οὐκ ἔοικεν. οὐδαμῇ ἄρα ἐν τᾶλλα ἔστιν, οὐδ' ἔχει ἐν ἑαυτοῖς ἐν οὐδέν. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. οὐδ' ἄρα πολλὰ ἔστι τᾶλλα· ἐν γὰρ ἂν ἦν ἕκαστον αὐτῶν μόνιον τοῦ ὅλου, εἰ πολλὰ ἦν· νῦν δὲ οὔτε ἐν οὔτε πολλὰ οὔτε ὅλον οὔτε μόριά ἐστι τᾶλλα τοῦ ἐνός,

ἐπειδὴ αὐτοῦ οὐδαμῇ μετέχει. ὀρθῶς. οὐδ' ἄρα δύο οὐδὲ τρία οὔτε αὐτά ἐστι τὰ ἄλλα οὔτε ἕνεστιν ἐν αὐτοῖς,

PA: “So the others would not partake of the one in any way, since they partake neither of a part of it nor of the whole.”

AR: “It seems not.”

PA: “So the others are not one in any way, nor do they have any one in themselves.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “So the others are not many either, for each of them would be one part of the whole if they were many. But, as matters stand, things other than one are neither one nor many, neither a whole nor parts, since they do not partake of the one in any way.”

AR: “Correct.”

159e

PA: “So the others themselves are neither two nor three nor are these in them if they are indeed entirely deprived of the one.”

εἵπερ τοῦ ἐνὸς πανταχῇ στέρεται. οὕτως. οὐδὲ ὅμοια ἄρα καὶ ἀνόμοια οὔτε αὐτά ἐστι τῷ ἐνὶ τὰ ἄλλα, οὔτε ἕνεστιν ἐν αὐτοῖς ὁμοιότης καὶ ἀνομοιότης· εἰ γὰρ ὅμοια καὶ ἀνόμοια αὐτὰ εἴη ἢ ἔχοι ἐν ἑαυτοῖς ὁμοιότητα καὶ ἀνομοιότητα, δύο που εἶδη ἐναντία ἀλλήλοις ἔχοι ἂν ἐν ἑαυτοῖς τὰ ἄλλα τοῦ ἐνός. φαίνεται. ἦν δέ γε ἀδύνατον δυοῖν τινοῖν μετέχειν ἢ μὴδ' ἐνὸς μετέχει. ἀδύνατον. οὐτ' ἄρα ὅμοια οὐτ' ἀνόμοιά ἐστιν οὐτ' ἀμφοτέρω τᾶλλα.

AR: “This is so.”

PA: “So the others are themselves neither like and unlike the one, nor are likeness and unlikeness in them. For if they were like and unlike, or had likeness and unlikeness in themselves, things other than the one would presumably possess two forms in themselves that are opposite to one another.”

AR: “Apparently.”

PA: “But things that do not even partake of one could not possibly partake of any two.”

AR: “Impossible.”

PA: “So the others are neither like, nor unlike, nor both. For if they were like or unlike they would partake of one different form, and if they were both like and unlike they would partake of two opposite forms, but these outcomes have proved to be impossible.”

AR: “True.”

160a

PA: “Nor are they the same or different, nor are they in motion or at rest, nor are they coming into being or ceasing to be, nor are they greater or lesser or equal. Nor do they have any other characteristics of this sort. For if the others submit to being characterised by anything of this sort, they will also share in one and two and three and odd and even. But it turned out to be impossible for them to partake of these since they are entirely deprived of the one in every way.”

ὅμοια μὲν γὰρ ἂν ὄντα ἢ ἀνόμοια ἐνὸς ἂν τοῦ ἐτέρου εἶδους μετέχουσι, ἀμφοτέρω δὲ ὄντα δυοῖν τοῖν ἐναντίοι· ταῦτα δὲ ἀδύνατον ἐφάνη. ἀληθῆ. οὐδ’ ἄρα τὰ αὐτὰ οὐδ’ ἕτερα, οὐδὲ κινούμενα οὐδὲ ἐστῶτα, οὐδὲ γιγνόμενα οὐδὲ ἀπολλύμενα, οὐδὲ μείζω οὐδὲ ἐλάττω οὐδὲ ἴσα· οὐδὲ ἄλλο οὐδὲν πέπονθε τῶν τοιούτων· εἰ γάρ τι τοιοῦτον πεπονθέναι ὑπομένει τὰ ἄλλα, καὶ ἐνὸς καὶ δυοῖν καὶ τριῶν καὶ περιττοῦ καὶ ἀρτίου μεθεῖξαι, ὧν αὐτοῖς ἀδύνατον

AR: “Very true.”

160b

PA: “In which case, if one is, the one is everything, and both in relation to itself and in relation to the others in like manner, it is not even one.”

ἐφάνη μετέχειν τοῦ ἑνός γε πάντη πάντως στερομένοις. ἀληθέστατα. οὕτω δὲ ἔν ἐστιν, πάντα τέ ἐστι τὸ ἔν καὶ οὐδὲ ἔν ἐστι καὶ πρὸς ἑαυτὸ καὶ πρὸς τὰ ἄλλα ὡσαύτως. παντελῶς μὲν οὖν. εἶεν· εἰ δὲ δὴ μὴ ἔστι τὸ ἔν, τί χρή συμβαίνειν ἄρ' οὐ σκεπτέον μετὰ τοῦτο; σκεπτέον γάρ. τίς οὖν ἂν εἴη αὕτη ἢ ὑπόθεσις, εἰ ἔν μὴ ἔστιν; ἄρα τι διαφέρει τῆσδε, εἰ μὴ ἔν μὴ ἔστιν; διαφέρει μέντοι. διαφέρει μόνον, ἢ καὶ πᾶν

AR: “Entirely so.”

PA: “So be it. Next, should we not consider what the consequences must be if one is not?”

AR: “Yes, we should.”

PA: “Well, what would this hypothesis, ‘if one is not’, be? Does it differ at all from the hypothesis, ‘if not one is not’?”

AR: “It differs indeed.”

PA: “Does it just differ, or is saying ‘if not one is not’ the complete opposite to saying ‘if one is not’?”

AR: “It is the complete opposite.”

160c

PA: “What if someone were to say ‘if largeness is not’ or ‘if smallness is not’, or anything else of that sort, would it be obvious in each case that he is saying that a different thing is that which is not?”

τοῦναντίον ἐστὶν εἰπεῖν εἰ μὴ ἔν μὴ ἔστι τοῦ εἰ ἔν μὴ ἔστιν; πᾶν τοῦναντίον. τί δ’ εἴ τις λέγει εἰ μέγεθος μὴ ἔστιν ἢ σμικρότης μὴ ἔστιν ἢ τι ἄλλο τῶν τοιούτων, ἄρα ἐφ’ ἐκάστου ἂν δηλοῖ ὅτι ἕτερόν τι λέγει τὸ μὴ ὄν; πάνυ γε. οὐκοῦν καὶ νῦν δηλοῖ ὅτι ἕτερον λέγει τῶν ἄλλων τὸ μὴ ὄν, ὅταν εἴπῃ ἔν ἐστι μὴ ἔστι, καὶ ἴσμεν ὃ λέγει; ἴσμεν. πρῶτον μὲν ἄρα γνωστόν τι λέγει, ἔπειτα ἕτερον τῶν ἄλλων, ὅταν εἴπῃ ἔν, εἴτε τὸ εἶναι αὐτῷ προσθεῖς εἴτε

AR: “Certainly.”

PA: “Is it not also obvious then that whenever someone says ‘if one is not’, he is saying that what is not is different from the others, and we know what he is referring to?”

AR: “Yes, we know.”

PA: “So whenever he speaks of one, is it obvious, firstly, that he is referring to something knowable, and secondly, to something different from the others, whether being or not being is added. For we still know, nevertheless, what is said not to be, and we know that it is different from the others. Isn’t this so?”

AR: “Necessarily.”

160d

PA: “So we should say from the beginning as follows, what must be the case if one is not. Now, the first thing that must pertain to it is, it seems, that there be knowledge of it, otherwise we would not know what is being said when someone says, ‘if one is not’.”

τὸ μὴ εἶναι· οὐδὲν γὰρ ἥττον γινώσκεται, τί τὸ λεγόμενον μὴ εἶναι, καὶ ὅτι διάφορον τῶν ἄλλων. ἢ οὐ; ἀνάγκη. ὥδε ἄρα λεκτέον ἐξ ἀρχῆς, ἔν εἰ μὴ ἔστι, τί χρὴ εἶναι. πρῶτον μὲν οὖν αὐτῷ τοῦτο ὑπάρχειν δεῖ, ὡς ἔοικεν, εἶναι αὐτοῦ ἐπιστήμην, ἢ μὴδὲ ὅτι λέγεται γινώσκεσθαι, ὅταν τις εἴπῃ ἔν εἰ μὴ ἔστιν. ἀληθῆ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τὰ ἄλλα ἕτερα αὐτοῦ εἶναι, ἢ μὴδὲ ἐκεῖνο ἕτερον τῶν ἄλλων λέγεσθαι; πάνυ γε. καὶ ἑτεροίότης ἄρα ἐστὶν αὐτῷ πρὸς τῇ ἐπιστήμῃ.

AR: “True.”

PA: “Also, must not the others be different from it, otherwise it could not be said to be different from the others?”

AR: “Certainly.”

160e

PA: “And so, difference belongs to it in addition to the knowledge. For whenever the one is said to be different from the others, the difference of that one is referred to, and not the difference of the others.”

οὐ γὰρ τὴν τῶν ἄλλων ἑτεροίότητα λέγει, ὅταν τὸ ἐν ἑτερον τῶν ἄλλων λέγῃ, ἀλλὰ τὴν ἐκείνου. φαίνεται. καὶ μὴν τοῦ γε ἐκείνου καὶ τοῦ τινὸς καὶ τούτου καὶ τούτῳ καὶ τούτων καὶ πάντων τῶν τοιούτων μετέχει τὸ μὴ ὄν· οὐ γὰρ ἂν τὸ ἐν ἐλέγετο οὐδ' ἂν τοῦ ἐνὸς ἕτερα, οὐδ' ἐκείνῳ ἂν τι ἦν οὐδ' ἐκείνου, οὐδ' ἂν τι ἐλέγετο, εἰ μήτε τοῦ τινὸς αὐτῷ μετῆν μήτε τῶν ἄλλων τούτων. ὀρθῶς. εἶναι μὲν δὴ τῷ ἐνὶ οὐχ οἶόν τε, εἴπερ γε μὴ ἔστι, μετέχειν δὲ πολλῶν οὐδὲν

AR: “Apparently.”

PA: “And indeed, the one that is not would share in that, in something, and in by-this and in to-this and in these, and in everything of this sort. For the one could not be spoken of, nor could things different from the one, nor could anything be to that or of that, nor could it be referred to as anything if it did not have a share either of something or of these others.”

AR: “Correct.”

161a

PA: “In that case, although the one cannot partake of ‘to be’, since it is not, there is nothing to prevent it from partaking of many things and this is actually necessary if indeed that one, and not another, is not. In fact, if neither the one, nor that, are not to be, but the argument concerns something else, then nothing should even be uttered. But if that one and no other is hypothesised not to be, it must also have a share in that, and in many others.”

κωλύει, ἀλλὰ καὶ ἀνάγκη, εἴπερ τό γε ἐν ἐκεῖνο καὶ μὴ ἄλλο μὴ ἔστιν. εἰ μέντοι μήτε τὸ ἐν μήτ' ἐκεῖνο μὴ ἔσται, ἀλλὰ περὶ ἄλλου τοῦ ὁ λόγος, οὐδὲ φθέγγεσθαι δεῖ οὐδέν· εἰ δὲ τὸ ἐν ἐκεῖνο καὶ μὴ ἄλλο ὑπόκειται μὴ εἶναι, καὶ τοῦ ἐκείνου καὶ ἄλλων πολλῶν ἀνάγκη αὐτῷ μετεῖναι. καὶ πάνυ γε. καὶ ἀνομοίότης ἄρα ἐστὶν αὐτῷ πρὸς τὰ ἄλλα· τὰ γὰρ ἄλλα τοῦ ἐνὸς ἕτερα ὄντα ἑτεροῖα καὶ εἴη ἂν. ναί. τὰ δ' ἑτεροῖα οὐκ ἄλλοῖα; πῶς δ' οὐ; τὰ δ' ἄλλοῖα οὐκ

AR: “Yes, indeed.”

PA: “So the one also has unlikeness in relation to the others. For things other than the one, being different, would also be different in kind.”

AR: “Yes”

PA: “And are not things that are different in kind, other in kind?”

AR: “Of course.”

161b

PA: “And things that are other in kind are unlike, are they not?”

ἀνόμοια; ἀνόμοια μὲν οὖν. οὐκοῦν εἴπερ τῷ ἐνὶ ἀνόμοιά ἐστι, δῆλον ὅτι ἀνομοίῳ τά γε ἀνόμοια ἀνόμοια ἂν εἴη. δῆλον. εἴη δὲ ἂν καὶ τῷ ἐνὶ ἀνομοιότης, πρὸς ἣν τὰ ἄλλα ἀνόμοια αὐτῷ ἐστιν. ἔοικεν. εἰ δὲ δὴ τῶν ἄλλων ἀνομοιότης ἔστιν αὐτῷ, ἄρ' οὐκ ἀνάγκη ἑαυτοῦ ὁμοιότητα αὐτῷ εἶναι; πῶς; εἰ ἐνὸς ἀνομοιότης ἔστι τῷ ἐνί, οὐκ ἂν που περὶ τοῦ τοιούτου ὁ λόγος εἴη οἴου τοῦ ἐνός, οὐδ' ἂν ἡ ὑπόθεσις εἴη περὶ ἐνός, ἀλλὰ περὶ ἄλλου ἢ ἐνός. πάνυ

AR: “Yes, unlike.”

PA: “Now, if they are indeed unlike the one, it is obvious that unlike things would be unlike something that is unlike them.”

AR: “It is obvious.”

PA: “In that case, the one would also have unlikeness in respect of which the others are unlike it.”

AR: “So it seems.”

PA: “But if it actually has unlikeness to the others, must it not necessarily have likeness to itself?”

AR: “In what way?”

PA: “If the one has unlikeness to the one, the argument would not, presumably, be about something of this sort, something like the one, nor would the hypothesis be about one, but about something other than one.”

AR: “Of course.”

161c

PA: “But it should not be about that.”

γε. οὐ δεῖ δέ γε. οὐ δῆτα. δεῖ ἄρα ὁμοιότητα τῷ ἐνὶ αὐτοῦ ἑαυτῷ εἶναι. δεῖ. καὶ μὴν οὐδ’ αὖ ἴσον γ’ ἐστὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις· εἰ γὰρ εἴη ἴσον, εἴη τε ἂν ἥδη καὶ ὅμοιον ἂν εἴη αὐτοῖς κατὰ τὴν ἰσότητα. ταῦτα δ’ ἀμφοτέρω ἀδύνατα, εἴπερ μὴ ἔστιν ἓν. ἀδύνατα. ἐπειδὴ δὲ οὐκ ἔστι τοῖς ἄλλοις ἴσον, ἄρα οὐκ ἀνάγκη καὶ τᾶλλα ἐκείνῳ μὴ ἴσα εἶναι; ἀνάγκη. τὰ δὲ μὴ ἴσα οὐκ ἄνισα; ναί. τὰ δὲ ἄνισα οὐ τῷ ἀνίσῳ ἄνισα; πῶς δ’ οὐ; καὶ ἀνισότητος δὴ μετέχει τὸ ἓν,

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “So the one must have likeness of this to itself.”

AR: “It must.”

PA: “And furthermore, the one is not equal to the others either. For if it were to be equal it would already be, and it would also be like them, based on the equality. But both these outcomes are impossible if indeed one is not.”

AR: “Yes, impossible.”

PA: “And since the one is not equal to the others, isn’t it necessary that the others are not equal to the one?”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “Are not things that are not equal, unequal?”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “And unequals are unequal to an unequal, are they not?”

AR: “Of course.”

161d

PA: “And in that case, does the one partake of inequality in respect of which the others are unequal to it?”

πρὸς ἣν τᾷλλα αὐτῷ ἐστιν ἄνισα; μετέχει. ἀλλὰ μέντοι ἀνισότητός γε ἐστὶ μέγεθός τε καὶ σμικρότης. ἔστι γάρ. ἔστιν ἄρα καὶ μέγεθός τε καὶ σμικρότης τῷ τοιούτῳ ἐνί; κινδυνεύει. μέγεθος μὴν καὶ σμικρότης ἀεὶ ἀφρέστατον ἀλλήλοιν. πάνυ γε. μεταξὺ ἄρα τι αὐτοῖν ἀεὶ ἐστιν. ἔστιν. ἔχεις οὖν τι ἄλλο εἰπεῖν μεταξὺ αὐτοῖν ἢ ἰσότητα; οὐκ, ἀλλὰ τοῦτο. ὅτῳ ἄρα ἔστι μέγεθος καὶ σμικρότης, ἔστι καὶ ἰσότης αὐτῷ μεταξὺ τούτοις οὕσα.

AR: “It partakes.”

PA: “But inequality involves largeness and smallness.”

AR: “It does.”

PA: “So, does a one of this sort have largeness and smallness?”

AR: “Quite likely.”

PA: “But largeness and smallness always stand apart from one another.”

AR: “Certainly.”

PA: “So there is always something in between them?”

AR: “There is.”

PA: “Now, can you say that there is anything in between them except equality?”

AR: “Nothing except this.”

161e

PA: “So, whatever has largeness and smallness also has an equality which is in between these two.”

φαίνεται. τῷ δὲ ἐνὶ μὴ ὄντι, ὡς ἔοικε, καὶ ἰσότητος ἂν μετεῖη καὶ μεγέθους καὶ σμικρότητος. ἔοικεν. καὶ μὴν καὶ οὐσίας γε δεῖ αὐτὸ μετέχειν πῃ. πῶς δὲ; ἔχειν αὐτὸ δεῖ οὕτως ὡς λέγομεν· εἰ γὰρ μὴ οὕτως ἔχει, οὐκ ἂν ἀληθῆ λέγοιμεν ἡμεῖς λέγοντες τὸ ἐν μὴ εἶναι· εἰ δὲ ἀληθῆ, δῆλον ὅτι ὄντα αὐτὰ λέγομεν. ἢ οὐχ οὕτως; οὕτω μὲν οὖν. ἐπειδὴ δὲ φάμεν ἀληθῆ λέγειν, ἀνάγκη

AR: “Apparently.”

PA: “Then the one that is not would, it seems, also have a share of equality as well as largeness and smallness.”

AR: “So it seems.”

PA: “And indeed, it should also, in a way, have a share of being.”

AR: “In what way?”

PA: “It must be such as we describe it, for if it were not such as we describe it, we would not be speaking the truth when we say that the one is not. But if we are speaking the truth, it is obvious that we are stating what actually is. Is this not so?”

AR: “It is so indeed.”

PA: “And since we maintain that we are speaking the truth, we must also maintain that we are stating what is.”

AR: “We must.”

162a

PA: “So the one is, it seems, if it is not. For if it were not to be what is not, but were somehow to let go of its being in relation to not being, it would immediately be what is.”

ἡμῖν φάναι καὶ ὄντα λέγειν. ἀνάγκη. ἔστιν ἄρα, ὡς ἔοικε, τὸ ἐν οὐκ ὄν· εἰ γὰρ μὴ ἔσται μὴ ὄν, ἀλλὰ πῃ τοῦ εἶναι ἀνήσει πρὸς τὸ μὴ εἶναι, εὐθύς ἔσται ὄν. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν. δεῖ ἄρα αὐτὸ δεσμὸν ἔχειν τοῦ μὴ εἶναι τὸ εἶναι μὴ ὄν, εἰ μέλλει μὴ εἶναι, ὁμοίως ὥσπερ τὸ ὄν τὸ μὴ ὄν ἔχειν μὴ εἶναι, ἵνα τελέως αὖ εἶναι ᾗ· οὕτως γὰρ ἂν τό τε ὄν μάλιστα ἂν εἴη καὶ τὸ μὴ ὄν οὐκ ἂν εἴη, μετέχοντα τὸ μὲν ὄν οὐσίας τοῦ εἶναι ὄν, μὴ οὐσίας δὲ τοῦ μὴ εἶναι μὴ

AR: “Entirely so.”

PA: “So, if it is not to be, it must have being what is not as a bond of not being, in just the same way that what is must have not being what is not, so that it in turn may be in every respect. For in this way, most

of all, what is would be, and what is not would not be, by what is partaking of the being of being what is, and the being of not being what is not, if it is to be in every respect, and on the other hand, by what is not partaking of the being of not being what is, and of the being of being what is not, if it too is in turn not to be in every respect.”

162b

AR: “Very true.”

ὄν, εἰ μέλλει τελέως εἶναι, τὸ δὲ μὴ ὄν μὴ οὐσίας μὲν τοῦ μὴ εἶναι μὴ ὄν, οὐσίας δὲ τοῦ εἶναι μὴ ὄν, εἰ καὶ τὸ μὴ ὄν αὖ τελέως μὴ ἔσται. ἀληθέστατα. οὐκοῦν ἐπεὶ τῷ τε ὄντι τοῦ μὴ εἶναι καὶ τῷ μὴ ὄντι τοῦ εἶναι μέτεστι, καὶ τῷ ἐνί, ἐπειδὴ οὐκ ἔστι, τοῦ εἶναι ἀνάγκη μετεῖναι εἰς τὸ μὴ εἶναι. ἀνάγκη. καὶ οὐσία δὴ φαίνεται τῷ ἐνί, εἰ μὴ ἔστιν. φαίνεται. καὶ μὴ οὐσία ἄρα, εἴπερ μὴ ἔστιν. πῶς δ' οὐ; οἷόν τε οὖν τὸ ἔχον πως μὴ ἔχειν οὕτω, μὴ μεταβάλλον ἐκ ταύτης τῆς ἕξεως; οὐχ οἷόν τε. πάν ἄρα τὸ τοιοῦτον

PA: “Now, since what is also shares in non-being, and what is not shares in being, the one must necessarily share in being in respect of its non-being, since it is not.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “In fact then, it appears that the one has being, if it is not.”

AR: “So it appears.”

PA: “And also to have non-being if in fact it is not.”

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “Now, can something that is in a certain state not be in that state without changing from that state?”

AR: “It cannot.”

162c

PA: “So everything of this sort, which is both so and not so, implies change.”

μεταβολὴν σημαίνει, ὃ ἂν οὕτω τε καὶ μὴ οὕτως ἔχῃ. πῶς δ' οὐ; μεταβολὴ δὲ κίνησις· ἢ τί φήσομεν; κίνησις. οὐκοῦν τὸ ἐν ὧν τε καὶ οὐκ ὧν ἐφάνη; ναί. οὕτως ἄρα καὶ οὐχ οὕτως ἔχον φαίνεται. ἔοικεν. καὶ κινούμενον ἄρα τὸ οὐκ ὧν ἐν πέφανται, ἐπεὶ περ καὶ μεταβολὴν ἐκ τοῦ εἶναι ἐπὶ τὸ μὴ εἶναι ἔχον. κινδυνεύει. ἀλλὰ μὴν εἰ μηδαμοῦ γέ ἐστι τῶν ὄντων, ὥς οὐκ ἔστιν εἴπερ μὴ ἔστιν, οὐδ' ἂν μεθίστατο ποθέν ποι. πῶς γάρ; οὐκ ἄρα τῷ γε

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “And change is motion, or what shall we maintain?”

AR: “It is motion.”

PA: “Didn’t the one turn out to be and not to be?”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “And so it appears in this way to be both so and not so.”

AR: “So it seems.”

PA: “And so the one that is not turns out to be in motion, since it has turned out to be changing from possessing being to possessing not being.”

AR: “Quite likely.”

PA: “Then again, if it is not included anywhere among things that are, which it is not since it is not, it would not relocate from one place to another.”

AR: “Of course.”

162d

PA: “So it would not move by changing place.”

μεταβαίνειν κινοῖτ' ἂν. οὐ γάρ. οὐδὲ μὴν ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ ἂν στρέφοιτο· ταύτου γὰρ οὐδαμοῦ ἄπτεται. ὧν γὰρ ἐστὶ τὸ ταυτόν· τὸ δὲ μὴ ὧν ἐν τῷ τῶν ὄντων ἀδύνατον εἶναι. ἀδύνατον γάρ. οὐκ ἄρα τὸ ἐν γε μὴ ὧν στρέφεσθαι ἂν δύναιτο ἐν ἐκείνῳ ἐν ᾧ μὴ ἔστιν. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. οὐδὲ μὴν ἀλλοιοῦταί που τὸ ἐν ἑαυτοῦ, οὔτε τὸ ὧν οὔτε τὸ μὴ ὧν οὐ γὰρ ἂν ἦν ὁ

λόγος ἔτι περὶ τοῦ ἐνός, εἴπερ ἡλλοιοῦτο αὐτὸ ἐαυτοῦ, ἀλλὰ περὶ ἄλλου τινός. ὀρθῶς. εἰ δὲ μήτ' ἡλλοιοῦται μήτε ἐν ταύτῳ στρέφεται μήτε μεταβαίνει, ἄρ'

AR: "It would not."

PA: "Nor indeed would it revolve in the same, since it has no contact with the same anywhere. For the same is something that is, and what is not cannot be in any of the things that are."

AR: "No, it cannot."

PA: "So the one that is not would not be able to revolve in that in which it is not."

AR: "Indeed not."

PA: "Nor could the one, whether it is or is not, be altered from itself. For in that case the argument would no longer be about the one if it were actually altered from itself, but about something else."

AR: "Correct."

162e

PA: "But if it is not altered, nor does it revolve in the same place, nor does it change place, could it still move in any way?"

ἂν πη ἔτι κινοῖτο; πῶς γάρ; τό γε μὴν ἀκίνητον ἀνάγκη ἡσυχίαν ἄγειν, τὸ δὲ ἡσυχάζον ἐστάναι. ἀνάγκη. τὸ ἐν ἅρα, ὡς ἔοικεν, οὐκ ὄν ἔστηκε τε καὶ κινεῖται. ἔοικεν. καὶ μὴν εἴπερ γε κινεῖται, μεγάλη ἀνάγκη αὐτῷ ἡλλοιοῦσθαι·

AR: "No, how could it?"

PA: "But that which is not moving must necessarily be still, and that which is still must be at rest."

AR: "It must."

PA: "So the one, it seems, although it is not, is both at rest and in motion."

AR: “So it seems.”

163a

PA: “And indeed, if in fact the one is moved, there is a strong necessity that it be altered. For according to the manner in which something is moved, it is to that extent no longer just as it was, but is different.”

ὅπη γὰρ ἄν τι κινηθῇ, κατὰ τοσοῦτον οὐκέθ' ὡσαύτως ἔχει ὡς εἶχεν, ἀλλ' ἐτέρως. οὕτως, κινούμενον δὴ τὸ ἐν καὶ ἀλλοιοῦται. ναί. καὶ μὴν μηδαμῇ γε κινούμενον οὐδαμῇ ἂν ἀλλοιοῖτο. οὐ γάρ. ἥ μὲν ἄρα κινεῖται τὸ οὐκ ὄν ἔν, ἀλλοιοῦται· ἥ δὲ μὴ κινεῖται, οὐκ ἀλλοιοῦται. οὐ γάρ. τὸ ἐν ἄρα μὴ ὄν ἀλλοιοῦταί τε καὶ οὐκ ἀλλοιοῦται. φαίνεται. τὸ δ' ἀλλοιούμενον ἄρ' οὐκ ἀνάγκη γίγνεσθαι μὲν ἕτερον ἢ πρότερον, ἀπόλλυσθαι δὲ ἐκ τῆς

AR: “Quite so.”

PA: “So the one, since it is being moved, is also being altered.”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “Then again, since it is not being moved in any way, it would not be altered in any way.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “So, insofar as the one that is not is moved, it is altered, but insofar as it is not moved it is not altered.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “So the one that is not is both altered and not altered.”

AR: “Apparently.”

163b

PA: “Now, must not that which is altered come to be different than before and cease to be in its former state, while that which is not altered must neither come to be, nor cease to be?”

προτέρας ἔξω· τὸ δὲ μὴ ἀλλοιούμενον μήτε γίγνεσθαι μήτε ἀπόλλυσθαι; ἀνάγκη. καὶ τὸ ἐν ἄρα μὴ ὄν ἀλλοιούμενον μὲν γίγνεται τε

καὶ ἀπόλλυται, μὴ ἀλλοιούμενον δὲ οὔτε γίγνεται οὔτε ἀπόλλυται· καὶ οὕτω τὸ ἐν μὴ ὄν γίγνεται τε καὶ ἀπόλλυται, καὶ οὔτε γίγνεται οὔτ' ἀπόλλυται. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. αὐθις δὴ ἐπὶ τὴν ἀρχὴν ἴωμεν πάλιν ὁφόμενοι εἰ ταῦτα ἡμῖν φανεῖται ἅπερ καὶ νῦν ἢ ἕτερα. ἀλλὰ χρή. οὐκοῦν

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “And so the one that is not, because it is being altered, is both coming to be and ceasing to be. And because it is not being altered it is neither coming to be nor ceasing to be, and accordingly, the one that is not is both coming to be and ceasing to be, and neither coming to be nor ceasing to be.”

AR: “Indeed it is not.”

163c

PA: “Then let us go back once again to the beginning and see if different outcomes or the same outcomes will appear to us as appeared just now.”

ἐν εἰ μὴ ἔστι, φαμέν, τί χρή περὶ αὐτοῦ συμβαίνειν; ναί. τὸ δὲ μὴ ἔστιν ὅταν λέγωμεν, ἄρα μὴ τι ἄλλο σημαίνει ἢ οὐσίας ἀπουσίαν τούτῳ ᾧ ἂν φῶμεν μὴ εἶναι; οὐδὲν ἄλλο. πότερον οὖν, ὅταν φῶμεν μὴ εἶναι τι, πῶς οὐκ εἶναι φαμεν αὐτό, πῶς δὲ εἶναι; ἢ τοῦτο τὸ μὴ ἔστι λεγόμενον ἀπλῶς σημαίνει ὅτι οὐδαμῶς οὐδαμῇ ἔστιν οὐδέ πη μετέχει οὐσίας τό γε μὴ ὄν; ἀπλούστατα μὲν οὖν. οὔτε ἄρα εἶναι δύναίτο ἂν τὸ μὴ ὄν οὔτε ἄλλως οὐδαμῶς

AR: “We should do so.”

PA: “In that case, are we to state what the consequences for the one must be, if the one is not?”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “Whenever we say ‘is not’, isn’t this simply indicating the absence of being in that which we maintain is not?”

AR: “Nothing else.”

PA: “Now, whenever we maintain that something is not, are we maintaining that in a way it is not, and in a way it is? Or is the phrase ‘is not’ simply indicating that whatever is not, is not at all in any way, and does not partake of being in any way?”

AR: “Yes, simply that.”

163d

PA: “So, what is not could not be, nor could it partake of being in any other way at all.”

οὐσίας μετέχειν. οὐ γάρ. τὸ δὲ γίνεσθαι καὶ τὸ ἀπόλλυσθαι μή τι ἄλλο ἦν ἢ τὸ μὲν οὐσίας μεταλαμβάνειν, τὸ δ' ἀπολλύναι οὐσίαν; οὐδὲν ἄλλο. ὦι δέ γε μηδὲν τούτου μέτεστιν, οὔτ' ἂν λαμβάνοι οὔτ' ἀπολλύοι αὐτό. πῶς γάρ; τῷ ἐνὶ ἅρα, ἐπειδὴ οὐδαμῇ ἔστιν, οὔτε ἐκτέον οὔτε ἀπαλλακτέον οὔτε μεταληπτέον οὐσίας οὐδαμῶς. εἰκός. οὔτε ἄρα ἀπόλλυται τὸ μὴ ὄν ἐν οὔτε γίγνεται, ἐπεὶ περ οὐδαμῇ μετέχει οὐσίας. οὐ φαίνεται. οὐδ' ἄρ'

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “But coming to be and ceasing to be are nothing but the acquisition of being and the loss of being.”

AR: “Nothing but.”

PA: “But that which has no share of being could neither have acquired it nor lost it.”

AR: “No, how could it?”

PA: “So, since the one is not in any way, it could not possess or lose or acquire being in any way at all.”

AR: “Quite likely.”

PA: “So the one that is not neither ceases to be, nor comes to be, since in fact it does not partake of being in any way.”

AR: “Apparently not.”

163e

PA: “So the one that is not is not altered in any way, for if this happened it would already be both coming into being and ceasing to be.”

ἀλλοιοῦται οὐδαμῇ· ἤδη γὰρ ἂν γίγνοιτό τε καὶ ἀπολλούιτο τοῦτο πάσχον. ἀληθῆ. εἰ δὲ μὴ ἀλλοιοῦται, οὐκ ἀνάγκη μηδὲ κινεῖσθαι; ἀνάγκη. οὐδὲ μὴν ἐστάναι φήσομεν τὸ μηδαμοῦ ὄν· τὸ γὰρ ἐστὸς ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ τινι δεῖ ἀεὶ εἶναι. τῷ αὐτῷ πῶς γὰρ οὐ; οὕτω δὴ αὖ τὸ μὴ ὄν μήτε ποτὲ ἐστάναι μήτε κινεῖσθαι λέγωμεν. μὴ γὰρ οὖν. ἀλλὰ μὴν οὐδ’ ἔστι γε αὐτῷ τι τῶν ὄντων· ἤδη γὰρ ἂν τούτου

AR: “True.”

PA: “But if it is not altered, then necessarily it is not moved either.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “Nor indeed shall we maintain that what in no way is, is at rest. For that which is at rest must always be in something the same.”

AR: “In the same, yes of course.”

PA: “Accordingly, we should also say that what is not is never either at rest or in motion.”

AR: “Indeed it is not.”

164a

PA: “But in that case, none of the things that are belong to it, for it would then partake of being by partaking of this.”

μετέχον ὄντος οὐσίας μετέχοι. δῆλον. οὔτε ἄρα μέγεθος οὔτε σμικρότης οὔτε ἰσότης αὐτῷ ἔστιν. οὐ γάρ. οὐδὲ μὴν ὁμοιότης γε οὐδὲ ἑτεροιότης οὔτε πρὸς αὐτὸ οὔτε πρὸς τᾶλλα εἴη ἂν αὐτῷ. οὐ φαίνεται. τί δέ; τᾶλλα ἔσθ’ ὅπως ἂν εἴη αὐτῷ, εἰ μηδὲν αὐτῷ δεῖ εἶναι; οὐκ ἔστιν. οὔτε ἄρα ὅμοια οὔτε ἀνόμοια οὔτε ταῦτά οὔθ’ ἕτερά ἐστιν αὐτῷ τὰ ἄλλα. οὐ γάρ. τί δέ; τὸ ἐκείνου ἢ τὸ ἐκείνω ἢ τὸ τί ἢ τὸ τοῦτο ἢ τὸ τούτου ἢ ἄλλου ἢ ἄλλω ἢ ποτὲ ἢ

AR: “Obviously.”

PA: “So neither largeness nor smallness nor equality belong to it.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “Nor would likeness or difference belong to it, neither with respect to itself, nor with respect to the others.”

AR: “Apparently not.”

PA: “What about this? If it can have nothing, is there any way that it can have others?”

AR: “There is not.”

PA: “So the others are neither like nor unlike, nor the same as it nor different from it.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

164b

PA: “What about this? Will there be of that, or to that, or something, or this, or of this, or of another, or to another, or once, or was, or now, or knowledge, or opinion, or perception, or an account, or a name, or will any of the other things that are be related to what is not?”

ἔπειτα ἢ νῦν ἢ ἐπιστήμη ἢ δόξα ἢ αἴσθησις ἢ λόγος ἢ ὄνομα ἢ ἄλλο ὅτιοῦν τῶν ὄντων περὶ τὸ μὴ ὄν ἔσται; οὐκ ἔσται. οὕτω δὲ ἔν οὐκ ὄν οὐκ ἔχει πως οὐδαμῇ. οὐκ οὐκ δὲ ἔοικέν γε οὐδαμῇ ἔχειν. ἔτι δὲ λέγωμεν, ἔν εἰ μὴ ἔστι, τὰλλα τί χρή πεπονθέναι. λέγωμεν γάρ. ἄλλα μὲν που δεῖ αὐτὰ εἶναι· εἰ γὰρ μηδὲ ἄλλα ἐστίν, οὐκ ἂν περὶ τῶν ἄλλων λέγοιτο. οὕτω. εἰ δὲ περὶ τῶν ἄλλων ὁ λόγος, τά γε ἄλλα ἕτερά ἐστιν. ἢ οὐκ ἐπὶ τῷ αὐτῷ καλεῖς τό τε ἄλλο καὶ τὸ

AR: “They will not.”

PA: “Accordingly then, the one, if it is not, is not characterised in any way at all.”

AR: “Well, it certainly seems not.”

PA: “In that case we should go on to say how the others must be characterised if one is not.”

AR: “Yes, we should.”

PA: “Now, they must somehow be others, for if they are not even others we would not be talking about the others.”

AR: “Quite so.”

PA: “But if the argument is about the others, the others are different, or don’t you refer to the same thing as both other and different?”

164c

AR: “I do.”

ἕτερον; ἔγωγε. ἕτερον δέ γέ πού φαμεν τὸ ἕτερον εἶναι ἐτέρου, καὶ τὸ ἄλλο δὴ ἄλλο εἶναι ἄλλου; ναί. καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις ἄρα, εἰ μέλλει ἄλλα εἶναι, ἔστι τι οὗ ἄλλα ἔσται. ἀνάγκη. τί δὴ οὖν ἂν εἴη; τοῦ μὲν γὰρ ἐνὸς οὐκ ἔσται ἄλλα, μὴ ὄντος γε. οὐ γάρ. ἀλλήλων ἄρα ἐστί· τοῦτο γὰρ αὐτοῖς ἔτι λείπεται, ἢ μηδενὸς εἶναι ἄλλοις. ὀρθῶς. κατὰ πλήθη ἄρα ἕκαστα ἀλλήλων ἄλλα ἐστί· κατὰ ἓν γὰρ οὐκ ἂν οἶά τε εἴη, μὴ ὄντος ἐνός. ἀλλ’ ἕκαστος, ὥς

PA: “And we maintain, I presume, that what is different is different from something different, and what is other is other than something other?”

AR: “Yes.”

PA: “And the others, if they are to be others, will have something to be other than.”

AR: “Necessarily.”

PA: “Now, what would that actually be? Indeed, they will not be other than the one since the one is not.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “So they are other than one another. Indeed this option still remains for them, or alternatively, to be other than nothing.”

AR: “Correct.”

164d

PA: “So they are other than one another, in each case, as multiplicities, for they could not be so as ones, since one is not. But in each case, it seems, the mass of them is unlimited in multiplicity, and if someone takes what seems to be the smallest part, suddenly, just as in a dream while sleeping, it appears to be many instead of seeming to be one, and instead of seeming miniscule, it appears enormous in comparison with any parts that are cut from it.”

ἔοικεν, ὁ ὄγκος αὐτῶν ἄπειρός ἐστι πλήθει, καὶ τὸ σμικρότατον δοκοῦν εἶναι λάβη τις, ὥσπερ ὄναρ ἐν ὕπνῳ φαίνεται ἐξαίφνης ἀντὶ ἐνὸς δόξαντος εἶναι πολλὰ καὶ ἀντὶ σμικροτάτου παμμέγεθες πρὸς τὰ κερματιζόμενα ἐξ αὐτοῦ. ὀρθότατα. τοιούτων δὴ ὄγκων ἄλλα ἀλλήλων ἂν εἴη τᾶλλα, εἰ ἐνὸς μὴ ὄντος ἄλλα ἐστίν. κομιδῇ μὲν οὖν. οὐκοῦν πολλοὶ ὄγκοι ἔσονται, εἷς ἕκαστος φαινόμενος, ὧν δὲ οὐ, εἴπερ ἓν μὴ ἔσται; οὕτω. καὶ ἀριθμὸς δὲ εἶναι αὐτῶν

AR: “Quite right.”

PA: “In which case, the others would be other than each other as masses of this sort if the others are, although one is not.”

AR: “Precisely.”

PA: “Won’t there be many masses, each appearing to be one without being so, if in fact one is not to be?”

AR: “Quite so.”

164e

PA: “And if in fact each seems to be one, there will seem to be a number of them since they are many.”

δόξει, εἴπερ καὶ ἓν ἕκαστον, πολλῶν ὄντων. πάνυ γε. καὶ τὰ μὲν δὴ ἄρτια, τὰ δὲ περιττὰ ἐν αὐτοῖς ὄντα οὐκ ἀληθῶς φαίνεται, εἴπερ ἓν μὴ ἔσται. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. καὶ μὴν καὶ σμικρότατόν γε, φαμέν, δόξει ἐν αὐτοῖς ἐνεῖναι: φαίνεται δὲ τοῦτο πολλὰ καὶ μεγάλα πρὸς ἕκαστον τῶν

AR: “Certainly.”

PA: “And some among them appear to be even, others odd, without in truth being so, if in fact one is not to be.”

AR: “Indeed.”

165a

PA: “And furthermore, according to us, a smallest will seem to be among them, but this appears to be many and large, relative to each of the many because they are small.”

πολλῶν ὡς σμικρῶν ὄντων. πῶς δ' οὐ; καὶ ἴσος μὴν τοῖς πολλοῖς καὶ σμικροῖς ἕκαστος ὄγκος δοξασθήσεται εἶναι· οὐ γὰρ ἂν μετέβαινεν ἐκ μείζονος εἰς ἕλαττον φαινόμενος, πρὶν εἰς τὸ μεταξὺ δόξειεν ἐλθεῖν, τοῦτο δ' εἴη ἂν φάντασμα ἰσότητος. εἰκός. οὐκοῦν καὶ πρὸς ἄλλον ὄγκον πέρας ἔχων, αὐτός γε πρὸς αὐτὸν οὔτε ἀρχὴν οὔτε πέρας οὔτε μέσον ἔχων; πῇ δὴ; ὅτι ἀεὶ αὐτῶν ὅταν τίς τι λάβῃ τῇ διανοίᾳ ὥς τι τούτων ὄν, πρό τε τῆς ἀρχῆς ἄλλη

AR: “Of course.”

PA: “And each mass will be imagined to be equal to what is many and small, for it could not give the appearance of changing from greater to lesser before seeming to arrive at whatever is in between, and this would be apparent equality.”

AR: “Quite likely.”

PA: “Would it not have limit relative to another mass, while having, itself, neither a beginning limit, nor middle, relative to itself?”

AR: “Why is that?”

165b

PA: “Because whenever anyone, in thought, grasps any of these as if it were one of them, then another beginning always appears before that beginning, and after the end, another end still remains, and in the middle others more in the middle, but smaller due to the impossibility of grasping each of them as one, since one is not.”

ἀεὶ φαίνεται ἀρχή, μετὰ τε τὴν τελευτὴν ἑτέρα ὑπολειπομένη τελευτή, ἔν τε τῷ μέσῳ ἄλλα μεσαίτερα τοῦ μέσου, σμικρότερα δέ, διὰ τὸ μὴ δύνασθαι ἑνὸς αὐτῶν ἐκάστου λαμβάνεσθαι, ἅτε οὐκ ὄντος τοῦ ἑνός. ἀληθέστατα. θρύπτεσθαι δὴ οἶμαι κερματιζόμενον ἀνάγκη πᾶν τὸ ὄν, ὃ ἂν τις λάβῃ τῇ διανοίᾳ· ὄγκος γάρ που ἄνευ ἑνός ἀεὶ λαμβάνοιτ' ἂν. πάννυ μὲν οὖν. οὐκοῦν τό γε τοιοῦτον πόρρωθεν μὲν

AR: “Very true.”

PA: “So it must be the case, I believe, for anything that is, that whatever one grasps in thought, even as it is being cut into pieces, must crumble apart. For it would always be grasped, somehow, as a mass devoid of the one.”

AR: “Yes, certainly.”

165c

PA: “Now, isn’t it necessary that something of this sort must appear to be one to anyone who views it dimly from afar, while to someone who considers it keenly from close up, each one must appear unlimited in multiplicity if it is actually deprived of the one because the one is not?”

ὁρῶντι καὶ ἀμβλὺ ἐν φαίνεσθαι ἀνάγκη, ἐγγύθεν δὲ καὶ ὁξὺ νοοῦντι πλήθει ἄπειρον ἐν ἑκάστῳ φανῆναι, εἴπερ στέρεται τοῦ ἑνός μὴ ὄντος; ἀναγκαιότατον μὲν οὖν. οὕτω δὴ ἄπειρά τε καὶ πέρας ἔχοντα καὶ ἐν καὶ πολλὰ ἑκαστα τᾶλλα δεῖ φαίνεσθαι, ἐν εἰ μὴ ἔστιν, τᾶλλα δὲ τοῦ ἑνός. δεῖ γάρ. οὐκοῦν καὶ ὅμοιά τε καὶ ἀνόμοια δόξει εἶναι; πῇ δὴ; οἷον ἐσκιαγραφημένα ἀποστάντι μὲν ἐν πάντα φαινόμενα ταῦτ' ὅν φαίνεσθαι πεπονθέναι καὶ ὅμοια εἶναι. πάννυ

AR: “Yes, absolutely necessary.”

PA: “In that case then, the others must each appear limitless and possessed of limit, and one and many, if one is not and there are things other than one.”

AR: “They must indeed.”

PA: “Won’t they also seem to be both like and unlike?”

AR: “In what way?”

PA: “In the way that shadow drawings all appear one to a person standing away from them, and appear to have a characteristic the same, and to be like.”

AR: “Indeed.”

165d

PA: “But to someone who has approached them they appear many and different, and by the appearance of difference they appear to be different in character and unlike themselves.”

γε. προσελθόντι δέ γε πολλά καὶ ἕτερα καὶ τῷ τοῦ ἐτέρου φαντάσματι ἑτεροῖα καὶ ἀνόμοια ἑαυτοῖς. οὕτω. καὶ ὁμοίους δὴ καὶ ἀνομοίους τοὺς ὄγκους αὐτοὺς τε αὐτοῖς ἀνάγκη φαίνεσθαι καὶ ἀλλήλοις. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. οὐκοῦν καὶ τοὺς αὐτοὺς καὶ ἑτέρους ἀλλήλων, καὶ ἀπτομένους καὶ χωρὶς ἑαυτῶν, καὶ κινουμένους πάσας κινήσεις καὶ ἐστῶτας πάντη, καὶ γιγνομένους καὶ ἀπολλυμένους καὶ μηδέτερα, καὶ πάντα που τὰ τοιαῦτα, ἃ διελθεῖν εὐπετεὺς ἤδη ἡμῖν, εἰ ἐνός

AR: “So they do.”

PA: “And so the masses themselves necessarily appear like and unlike themselves and one another.”

AR: “Yes, certainly.”

165e

PA: “Therefore if one is not, and there are many, these must appear both the same as and different from one another, both in contact with and apart from themselves, both moving with every motion and at rest in every respect, both coming to be and ceasing to be and neither, and everything else of this sort, I presume, which we could easily set out at this stage.”

μὴ ὄντος πολλὰ ἔστιν. ἀληθέστατα μὲν οὖν. ἔτι δὴ ἅπαξ ἐλθόντες πάλιν ἐπὶ τὴν ἀρχὴν εἴπωμεν, ἔν εἰ μὴ ἔστι, τᾶλλα δὲ τοῦ ἐνός, τί χρὴ εἶναι. εἴπωμεν γὰρ οὖν. οὐκοῦν ἔν μὲν οὐκ ἔσται τᾶλλα. πῶς γάρ; οὐδὲ μὴν

πολλά γε· ἐν γὰρ πολλοῖς οὓσιν ἐνείη ἂν καὶ ἓν. εἰ γὰρ μηδὲν αὐτῶν ἐστὶν ἓν, ἅπαντα οὐδὲν ἐστὶν, ὥστε οὐδ' ἂν πολλά εἴη. ἀληθῆ. μὴ ἐνόντος δὲ ἐνὸς ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις, οὔτε πολλά οὔτε ἓν ἐστὶ τᾶλλα. οὐ γάρ. οὐδέ

AR: “Very true.”

PA: “Then let us go back once again to the beginning, and let us say what must be the case if one is not and there are things other than one.”

AR: “Yes, let us do so.”

PA: “In that case, the others will not be one.”

AR: “No, how could they?”

PA: “Nor indeed will they be many since one would then be present in things that are many. For if no one of them is one, they are all nothing, and so they could not be many.”

AR: “True.”

PA: “But without the one being present in the others, the others are neither many nor one.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

166a

PA: “Nor do they even appear to be one or many.”

γε φαίνεται ἓν οὐδὲ πολλά. τί δὴ; ὅτι τᾶλλα τῶν μὴ ὄντων οὐδενὶ οὐδαμῇ οὐδαμῶς οὐδεμίαν κοινωνίαν ἔχει, οὐδέ τι τῶν μὴ ὄντων παρὰ τῶν ἄλλων τῷ ἐστὶν· οὐδὲν γὰρ μέρος ἐστὶ τοῖς μὴ οὓσιν. ἀληθῆ. οὐδ' ἄρα δόξα τοῦ μὴ ὄντος παρὰ τοῖς ἄλλοις ἐστὶν οὐδέ τι φάντασμα, οὐδὲ δοξάζεται οὐδαμῇ οὐδαμῶς τὸ μὴ ὄν ἐπὶ τῶν ἄλλων. οὐ γὰρ οὓν. ἐν ἄρα εἰ μὴ ἔστιν, οὐδὲ δοξάζεται τι τῶν

AR: “Why is that?”

PA: “Because the others do not have any communion whatsoever in any way at all with any of the things that are not, nor does anything

from the others belong to things that are not, since there is no part of things that are not.”

AR: “True.”

PA: “Nor is there any opinion of what is not, with the others, nor any appearance either, nor is what is not thought of in any way at all by the others.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

166b

PA: “So if one is not, none of the others is thought to be either one or many, for it is impossible to think of many in the absence of one.”

ἄλλων ἔν εἶναι οὐδὲ πολλά· ἄνευ γὰρ ἑνὸς πολλὰ δοξάσαι ἀδύνατον. ἀδύνατον γάρ. ἔν ἄρα εἰ μὴ ἔστι, τᾶλλα οὔτε ἔστιν οὔτε δοξάζεται ἔν οὐδὲ πολλά. οὐκ ἔοικεν. οὐδ’ ἄρα ὅμοια οὐδὲ ἀνόμοια. οὐ γάρ. οὐδὲ μὴν τὰ αὐτὰ γε οὐδ’ ἕτερα, οὐδὲ ἀπτόμενα οὐδὲ χωρίς, οὐδὲ ἄλλα ὅσα ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν διήλθομεν ὡς φαινόμενα αὐτά, τούτων οὔτε τι ἔστιν οὔτε φαίνεται τᾶλλα, ἔν εἰ μὴ ἔστιν. ἀληθῆ. οὐκοῦν καὶ

AR: “Yes, impossible.”

PA: “So if one is not, the others neither are, nor are thought to be, one or many.”

AR: “It seems not.”

PA: “Nor are they like, nor are they unlike.”

AR: “Indeed not.”

PA: “Nor are they the same, nor different, nor in contact, nor separate, nor are they anything else that they appeared to be in our earlier description. They neither are, nor appear to be, any of these if one is not.”

AR: “True.”

166c

PA: “In that case, if we were to maintain, in short, that if one is not then nothing is, would we be right to say so?”

AR: “Entirely so.”

166c

PA: “So, let us say this, and also that, as it seems, whether one is or is not, both itself and the others, in relation to themselves and to one another, both are and are not, and appear and do not appear to be all things in all ways.”

συλλήβδην εἰ εἵπομεν, ἔν εἰ μὴ ἔστιν, οὐδέν ἐστιν, ὀρθῶς ἂν εἵπομεν; παντάπασι μὲν οὖν. εἰρήσθω τοίνυν τοῦτό τε καὶ ὅτι, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἔν εἴτ' ἔστιν εἴτε μὴ ἔστιν, αὐτό τε καὶ τᾶλλα καὶ πρὸς αὐτὰ καὶ πρὸς ἄλληλα πάντα πάντως ἐστὶ τε καὶ οὐκ ἔστι καὶ φαίνεται τε καὶ οὐ φαίνεται. ἀληθέστατα.

AR: “Very true.”

Notes

¹ Adimantus and Glaucon were Plato's older brothers. They are the main interlocutors with Socrates in Plato's Republic.

² Zeno of Elea was a philosopher and student of Parmenides who became famous for his paradoxes.

³ Parmenides of Elea was a famous philosopher and founder of the Eleatic school of philosophy.

⁴ The Panathenaea was an annual festival held over several days in Athens in honour of the goddess Athena. Every four years it was celebrated as the Great Panathenaea.

⁵ This phrase could be rendered as ‘the many are not’, ‘there is no multiplicity’, or as ‘multiplicity does not exist’.

⁶ The Greek phrase here is *ei polla esti*. We have rendered it as ‘if many are’, but it could be translated as ‘if [things] are many’.

⁷ Ibycus of Rhegium was a lyric poet who was noted, in particular, for his verses on love.

⁸ Some scholars justify translating this phrase as ‘if one is or if it is not’.

⁹ The phrase ‘if one is’ can also be translated as ‘if it [the one or the all?] is one’. This, however, would make the first hypothesis predicative, while all of the others are existential.